

Antigone

Sophocles · about 441 B.C.E.

Francis Storr translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks (app text)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

13 scene lessons plus 1 seminar, a test day and an essay day: 14 class days of 90 minutes, 5 per unit (block schedule), 3 units
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Cover: J. M. W. Turner, The Fighting Temeraire (1839). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–13), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Sections follow the Greek structure (prologue, parodos, episodes, stasima, exodos). Line numbers are Storr's English lines, not Greek. Method lines 53, 1161–1162, 1175–1179, 1235–1236, 1241 and 1246–1248 are cited by number only.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to AP via rigor levels). **Units:** 3. **Class days:** 14 × 90 minutes (13 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Antigone suggest about divine law and human law?
- What does Antigone suggest about family and the State?
- What does Antigone suggest about pride and stubbornness?
- What does Antigone suggest about gender and power?
- What does Antigone suggest about learning too late?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Writing prompt each unit (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has four rigor levels (HS Sophomore through AP); each level offers three writing options (individual analytical, individual creative, group) on one rubric; the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	We do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Unit	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Prologue (lines 1–98) Parodos (lines 99–154) Episode 1 (lines 155–323) Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*divine law and human law* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Episode 2 (lines 354–548) *Socratic seminar on divine law and human law* Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588) (20-minute preview) and Episode 3 (lines 589–736) Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752) (20-minute preview) and Episode 4 (lines 753–883) Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923) (20-minute preview) and Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*family and the State* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on divine law and human law • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093) (20-minute preview) and Exodos (lines 1094–1279) *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	4 × 90 min (360 min)	*pride and stubbornness* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Antigone

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Sophocles's life or times connects to divine law and human law in “Antigone”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (divine law and human law, family and the State, pride and stubbornness).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Sophocles (about 497/6 to 406/5 B.C.E.) was one of the three great tragic poets of Athens, with Aeschylus and Euripides. He was born at Colonus, just outside the city, served Athens as a general and a treasurer, and is said to have written more than 120 plays, of which seven survive complete. He won first prize at the City Dionysia many times and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage.

Historical and cultural context

Sophocles was an Athenian tragedian whose plays were staged at the City Dionysia in Athens; Antigone is usually dated to about 441 B.C.E., when Athens under Pericles was at the height of its power.

Publication and reception, then and now

Antigone is usually dated to about 441 B.C.E., the earliest of the three Theban plays though it tells the last part of the story. Hegel made it a central example of tragedy as a clash of two rights. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 translation as edited by Standard Ebooks.

Then: The play was probably first staged at the Great Dionysia in Athens about 441 B.C.E.; Jebb gives 442 and 441 as the likely limits, and an old tradition says its fame helped win Sophocles a generalship (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, §§ 19–20).

Now: Modern readers still argue over it: Hegel read it as a clash of two rightful powers, while Jebb held that the right is wholly with Antigone; in 1845 it was staged in London with Mendelssohn's music (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 18).

Overview (spoiler-free)

After the brothers Eteocles and Polyneices kill each other in a war for Thebes, their uncle Creon, the new king, forbids anyone to bury Polyneices. Their sister Antigone decides to bury him anyway, and must face the king's law.

Main themes

- divine law and human law: Watch how characters appeal either to the laws of the gods or to the orders of the city, and ask which should come first.
- family and the State: The play keeps setting loyalty to family against loyalty to the city; notice who chooses which.
- pride and stubbornness: Watch for characters who will not bend, and for the warnings others give them.
- gender and power: Notice how often a character's being a woman is used as an argument about who should obey.
- learning too late: Ask, as the play goes on, who learns from advice in time and who does not.

Why it matters

Antigone is the classic debate between conscience and the law of the state, and between private loyalty and public order. Students meet the same questions in civil disobedience, protest and the limits of authority.

Spoilers · teacher only

Antigone buries her brother, is caught and is sentenced to be shut alive in a tomb. The prophet Teiresias warns Creon, who gives way too late: Antigone, his son Haemon and his wife Eurydice are all dead, reported by messengers, and Creon is left in ruin.

Content framing, teacher guidance: Have the school counselor's contact ready and follow school protocol if a student discloses risk. The Lifeline offers call, text and chat, free and confidential, 24/7. The announcement names no later victims, so it does not give away the ending.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Say: Before we start, I want to tell you about some hard parts of this play. It is an ancient Greek tragedy about a young woman who defies a king's order so that she can honor her dead brother. The play includes war and violence within a family, references to incest in the family's past, threats of execution, self-harm, and several deaths, including deaths by suicide. These events happen offstage and are reported by others, and Sophocles shows them as a catastrophe, not as brave or as a solution. In real life, hurting yourself is wrong and is never the answer. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide or self-harm, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or talk to a school counselor or a trusted adult. You don't have to handle it alone. Before we open Antigone: which matters more, divine law and human law or family and the State? Write for five minutes.
Prompt: Before we open Antigone: which matters more, divine law and human law or family and the State? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · We do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
Key terms for Antigone: divine law and human law, family and the State, pride and stubbornness, gender and power, learning too late.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Sophocles (about 497/6 to 406/5 B.C.E.) was one of the three great tragic poets of Athens, with Aeschylus and Euripides. He was born at Colonus, just outside the city, served Athens as a general and a treasurer, and is said to have written more than 120 plays, of which seven survive complete. He won first prize at the City Dionysia many times and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage. The world of the book. Sophocles was an Athenian tragedian whose plays were staged at the City Dionysia in Athens; Antigone is usually dated to about 441 B.C.E., when Athens under Pericles was at the height of its power. Publication and reception. Antigone is usually dated to about 441 B.C.E., the earliest of the three Theban plays though it tells the last part of the story. Hegel made it a central example of tragedy as a clash of two rights. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 translation as edited by Standard Ebooks. Then: The play was probably first staged at the Great Dionysia in Athens about 441 B.C.E.; Jebb gives 442 and 441 as the likely limits, and an old tradition says its fame helped win Sophocles a generalship (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, §§ 19–20). Now: Modern readers still argue over it: Hegel read it as a clash of two rightful powers, while Jebb held that the right is wholly with Antigone; in 1845 it was staged in London with Mendelssohn's music (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 18). Later influence. Later critics have kept arguing over the play: Hegel read it as a collision of two powers, family and the gods below against the State (Hegel, 1838/1920), while Jebb held that the right is wholly with Antigone (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 7). Goethe wished the brother argument (lines 849–854) could be removed (Eckermann, 1850, 28 March 1827). Mendelssohn wrote music for a German Antigone in 1841, and that production was staged at Covent Garden in London on 2 January 1845 (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 18). The play is still taught as a debate between law and conscience.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Antigone speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about two sisters, one choice. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, conflict to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Antigone. The strongest word is "Oedipus": the word "Oedipus" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about two sisters, one choice? My answer: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. These lines show two sisters, one choice, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes (Prologue (lines 1–98), Antigone)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Antigone speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about two sisters, one choice. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, conflict to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Antigone. The strongest word is "Oedipus": the word "Oedipus" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about two sisters, one choice? My answer: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. These lines show two sisters, one choice, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.

What the book is about (no spoilers): After the brothers Eteocles and Polyneices kill each other in a war for Thebes, their uncle Creon, the new king, forbids anyone to bury Polyneices. Their sister Antigone decides to bury him anyway, and must face the king's law. Themes to track: divine law and human law: Watch how characters appeal either to the laws of the gods or to the orders of the city, and ask which should come first. family and the State: The play keeps setting loyalty to family against loyalty to the city; notice who chooses which. pride and stubbornness: Watch for characters who will not bend, and for the warnings others give them. gender and power: Notice how often a character's being a woman is used as an argument about who should obey. learning too late: Ask, as the play goes on, who learns from advice in time and who does not.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page, divine law and human law: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.

Task: Set up a reading journal for Antigone: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.

Exemplar: Theme page, divine law and human law: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Antigone still matter? Antigone is the classic debate between conscience and the law of the state, and between private loyalty and public order. Students meet the same questions in civil disobedience, protest and the limits of authority.
Anchor question: Why might Antigone still be taught today?
Facilitation: Antigone is the classic debate between conscience and the law of the state, and between private loyalty and public order. Students meet the same questions in civil disobedience, protest and the limits of authority.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Sophocles wrote Antigone for an Athens led by Pericles, a democracy proud of its laws. How might citizens of that democracy have judged a ruler for whom the city's law outranks family and the gods? Answer: Accept answers such as: citizens who valued law and the city might sympathise with Creon at first, yet Athens also honoured burial rites and the gods, so his refusal would have looked dangerous.
Exit ticket: Sophocles wrote Antigone for an Athens led by Pericles, a democracy proud of its laws. How might citizens of that democracy have judged a ruler for whom the city's law outranks family and the gods?
Answer: Accept answers such as: citizens who valued law and the city might sympathise with Creon at first, yet Athens also honoured burial rites and the gods, so his refusal would have looked dangerous.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Prologue (lines 1–98).

Teacher notes · sources: Standard Ebooks, Sophocles, translated by Francis Storr (https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles); R. C. Jebb, Sophocles: The Plays and Fragments (Cambridge University Press), Internet Archive (https://archive.org/details/sophocles02soph_0)

Lesson 2: Prologue (lines 1–98)

Focus: two sisters, one choice

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Prologue (lines 1–98)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Cite method lines by number only.
Suggested language: "What does the play show about the cost of this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone.

Background: For Greeks, leaving a body unburied denied the dead rest and offended the gods. The two brothers had killed each other in the war over Thebes; this play was written before Oedipus Rex and Oedipus at Colonus, though its story comes last.

Significance: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When, if ever, is it right to break a law? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....
Prompt: When, if ever, is it right to break a law?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context.
Today's words: interdict — a formal ban; edict — an official order from a ruler; obsequies — funeral rites; fratricide — the killing of one's brother; promulgate — to announce a law officially; specious — appearing true or right but false.
Words: interdict: a formal ban · edict: an official order from a ruler · obsequies: funeral rites · fratricide: the killing of one's brother · promulgate: to announce a law officially · specious: appearing true or right but false

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
For Greeks, leaving a body unburied denied the dead rest and offended the gods. The two brothers had killed each other in the war over Thebes; this play was written before Oedipus Rex and Oedipus at Colonus, though its story comes last. The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Characterization: Antigone speaks in commands and tests ("If thou art worthy of thy blood or base"); Ismene answers with memory and fear, so their speech styles already carry the choice. Conflict: Creon's burial ban sets the gods' rites against the city's order before either sister acts; the sisters then split over whether to defy it. Setting: Before dawn, outside the palace after a civil war, a private talk between two sisters opens the public crisis of the play. Watch for burial and the unburied body: Polyneices is named as a feast for kites, so the denied burial is already a religious offense, not only a family grief.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" slowly and put it in my own words: Antigone opens by naming Ismene as her blood sister and by claiming that Zeus is completing Oedipus's inherited doom in their own lives. Next, craft. "Sister of my blood and heart" binds the two women before any dispute, and "the weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" piles the family curse into one phrase so the new trouble already feels inherited. The strongest word is "Oedipus": it packs the inherited doom into one name before any choice is spoken. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about two sisters, one choice? My answer: The sisters will embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. The opening already sets the family past as the pressure under which that choice is made.

> *Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes (Prologue, lines 1–3)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" slowly and put it in my own words: Antigone opens by naming Ismene as her blood sister and by claiming that Zeus is completing Oedipus's inherited doom in their own lives. Next, craft. "Sister of my blood and heart" binds the two women before any dispute, and "the weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" piles the family curse into one phrase so the new trouble already feels inherited. The strongest word is "Oedipus": it packs the inherited doom into one name before any choice is spoken. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about two sisters, one choice? My answer: The sisters will embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. The opening already sets the family past as the pressure under which that choice is made.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Dishonoured", "tombless" and "unwept" stand out. Each word names a rite denied to Polyneices, so Antigone shows how harsh the edict is before she says what she will do about it. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. (Antigone, lines 25–29.)

> *But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse, / (So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament— / Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast / For kites to scent afar and swoop upon (Prologue, lines 25–29)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Dishonoured", "tombless" and "unwept" stand out in lines 25–29. Each word names a rite the edict denies Polyneices—honour, a grave, and lament—so Antigone shows how harsh Creon's order is before she says what she will do about it. "Dishonoured corse" already judges the decree in a single phrase.
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. (Antigone, lines 25–29.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about two sisters, one choice? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–98) develops the idea of two sisters, one choice. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. When the text says "If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men" (Prologue, lines 59–61), it shows this directly. Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about two sisters, one choice? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–98) develops the idea of two sisters, one choice. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. When the text says "If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men" (Prologue, lines 59–61), it shows this directly. Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: When, if ever, is it right to break a law? Ask: When, if ever, is it right to break a law?

Anchor question: When, if ever, is it right to break a law?

Facilitation: Ask: When, if ever, is it right to break a law?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about two sisters, one choice? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. ("If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men", Prologue, lines 59–61). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about two sisters, one choice? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. ("If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men", Prologue, lines 59–61). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes two sisters, one choice. Key takeaway: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Antigone speaks in commands and tests ("If thou art worthy of thy blood or base"); Ismene answers with memory and fear, so their speech styles already carry the choice.
- **Conflict:** Creon's burial ban sets the gods' rites against the city's order before either sister acts; the sisters then split over whether to defy it.
- **Setting:** Before dawn, outside the palace after a civil war, a private talk between two sisters opens the public crisis of the play.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** Polyneices is named as a feast for kites, so the denied burial is already a religious offense, not only a family grief.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes" (Prologue, lines 1–3) Antigone, lines 1–3.
- "But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse, / (So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament— / Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast / For kites to scent afar and swoop upon" (Prologue, lines 25–29) Antigone, lines 25–29.
- "If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men" (Prologue, lines 59–61) Ismene, lines 59–61.
- "Go thine own way; myself will bury him" (Prologue, line 70) Antigone, line 70.
- "I scorn them not, but to defy the State / Or break her ordinance I have no skill" (Prologue, lines 77–78) Ismene, lines 77–78.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges.
Evidence: "If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men" (Prologue, lines 59–61)
Reasoning: Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1–3

1 **Antigone:** Ismene, sister of my blood and heart,
2 **Antigone:** See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil
3 **Antigone:** The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes!

Lines 1–15

1 **Antigone:** Ismene, sister of my blood and heart,
2 **Antigone:** See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil
3 **Antigone:** The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes!
4 **Antigone:** For what of pain, affliction, outrage, shame,
5 **Antigone:** Is lacking in our fortunes, thine and mine?
6 **Antigone:** And now this proclamation of today
7 **Antigone:** Made by our Captain-General to the State,
8 **Antigone:** What can its purport be? Didst hear and heed,
9 **Antigone:** Or art thou deaf when friends are banned as foes?
10 **Ismene:** To me, Antigone, no word of friends
11 **Ismene:** Has come, or glad or grievous, since we twain
12 **Ismene:** Were reft of our two brethren in one day
13 **Ismene:** By double fratricide; and since i' the night

14 **Ismene:** Our Argive leaguers fled, no later news
15 **Ismene:** Has reached me, to inspirit or deject.

Lines 25–29
25 **Antigone:** But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse,
26 **Antigone:** (So by report the royal edict runs)
27 **Antigone:** No man may bury him or make lament—
28 **Antigone:** Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast
29 **Antigone:** For kites to scent afar and swoop upon.

Line 38
38 **Antigone:** If thou art worthy of thy blood or base.

Line 44
44 **Ismene:** What, bury him despite the interdict?

Line 46
46 **Antigone:** No man shall say that I betrayed a brother.

Line 48
48 **Antigone:** What right has he to keep me from my own?

Line 53
[line 53: cited by line number only]

Lines 59–61
59 **Ismene:** If in defiance of the law we cross
60 **Ismene:** A monarch's will?—weak women, think of that,
61 **Ismene:** Not framed by nature to contend with men.

Lines 65–66
65 **Ismene:** The dead to pardon. I perforce obey
66 **Ismene:** The powers that be. 'Tis foolishness, I ween,

Line 70
70 **Antigone:** Go thine own way; myself will bury him.

Line 71
71 **Antigone:** How sweet to die in such employ, to rest—

Line 72
72 **Antigone:** Sister and brother linked in love's embrace—

Lines 77–78
77 **Ismene:** I scorn them not, but to defy the State
78 **Ismene:** Or break her ordinance I have no skill.

Lines 79–80

79 **Antigone:** A specious pretext. I will go alone
80 **Antigone:** To lap my dearest brother in the grave.

Lines 85–86

85 **Antigone:** O tell it, sister; I shall hate thee more
86 **Antigone:** If thou proclaim it not to all the town.

Line 87

87 **Ismene:** Thou hast a fiery soul for numbing work.

Line 89

89 **Ismene:** If thou succeed; but thou art doomed to fail.

Line 90

90 **Antigone:** When strength shall fail me, yes, but not before.

Line 98

98 **Ismene:** Yet to thy lovers thou art dear as ever. Exeunt.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
interdict (noun)	a formal ban	*What, bury him despite the interdict?*
edict (noun)	an official order from a ruler	*(So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament—*
obsequies (noun)	funeral rites	*With obsequies that use and wont ordain, / So gracing him among the dead below.*
fratricide (noun)	the killing of one's brother	*By double fratricide; and since i' the night*
promulgate (verb)	to announce a law officially	*He will be here to promulgate, for such*
specious (adjective)	appearing true or right but false	*A specious pretext. I will go alone / To lap my dearest brother in the grave.*

Discussion questions

1. When, if ever, is it right to break a law?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with divine law and human law?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore:

1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What will happen to Polyneices' body under the edict (lines 25–29)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It will lie unburied and unmourned, food for birds.
   Answer guidance: It will lie unburied and unmourned, food for birds.
2. What has Creon forbidden? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Burying or mourning Polyneices
   Answer guidance: Burying or mourning Polyneices.
3. Why is Polyneices treated differently from Eteocles? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He attacked Thebes while Eteocles defended it
   Answer guidance: He attacked Thebes while Eteocles defended it.
4. What help does Antigone want from her sister? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Help her bury their brother
   Answer guidance: Help her bury their brother.
5. What reasons hold Ismene back from joining her? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She fears defying the State and the king
   Answer guidance: She fears defying the State and the king.
6. Which best describes the conflict in the Prologue? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Family and religious duty against the ruler's law
   Answer guidance: Family and religious duty against the ruler's law.
7. Retell the most important events of “Prologue (lines 1–98)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone.
   Answer guidance: Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone.
8. Who is on stage in “Prologue (lines 1–98)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Prologue (lines 1–98)” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting

detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “What, bury him despite the interdict?” What does “interdict” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** interdict: a formal ban.

    Answer guidance: interdict: a formal ban.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Ismene's line about "weak women" show about the society of the play? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Women were expected to obey men and the State; Ismene accepts that view.

    Answer guidance: Women were expected to obey men and the State; Ismene accepts that view.

2. What does “Prologue (lines 1–98)” suggest about two sisters, one choice? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges.

    Answer guidance: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Evidence to accept: “Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See’st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes” (Prologue, lines 1–3): Antigone, lines 1–3. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of characterization in “Prologue (lines 1–98)”. What does it reveal about two sisters, one choice that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: “But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse, / (So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament— / Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast / For kites to scent afar and swoop upon” (Prologue, lines 25–29): Antigone, lines 25–29. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the conflict in “Prologue (lines 1–98)” shape what we understand about two sisters, one choice? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See’st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes” (Prologue, lines 1–3): Antigone, lines 1–3. On conflict: Creon’s burial ban sets the gods’ rites against the city’s order before either sister acts; the sisters then split over whether to defy it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, See’st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch’s will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men” (Prologue, lines 59–61): Ismene, lines 59–61. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Prologue (lines 1–98)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Creon's edict forbidding burial of Polyneices; Antigone's decision to bury him anyway; the effect, a break between the two sisters.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Creon's edict forbidding burial of Polyneices; Antigone's decision to bury him anyway; the effect, a break between the two sisters. Evidence to accept: “Go thine own way; myself will bury him” (Prologue, line 70): Antigone, line 70. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. As the opening scene, what does “Prologue (lines 1–98)” set up that the rest of Antigone will need? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse, / (So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament— / Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast / For kites to scent afar and swoop upon” (Prologue, lines 25–29): Antigone, lines 25–29. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Prologue (lines 1–98)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about two sisters, one choice, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch’s will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men” (Prologue, lines 59–61): Ismene, lines 59–61. On characterization: Antigone speaks in commands and tests (“If thou art worthy of thy blood or base”); Ismene answers with memory and fear, so their speech styles already carry the choice. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (When, if ever, is it right to break a law?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “I scorn them not, but to defy the State / Or break her ordinance I have no skill” (Prologue, lines 77–78): Ismene, lines 77–78. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does setting appear in “Prologue (lines 1–98)”, and how does it connect two sisters, one choice to the larger concern with divine law and human law? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “Go thine own way; myself will bury him” (Prologue, line 70): Antigone, line 70. On setting: Before dawn, outside the palace after a civil war, a private talk between two sisters opens the public crisis of the play. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Ismene a coward or a realist? Argue with lines 59–61 and 77–78. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
    Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See’st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes” (Prologue, lines 1–3): Antigone, lines 1–3. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Prologue (lines 1–98)” acts most wisely in the matter of two sisters, one choice, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse, / (So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament— / Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast / For kites to scent afar and swoop upon” (Prologue, lines 25–29): Antigone, lines 25–29. On characterization: Antigone speaks in commands and tests (“If thou art worthy of thy blood or base”); Ismene answers with memory and fear, so their speech styles already carry the choice. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Prologue (lines 1–98)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of two sisters, one choice. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-

Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch’s will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men” (Prologue, lines 59–61): Ismene, lines 59–61. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Prologue (lines 1–98)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “Go thine own way; myself will bury him” (Prologue, line 70): Antigone, line 70. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Prologue (lines 1–98)”, with its focus on two sisters, one choice, to family and the State: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “I scorn them not, but to defy the State / Or break her ordinance I have no skill” (Prologue, lines 77–78): Ismene, lines 77–78. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in “Prologue (lines 1–98)” effective in presenting two sisters, one choice, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, / See’st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil / The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes” (Prologue, lines 1–3): Antigone, lines 1–3. On characterization: Antigone speaks in commands and tests (“If thou art worthy of thy blood or base”); Ismene answers with memory and fear, so their speech styles already carry the choice. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Prologue (lines 1–98)” treats two sisters, one choice with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “But Polyneices, a dishonoured corse, / (So by report the royal edict runs) / No man may bury him or make lament— / Must leave him tombless and unwept, a feast / For kites to scent afar and swoop upon” (Prologue, lines 25–29): Antigone, lines 25–29. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Parodos (lines 99–154)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch’s will?— weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men” (Prologue, lines 59–61): Ismene, lines 59–61. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Prologue (lines 1–98)” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about two sisters, one choice? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. Useful evidence: “Go thine own way; myself will bury him” (Prologue, line 70): Antigone, line 70. Theme link: The edict denies Polyneices the rites the gods require (no burial, no lament), so a human order collides with divine custom before Antigone acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Antigone call outside the gates at the start of the play?
   A. Her sister Ismene

B. Her brother Eteocles

C. The elders of Thebes

D. A palace guard

Key: A (Her sister Ismene)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has Creon's edict ordered for Polyneices?

A. That he be buried beside his father

B. That no one may bury or mourn him

C. That his body be sent back to Argos

D. That his name be struck from the city records

Key: B (That no one may bury or mourn him)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What penalty does the edict set for anyone who breaks it?

A. Exile from Thebes

B. A heavy fine paid in silver

C. Death by stoning

D. Loss of all family land

Key: C (Death by stoning)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Antigone's line: "No man shall say that I _____ a brother."

Key: betrayed

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who fled from Thebes in the night, according to Ismene?

A. The elders of the city

B. Creon's household guards

C. The priests of Zeus

D. The Argive army

Key: D (The Argive army)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Ismene refuse to help?

A. She is afraid to defy the ruler's power

B. She thinks Polyneices deserves no burial

C. She has promised to marry Creon's son

D. She plans to leave Thebes that night

Key: A (She is afraid to defy the ruler's power)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Antigone ask Ismene to do with the secret?

A. Keep it close and tell no one

B. Proclaim it to all the town

C. Tell only the elders of the city

D. Write it down for the priests

Key: B (Proclaim it to all the town)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Ismene's warning: “If thou succeed; but thou art doomed to _____.”

   Key: fail

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do the two sisters react differently to Creon's edict?

   Sample answer: Antigone decides at once to bury her brother, whatever the cost, and asks Ismene to help. Ismene is afraid: she reminds her sister of the ruin of their family and says that two women cannot fight the ruler's power. Antigone then refuses her help and says she will act alone.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Explain why Antigone says burying Polyneices would be an honourable death.

    Sample answer: Antigone believes the gods and the dead demand burial for a brother, so dying for that act would be dying for something right. She says the worst that can happen is to die an honourable death, and she expects to be commended by the dead. In her eyes, obeying the edict would be the real dishonour.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who does Antigone say will be buried with full honours?

    A. Eteocles
    B. Polyneices
    C. Menoeceus
    D. Oedipus

    Key: A (Eteocles)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which birds does Antigone say will feed on the unburied body?

    A. Eagles
    B. Kites
    C. Owls
    D. Swans

    Key: B (Kites)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's line: “I will go alone To lap my dearest brother in the _____.”

    Key: grave

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Ismene call the rule she would rather not overstep?

    A. The law of the hearth
    B. The will of the elders
    C. The golden mean
    D. The oath of the city

    Key: C (The golden mean)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone mean when she says Ismene must show “If thou art worthy of thy blood or base”?

    A. Ismene must prove she is truly Creon's niece
    B. Ismene must swear an oath on her family's blood
    C. Ismene must show she is braver than her brothers
    D. Ismene must prove her noble birth by acting

    Key: D (Ismene must prove her noble birth by acting)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Ismene speak of herself and Antigone as "weak women"?

    A. She argues they cannot fight the stronger men who rule

    B. She is mocking her sister for having so little courage to act

    C. She is repeating an insult Creon has used

    D. She wants the elders to take pity on them

    Key: A (She argues they cannot fight the stronger men who rule)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Antigone mean by calling herself "A sinless sinner"?

    A. She has done many wrongs that no one has seen

    B. Breaking the edict would be right in the gods' eyes

    C. She expects the city to forgive her quickly

    D. She is ashamed of what her brother did

    Key: B (Breaking the edict would be right in the gods' eyes)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the quick one-line exchanges near the end of the scene?

    A. They slow the scene into a calm prayer

    B. They show that the sisters now agree

    C. They sharpen the clash between the sisters

    D. They let a third speaker join the debate

    Key: C (They sharpen the clash between the sisters)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Ismene's phrase "I perforce obey The powers that be" reveal about her view of law?

    Sample answer: Ismene thinks the law of the ruler must be obeyed because it is backed by force, whatever she feels. She asks the dead to pardon her for giving way, which shows she believes the burial is right in itself. Her obedience comes from fear and weakness, not from agreeing with Creon.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Antigone's view of the dead differ from her view of the living in the Prologue?

    Sample answer: Antigone says she will abide for ever with the dead and expects them to commend her, while the living matter less to her. She is willing to be banned awhile on earth if the dead approve. This shows that her loyalty runs first to family and the gods below, not to the city or its ruler.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Antigone call the decree "aimed At thee and me"?

    A. As sisters, they are the ones bound to bury him

    B. Creon has named both sisters in a public speech

    C. The guards have been told to watch their house

    D. Creon believes they helped the Argive army

    Key: A (As sisters, they are the ones bound to bury him)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Antigone's sarcasm in "our most noble Creon" suggest?

    A. Real respect for her uncle and for the way he governs

B. Contempt for the man who made the edict

C. Fear that Creon will hear of her plan

D. Hope that Creon will change his mind

Key: B (Contempt for the man who made the edict)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's question: "What right has he to keep me from my _____?"

Key: own

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone's demand that Ismene proclaim her plan reveal?

A. She hopes to be stopped before she acts

B. She does not trust the guards to report it

C. She wants her act to be open and public

D. She wants Ismene to join her in the punishment

Key: C (She wants her act to be open and public)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device is at work in "Sister and brother linked in love's embrace"?

A. Rhetorical question

B. Understatement

C. Apostrophe

D. Alliteration

Key: D (Alliteration)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Prologue shape the audience's expectations?

A. It sets a clear choice and a deadly penalty before Creon appears

B. It shows Creon explaining his edict to the city

C. It reveals at once how the conflict will end

D. It suggests that the sisters will soon agree

Key: A (It sets a clear choice and a deadly penalty before Creon appears)

27. [mc · synthesis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which pair of values does the Prologue set against each other?

A. Love of wealth against love of honour

B. Duty to family and the gods against obedience to the city

C. Courage in war against love of peace

D. Youth against the wisdom of old age

Key: B (Duty to family and the gods against obedience to the city)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze Ismene's list of family disasters (lines 49–56). How does it support her argument?

Sample answer: Ismene recalls her father's disgrace and blinding, their mother's death and the brothers who killed each other in one day. The list shows a family already ruined, and she argues that if the last two sisters defy the king they will perish wretchedest of all. The family history becomes a reason for caution rather than for action.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone mean when she says she will "hate thee more If thou proclaim it not"?

    Sample answer: Antigone rejects secrecy because hiding the act would treat it as shameful. She wants the burial to be known, as a public stand for what she thinks is right. Her words also turn her anger on Ismene, showing how completely the disagreement has divided them.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Ismene's claim that it is foolish to overstep the golden mean. Is her caution wise or weak?

    Sample answer: Ismene's caution can be called wise: she sees the danger and the power of the ruler, and she does not want to throw her life away. It can also be called weak, since she agrees the burial is right but will not act on it. A strong answer weighs both sides and supports its view with her own words or Antigone's replies.

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Ismene mean by "Thou hast a fiery soul for numbing work"?

    A. Antigone is passionate about a chilling, deadly task
    B. Antigone is too cold to feel grief for her brother
    C. Antigone works hard but has no real feeling
    D. Antigone's anger will soon cool down

    Key: A (Antigone is passionate about a chilling, deadly task)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's reply: "When strength shall fail me, yes, but not _____."

    Key: before

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of Antigone's word "disappointed" for Polyneices's lack of rites?

    A. It shows that he had fully expected to win the war and the throne
    B. It stresses that he was denied what was owed him
    C. It suggests that the gods are angry with Creon
    D. It means that Polyneices has been forgotten

    Key: B (It stresses that he was denied what was owed him)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does Antigone add "if report speak true" when describing the edict?

    A. She believes the report is a lie
    B. She wants to mock the city's heralds
    C. She has heard it only by report so far
    D. She plans to ask Creon whether it is true

    Key: C (She has heard it only by report so far)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Ismene's closing couplet ("Yet to thy lovers thou art dear as ever") change the tone of the scene?

    A. It turns the scene into open mockery
    B. It warns that the gods will punish her
    C. It shows that Ismene has changed her mind
    D. It ends the quarrel with loyal love

Key: D (It ends the quarrel with loyal love)

36. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the Prologue's role in the play?

    A. It sets up the clash of city law and family duty

    B. It explains in full how the war began

    C. It shows the elders' first reactions to Creon

    D. It gives the audience Creon's reasons for the edict

    Key: A (It sets up the clash of city law and family duty)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone's rejection of Ismene's later help (lines 68–70) shape her character from the start?

    Sample answer: Antigone says that even if Ismene were willing now, she would not welcome such a fellowship. She judges quickly and absolutely, treating any hesitation as betrayal. From the start she is shown as fiercely principled and alone in her choice, which makes her both admirable and hard.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the paradox in “How sweet to die in such employ”.

    Sample answer: Antigone calls dying sweet, which runs against ordinary feeling. For her the act of burial is so right that death in doing it becomes a reward, joining her to her brother and the dead she loves. The paradox shows the depth of her conviction and warns the audience how far she will go.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the sisters' ideas of what makes a person noble in the Prologue.

    Sample answer: For Antigone, nobility means acting for family and the gods even at the cost of life, and she tests Ismene on whether she is worthy of her blood. For Ismene, wisdom means knowing one's weakness and not overstepping the golden mean. One sees courage in defiance, the other sense in submission, and the play sets the two views side by side.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how fairly the Prologue presents Ismene. Is she a coward or a voice of reason?

    Sample answer: The scene gives Ismene real arguments: the family's past ruin, the power of the ruler and the danger to two women alone. She still loves her sister and keeps the secret. Yet she agrees the burial is right and does nothing, which Antigone calls a pretext. A strong answer takes a position and supports it with lines from both sisters.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–98) develops the idea of two sisters, one choice. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–98)" could deliver about two sisters, one choice. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for two sisters, one choice in "Prologue (lines 1–98)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (lines 1–98) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of two sisters, one choice. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–98)" could deliver about two sisters, one choice. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for two sisters, one choice in "Prologue (lines 1–98)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Prologue (lines 1–98) suggests about two sisters, one choice. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–98)" could deliver about two sisters, one choice. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for two sisters, one choice in "Prologue (lines 1–98)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Prologue (lines 1–98) to complicate the reader's understanding of two sisters, one choice. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–98)" could deliver about two sisters, one choice. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for two sisters, one choice in "Prologue (lines 1–98)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Ismene, sister of my blood and heart, See'st thou how Zeus would in our lives fulfil The weird of Oedipus, a world of woes! For what of pain, affliction, outrage, shame, Is lacking in our fortunes, thine and mine? And now this proclamation of today Made by our Captain-General to the State, What can its purport be? Didst hear and heed, Or art thou deaf when friends are banned as foes? To me, Antigone, no word of friends Has come, or glad or grievous, since we twain Were reft of our two brethren in one day By double fratricide; and since i' the night Our Argive leaguers fled, no later news Has reached me, to inspirit or deject.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–98)"?

   A. A hymn of thanks for a battle already won

   B. A catalog of human skills and inventions

   C. A list of earlier Theban kings in exile

   D. Two sisters, one choice

SAT key: 1. D (Two sisters, one choice)

Lesson 3: Parodos (lines 99–154)

Focus: the city's victory song

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Parodos (lines 99–154)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

At sunrise the Chorus of Theban elders celebrates the defeat of the Argive army led by Polyneices. They describe Zeus striking down a boastful attacker with lightning and call for dancing and thanks to the gods.

Background: The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) recalls the war of the Seven against Thebes, a famous myth also staged by Aeschylus.

Significance: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....*
> **Prompt:** Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city’s victory even before Creon speaks his human edict.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)**
> Six key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: braggart — a person who boasts loudly; paean — a song of triumph or thanksgiving; argent — silver in color; pinions — a bird’s wings; impious — showing no respect for the gods; revels — joyful noisy celebrations. “braggart”: Origin: Middle French bragard (“bragging”).*
> **Words:** braggart: a person who boasts loudly · paean: a song of triumph or thanksgiving · argent: silver in color · pinions: a bird’s wings · impious: showing no respect for the gods · revels: joyful noisy celebrations

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) recalls the war of the Seven against Thebes, a famous myth also staged by Aeschylus. The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Imagery: The Parodos fills the night battle with fire, towers and a "forkèd lightning blaze," so the city's rescue is felt as something seen and heard, not only told. Structure: The entrance song turns from the war just won to Creon's summons, so celebration and the new king's law arrive in one breath. Tone / mood: The elders' voice is triumphant and grateful, but Zeus's strike on the "braggart's boast" already sounds a warning against pride. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The song celebrates a saved city and says nothing yet of Polyneices's body, so the burial crisis waits just outside the hymn of thanks.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" slowly and put it in my own words: the Chorus says Zeus hates proud boasting, saw the gold-clad Argive army, and struck it with lightning just as the attackers raised a victory hymn. Next, craft. "Braggart's boast" and "gold-bespangled host" paint the enemy as proud and showy, and the paean is cut off by "forkèd lightning blaze," so celebration turns into punishment in one breath. The strongest word is "lightning": it cuts the paean short and turns the victory hymn into a blow. Then, effect. What do lines 119–122 reveal about the city's victory song? My answer: The elders celebrate a rescue that came just in time. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) already names the kind of pride the city's victory song condemns in the defeated host.

> *For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze (Parodos, lines 119–122)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" slowly and put it in my own words: the Chorus says Zeus hates proud boasting, saw the gold-clad Argive army, and struck it with lightning just as the attackers raised a victory hymn. Next, craft. "Braggart's boast" and "gold-bespangled host" paint the enemy as proud and showy, and the paean is cut off by "forkèd lightning blaze," so celebration turns into punishment in one breath. The strongest word is "lightning": it cuts the paean short and turns the victory hymn into a blow. Then, effect. What do lines 119–122 reveal about the city's victory song? My answer: The elders celebrate a rescue that came just in time. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) already names the kind of pride the city's victory song condemns in the defeated host.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Torch", "crown of towers" and "panic-struck" stand out. The city is pictured as crowned with towers that the enemy never got to burn, so the elders celebrate a rescue that came just in time. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. (Chorus, lines 115–118.)

> *But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear (Parodos, lines 115–118)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Torch", "crown of towers" and "panic-struck" stand out in lines 115–118. The city is pictured as crowned with towers that the enemy never got to burn, and Ares is heard as a panic in their rear, so the elders celebrate a rescue that came just in time. The wording turns almost-ruin into thanksgiving.
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes before a human torch could burn the "crown of towers" (lines 115–118), so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. (Chorus, lines 115–118.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the city's victory song? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 99–154) develops the idea of the city's victory song. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. When the text says “For Zeus who hates the braggart’s boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze” (Parodos, lines 119–122), it shows this directly. At sunrise the Chorus of Theban elders celebrates the defeat of the Argive army led by Polyneices. They describe Zeus striking down a boastful attacker with lightning and call for dancing and thanks to the gods.

Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the city's victory song? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 99–154) develops the idea of the city's victory song. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. When the text says “For Zeus who hates the braggart’s boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze” (Parodos, lines 119–122), it shows this directly. At sunrise the Chorus of Theban elders celebrates the defeat of the Argive army led by Polyneices. They describe Zeus striking down a boastful attacker with lightning and call for dancing and thanks to the gods.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved? Ask: Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved?

Anchor question: Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved?

Facilitation: Ask: Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the city's victory song? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. ("For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise", Parodos, lines 119–122). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the city's victory song? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. ("For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise", Parodos, lines 119–122). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the city's victory song. Key takeaway: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The Parodos fills the night battle with fire, towers and a "forkèd lightning blaze," so the city's rescue is felt as something seen and heard, not only told.
- **Structure:** The entrance song turns from the war just won to Creon's summons, so celebration and the new king's law arrive in one breath.
- **Tone / mood:** The elders' voice is triumphant and grateful, but Zeus's strike on the "braggart's boast" already sounds a warning against pride.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The song celebrates a saved city and says nothing yet of Polyneices's body, so the burial crisis waits just outside the hymn of thanks.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122) Chorus, lines 119–122.
- "But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear" (Parodos, lines 115–118) Chorus, lines 115–118.
- "Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon / Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray" (Parodos, lines 99–100) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play.
Evidence: "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122)
Reasoning: At sunrise the Chorus of Theban elders celebrates the defeat of the Argive army led by Polyneices. They describe Zeus striking down a boastful attacker with lightning and call for dancing and thanks to the gods.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 99–100
99 **Chorus:** Sunbeam, of all that ever dawn upon
100 **Chorus:** Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray,

Lines 99–103
99 **Chorus:** Sunbeam, of all that ever dawn upon
100 **Chorus:** Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray,
101 **Chorus:** O eye of golden day,
102 **Chorus:** How fair thy light o'er Dircè's fountain shone,
103 **Chorus:** Speeding upon their headlong homeward course,

Lines 99–112
99 **Chorus:** Sunbeam, of all that ever dawn upon
100 **Chorus:** Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray,
101 **Chorus:** O eye of golden day,
102 **Chorus:** How fair thy light o'er Dircè's fountain shone,
103 **Chorus:** Speeding upon their headlong homeward course,
104 **Chorus:** Far quicker than they came, the Argive force;
105 **Chorus:** Putting to flight
106 **Chorus:** The argent shields, the host with scutcheons white.
107 **Chorus:** Against our land the proud invader came
108 **Chorus:** To vindicate fell Polyneices' claim.
109 **Chorus:** Like to an eagle swooping low,

110 **Chorus:** On pinions white as new fall'n snow,
111 **Chorus:** With clanging scream, a horsetail plume his crest,
112 **Chorus:** The aspiring lord of Argos onward pressed.

Lines 109–112
109 **Chorus:** Like to an eagle swooping low,
110 **Chorus:** On pinions white as new fall'n snow,
111 **Chorus:** With clanging scream, a horsetail plume his crest,
112 **Chorus:** The aspiring lord of Argos onward pressed.

Lines 115–118
115 **Chorus:** But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn,
116 **Chorus:** Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn
117 **Chorus:** Forced by the Dragon; in their rear
118 **Chorus:** The din of Ares panic-struck they hear.

Line 119
119 **Chorus:** For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast

Lines 119–122
119 **Chorus:** For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast
120 **Chorus:** Beheld that gold-bespangled host;
121 **Chorus:** As at the goal the paean they upraise,
122 **Chorus:** He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze.

Lines 131–134
131 **Chorus:** Seven captains at our seven gates
132 **Chorus:** Thundered; for each a champion waits,
133 **Chorus:** Each left behind his armour bright,
134 **Chorus:** Trophy for Zeus who turns the fight;

Lines 135–144
135 **Chorus:** Save two alone, that ill-starred pair
136 **Chorus:** One mother to one father bare,
137 **Chorus:** Who lance in rest, one 'gainst the other
138 **Chorus:** Drave, and both perished, brother slain by brother.
139 **Chorus:** Now Victory to Thebes returns again
140 **Chorus:** And smiles upon her chariot-circled plain.
141 **Chorus:** Now let feast and festal shout
142 **Chorus:** Memories of war blot out.
143 **Chorus:** Let us to the temples throng,
144 **Chorus:** Dance and sing the live night long.

Lines 141–146
141 **Chorus:** Now let feast and festal shout
142 **Chorus:** Memories of war blot out.

Chorus: Let us to the temples throng,
Chorus: Dance and sing the live night long.
Chorus: God of Thebes, lead thou the round,
Chorus: Bacchus, shaker of the ground!

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
braggart (noun)	a person who boasts loudly	*For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast Beheld that gold-bespangled host; As at the goal the paean they upraise, He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze.*	"braggart": Origin: Middle French bragard ("bragging"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/braggart#Etymology)
paean (noun)	a song of triumph or thanksgiving	*As at the goal the paean they upraise,*	
argent (adjective)	silver in color	*The argent shields, the host with scutcheons white.*	
pinions (noun)	a bird's wings	*On pinions white as new fall'n snow,*	
impious (adjective)	showing no respect for the gods	*The fire-brand from his impious hand was dashed,*	
revels (noun)	joyful noisy celebrations	*Let us end our revels here; / Lo! Creon our new lord draws near,*	

Discussion questions

1. Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with family and the State?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What image does the Chorus use for Zeus' punishment? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His "forkèd lightning blaze."
   Answer guidance: His "forkèd lightning blaze."

2. To what bird is the lord of Argos compared in lines 109–112? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** An eagle swooping low on pinions white as new-fallen snow, with a clanging scream and a horsetail plume.
   Answer guidance: An eagle swooping low on pinions white as new-fallen snow, with a clanging scream and a horsetail plume.
3. What happened at the seven gates, according to lines 131–134? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Seven captains attacked, each met a Theban champion, and each left his bright armour as a trophy for Zeus.
   Answer guidance: Seven captains attacked, each met a Theban champion, and each left his bright armour as a trophy for Zeus.
4. How do the elders want to mark the victory in lines 141–146? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** With feasting and festal shouts, crowding to the temples and dancing all night with Bacchus leading the round.
   Answer guidance: With feasting and festal shouts, crowding to the temples and dancing all night with Bacchus leading the round.
5. What are the elders celebrating? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The defeat of the attacking army
   Answer guidance: The defeat of the attacking army.
6. What does Zeus do to the boastful attacker? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Strikes him with lightning
   Answer guidance: Strikes him with lightning.
7. What does Zeus hate, according to line 119? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A braggart's boast
   Answer guidance: A braggart's boast.
8. What is the mood of the Parodos? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Triumphant and thankful
   Answer guidance: Triumphant and thankful.
9. What does the Parodos foreshadow? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The punishment of pride
   Answer guidance: The punishment of pride.
10. Retell the most important events of "Parodos (lines 99–154)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At sunrise the Chorus of Theban elders celebrates the defeat of the Argive army led by Polyneices. They describe Zeus striking down a boastful attacker with lightning and call for dancing and thanks to the gods.
    Answer guidance: At sunrise the Chorus of Theban elders celebrates the defeat of the Argive army led by Polyneices. They describe Zeus striking down a boastful attacker with lightning and call for dancing and thanks to the gods.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Sophocles open the choral songs with victory? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Public joy set against private conflict still to come, with a locator in the Parodos.
   Answer guidance: Sophocles opens the choral songs with public joy—the rescue of the seven-gated city

and thanks to Zeus (lines 115–122, 139–146)—so the private quarrel of the Prologue and the edict that follows stand out more sharply against a city that wants to "blot out" memories of war (lines 141–142).

2. What does "Parodos (lines 99–154)" suggest about the city's victory song? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play.
   Answer guidance: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Evidence to accept: "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122): Chorus, lines 119–122. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of imagery in "Parodos (lines 99–154)". What does it reveal about the city's victory song that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: "But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear" (Parodos, lines 115–118): Chorus, lines 115–118. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the structure in "Parodos (lines 99–154)" shape what we understand about the city's victory song? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122): Chorus, lines 119–122. On structure: The entrance song turns from the war just won to Creon's summons, so celebration and the new king's law arrive in one breath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray, O eye of golden day, How fair thy light o'er Dircè's fountain shone, Speeding upon their headlong…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon / Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray" (Parodos, lines 99–100): Chorus, in this part of the section. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in "Parodos (lines 99–154)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the Argive army's flight from the seven gates; the two brothers who killed each other; the effect, a victory song that turns to Creon's summons.
   Answer guidance: Look for: the Argive army's flight from the seven gates; the two brothers who killed each other; the effect, a victory song that turns to Creon's summons. Evidence to accept: "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He

struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122): Chorus, lines 119–122. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Parodos (lines 99–154)" build on "Prologue (lines 1–98)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear" (Parodos, lines 115–118): Chorus, lines 115–118. On structure: The entrance song turns from the war just won to Creon's summons, so celebration and the new king's law arrive in one breath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Parodos (lines 99–154)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the city's victory song, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon / Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray" (Parodos, lines 99–100): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can a victory celebration hide problems that are not yet solved?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear" (Parodos, lines 115–118): Chorus, lines 115–118. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in "Parodos (lines 99–154)", and how does it connect the city's victory song to the larger concern with family and the State? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122): Chorus, lines 119–122. On tone / mood: The elders' voice is triumphant and grateful, but Zeus's strike on the "braggart's boast" already sounds a warning against pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the Parodos warn Creon as much as it praises the city? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. Creon is called king 'by this strange chance.' Is that a good or a bad sign for his rule? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
3. Is it right for the city to celebrate while the two brothers lie dead? Argue with lines 135–144. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: “But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear” (Parodos, lines 115–118): Chorus, lines 115–118. Theme link: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city’s victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Which character in “Parodos (lines 99–154)” acts most wisely in the matter of the city's victory song, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: “Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon / Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray” (Parodos, lines 99–100): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city’s victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. You are directing “Parodos (lines 99–154)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the city's victory song. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: “For Zeus who hates the braggart’s boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the

goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122): Chorus, lines 119–122. On structure: The entrance song turns from the war just won to Creon's summons, so celebration and the new king's law arrive in one breath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Parodos (lines 99–154)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear" (Parodos, lines 115–118): Chorus, lines 115–118. Theme link: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Parodos (lines 99–154)", with its focus on the city's victory song, to pride and stubbornness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon / Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray" (Parodos, lines 99–100): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city's victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the imagery in "Parodos (lines 99–154)" effective in presenting the city's victory song, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: "For Zeus who hates the braggart's boast / Beheld that gold-bespangled host; / As at the goal the paean they upraise, / He struck them with his forkèd lightning blaze" (Parodos, lines 119–122): Chorus, lines 119–122. On imagery: The Parodos fills the night battle with fire, towers and a "forkèd lightning blaze," so the city's rescue is felt as something seen and heard, not only told. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how "Parodos (lines 99–154)" treats the city's victory song with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city celebrates while the play's real conflict is just

beginning. Zeus punishing a "braggart's boast" (line 119) foreshadows the fall of pride later in the play. Useful evidence: “But ere a torch our crown of towers could burn, / Ere they had tasted of our blood, they turn / Forced by the Dragon; in their rear / The din of Ares panic-struck they hear” (Parodos, lines 115–118): Chorus, lines 115–118. Theme link: The elders thank the gods for saving Thebes, so divine power underwrites the city’s victory even before Creon speaks his human edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What time of day is it when the Chorus enters?
   A. Sunrise
   B. Midnight
   C. Noon
   D. Dusk

   Key: A (Sunrise)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which army has just fled from Thebes?
   A. The Athenian fleet
   B. The Argive army
   C. The Persian host
   D. The Corinthian guard

   Key: B (The Argive army)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what bird does the Chorus compare the invading lord of Argos?
   A. A raven
   B. A vulture
   C. An eagle
   D. A hawk

   Key: C (An eagle)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “O eye of golden _____”

   Key: day
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what does the Chorus compare great Ares in the battle?
   A. A lion
   B. A storm wind
   C. A wolf
   D. A war-horse

Key: D (A war-horse)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How many captains attacked the city's gates?

   A. Seven

   B. Three

   C. Twelve

   D. Two

   Key: A (Seven)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the Chorus call for now that the war is over?

   A. A day of silent mourning for all the fallen

   B. Feasting and dancing in the temples

   C. A new attack on Argos

   D. The building of higher walls

   Key: B (Feasting and dancing in the temples)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Chorus say Zeus struck the attacker?

   A. The attacker had robbed his temple

   B. The attacker was Zeus's old enemy

   C. Zeus hates a braggart's boast

   D. The Theban priests begged him to

   Key: C (Zeus hates a braggart's boast)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What is the mood of the Chorus's entrance song?

   Sample answer: The mood is joyful and triumphant. The elders greet the sunrise, celebrate the flight of the Argive army and call for dancing and feasting through the night. Only at the end does the mood change, when they wonder why their new lord has summoned them.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Why does the Chorus end its song by asking why Creon has called them?

    Sample answer: The elders have been summoned by the new king to debate some grave concern of State, and they do not yet know what it is. Their questions turn the scene from celebration to uncertainty. The ending prepares the audience for Creon's arrival and what he will say.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which spring does the Chorus say the sunlight shone upon?

    A. Dircè's fountain

    B. The springs of Castaly

    C. The river Ismenus

    D. The sea at Aulis

    Key: A (Dircè's fountain)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “The din of _____ panic-struck they hear.”

    Key: Ares

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What colour are the shields of the invading army?

    A. Black

    B. White

C. Red

D. Gold

Key: B (White)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say each captain left behind at the gates?

A. His horse and chariot as a gift to the city

B. His sons as hostages

C. His armour as a trophy for Zeus

D. His spear in the city wall

Key: C (His armour as a trophy for Zeus)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Chorus call the two brothers “that ill-starred pair”?

A. They served opposite gods and died for them

B. They were captured by the enemy

C. They fled from the battle together

D. They were brothers who killed each other

Key: D (They were brothers who killed each other)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of the city's “crown of towers” suggest?

A. Thebes is proud and royal, ringed with defences

B. Thebes has a king who wears a tower crown

C. Thebes is a city of temples and priests

D. Thebes has been burned to the ground

Key: A (Thebes is proud and royal, ringed with defences)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the Chorus picture the fallen attacker before he crashes to earth?

A. As a hungry wolf creeping slowly toward the gates

B. As a Bacchic reveller breathing hate and flame

C. As a ship driven onto the rocks

D. As a tree cut down by an axe

Key: B (As a Bacchic reveller breathing hate and flame)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What contrast does the Chorus draw in describing the Argives' retreat?

A. They came at night but fled in the day

B. They came in ships but fled on foot

C. They came slowly but fled faster than they came

D. They came as friends but fled as foes

Key: C (They came slowly but fled faster than they came)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Chorus show that the gods fought on the side of Thebes?

Sample answer: The elders say the Argives turned back forced by the Dragon and hearing the din of Ares, and that Zeus

struck down the boastful attacker with lightning. Each captain's armour is left as a trophy for Zeus who turns the fight. The victory is presented as the work of the gods as much as of the Theban spearmen.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Explain how the entrance song prepares the audience for Creon's first speech.

    Sample answer: The song celebrates the city's safety and names the two brothers who died fighting each other. It ends by naming Creon as the new lord, crowned by this strange chance, and asking why he has called the elders. The audience now knows the background of war and is ready to hear how the new king will treat the dead.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “Crowned by this strange chance” suggest about how Creon became king?

    A. He gained the throne through the brothers' deaths

    B. He won the crown in an athletic contest

    C. He was chosen by an oracle at Delphi

    D. He took power in a revolt

    Key: A (He gained the throne through the brothers' deaths)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “Dance and sing the live _____ long.”

    Key: night

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus imply by calling the attacker's hand impious?

    A. He refused to pray before the battle

    B. He made war on the gods' own city and shrines

    C. He had killed a priest of Apollo

    D. He had broken a treaty with Argos

    Key: B (He made war on the gods' own city and shrines)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of the phrase “brother slain by brother”?

    A. It celebrates the brothers' courage

    B. It suggests the brothers were enemies of Zeus

    C. It stresses the horror of kin killing kin

    D. It shows that the war is not over

    Key: C (It stresses the horror of kin killing kin)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device does the Chorus use in addressing the sunbeam as an eye of golden day?

    A. Irony

    B. Understatement

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Apostrophe

    Key: D (Apostrophe)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Parodos reflect the role of the Chorus in Greek tragedy?

    A. It speaks for the city and reacts to events

B. It acts out the whole battle on stage for the audience

C. It argues with the king about the war

D. It tells the audience how the play will end

Key: A (It speaks for the city and reacts to events)

27. [mc · synthesis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What view of pride does the Parodos present?

A. Pride is the source of a city's strength

B. The gods humble those who boast

C. Pride belongs only to kings and heroes

D. Pride is forgiven when a war is won

Key: B (The gods humble those who boast)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the image of the eagle (lines 109–112) presents the Argive attacker.

Sample answer: The attacker is pictured as an eagle swooping low on wings white as snow, with a clanging scream and a horsetail plume. The image makes him fierce, proud and dangerous, a hunter descending on prey. This makes his sudden fall more striking and shows the gods humbling the proud.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does the Chorus give only two lines to the brothers in a song about victory?

Sample answer: The brothers' deaths are the one dark note in a song of joy. The Chorus gives them only two lines—"Save two alone, that ill-starred pair … both perished, brother slain by brother" (lines 135–138)—and then calls Victory back and asks that "Memories of war blot out" (lines 139–142). That brevity shows a city eager to forget the war and celebrate, yet it also leaves the question of the brothers open for Creon's edict.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the Chorus's joy in the Parodos is fully justified.

Sample answer: The joy is justified in that the city has been saved from a real danger. Yet the victory has come at the cost of two brothers of the royal house, and a new king has taken power by chance. A strong answer weighs the celebration against these losses and supports its view with lines from the song.

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by "Forced by the Dragon"?

A. Driven back by the might of Thebes

B. Chased by a real monster

C. Burned by a fire-breathing beast

D. Frightened by an evil sign in the sky

Key: A (Driven back by the might of Thebes)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Bacchus, shaker of the _____!"

Key: ground

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus say the attacker came "Outbreathing hate and flame"?

A. To show that he was really a god in disguise

B. To show his violent, destructive fury

C. To show he was sick with fever

D. To show he was singing a hymn

Key: B (To show his violent, destructive fury)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which theme of the play is first suggested by the Parodos's account of the brothers?

    A. Love that overcomes all enemies and every hatred

    B. The wisdom of old age

    C. Family bonds turned to deadly conflict

    D. The power of money to corrupt

    Key: C (Family bonds turned to deadly conflict)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Parodos's form differ from the Prologue's?

    A. It is spoken by a single actor alone

    B. It is written in prose

    C. It has no rhythm or rhyme at all

    D. It is a sung choral ode rather than spoken dialogue

    Key: D (It is a sung choral ode rather than spoken dialogue)

36. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about the Chorus's call to blot out memories of war?

    A. The war's dead will soon cause new conflict

    B. The elders have not seen a war in many years

    C. The city has actually lost the war

    D. The god of war is their patron

    Key: A (The war's dead will soon cause new conflict)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the Parodos uses light imagery, from “Sunbeam” to the “fire-brand”.

    Sample answer: The song opens with the sunbeam, the brightest ray, shining on Thebes as the enemy flees; light means safety and victory. The attacker's fire-brand and the lightning of Zeus are destructive light, one threatening the city, the other punishing him. The imagery separates the light that blesses the city from the fire that destroys the proud.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Parodos present Zeus, and why does this matter for the play?

    Sample answer: Zeus is shown as the god who hates the braggart's boast and strikes the proud with lightning. He is the protector of the city and the punisher of pride. This sets up a standard by which later characters, including Creon, can be judged: the gods humble those who boast.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Compare the way the Chorus treats the attacker and the two brothers.

    Sample answer: The attacker is described at length, as an eagle, a reveller and a figure of hate struck down by Zeus. The brothers get only two lines, named as one mother's sons who killed each other. The Chorus enjoys the enemy's fall but passes quickly over the family tragedy, showing its wish to forget the painful cost of victory.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate the Parodos as an opening for the Chorus's role in the play.

    Sample answer: The song shows the elders as loyal citizens who celebrate the city's safety and trust the gods. It also shows them eager to forget, and uncertain of their new king. A strong answer judges how this sets up their later wavering between Creon and Antigone, using lines from the song.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Parodos (lines 99–154) develops the idea of the city's victory song. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 99–154)" could deliver about the city's victory song. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the city's victory song in "Parodos (lines 99–154)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Parodos (lines 99–154) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the city's victory song. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 99–154)" could deliver about the city's victory song. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the city's victory song in "Parodos (lines 99–154)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Parodos (lines 99–154) suggests about the city's victory song. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 99–154)" could deliver about the city's victory song. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the city's victory song in "Parodos (lines 99–154)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Parodos (lines 99–154) to complicate the reader's understanding of the city's victory song. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 99–154)" could deliver about the city's victory song. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the city's victory song in "Parodos (lines 99–154)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Sunbeam, of all that ever dawned upon Our seven-gated Thebes the brightest ray, O eye of golden day, How fair thy light o'er Dircè's fountain shone, Speeding upon their headlong homeward course, Far quicker than they came, the Argive force; Putting to flight The argent shields, the host with scutcheons white. Against our land the proud invader came To vindicate fell Polyneices' claim. Like to an eagle swooping low, On pinions white as new fall'n snow, With clanging scream, a horsetail plume his crest, The aspiring lord of Argos onward pressed.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 99–154)"?

   A. A private quarrel between the two sisters

   B. A claim that the Argive host has taken all seven gates

   C. A catalog of earlier Theban kings

   D. The city's victory song

SAT key: 1. D (The city's victory song)

Lesson 4: Episode 1 (lines 155–323)

Focus: Creon's first speech and the Guard

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Creon, the new king, explains to the elders that loyalty to the State comes before friendship, and that the traitor Polyneices will not be buried. A frightened Guard reports that someone has sprinkled dust on the body. Creon suspects bribery and threatens the guards.

Background: Creon's speech echoes Athenian ideas about the city as a ship whose safety comes first. Burial "with dust" was a symbolic rite enough to satisfy the gods.

Significance: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....
Prompt: Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context.
Today's words: miscreants — wrongdoers; villains; patriots — people devoted to their country; convened — called together for a meeting; unburied — left without a grave or funeral rites; interred — placed in a grave; precedence — the right to be ranked first.
Words: miscreants: wrongdoers; villains · patriots: people devoted to their country · convened: called together for a meeting · unburied: left without a grave or funeral rites · interred: placed in a grave · precedence: the right to be ranked first

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Creon's speech echoes Athenian ideas about the city as a ship whose safety comes first. Burial "with dust" was a symbolic rite enough to satisfy the gods. Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Characterization: Creon argues like a practical ruler who puts the "good ship" of the State first; the Guard's comic fear shows how that rigidity already frightens ordinary men. Irony: Creon swears he will never shelter a public foe, while the audience knows the "foe" who has just been buried is his own niece acting from piety. Conflict: The first clash is not yet Antigone versus Creon face to face, but an unseen burial against a new king's law, reported by a terrified Guard. Watch for burial and the unburied body: A light covering of "thirsty dust" counts as burial, so the smallest ritual gesture is enough to break Creon's edict and honour the gods.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" slowly and put it in my own words: Creon swears by Zeus that he will speak out against any plot to weaken the State, and he will not treat a public enemy as a private friend, because the State is the ship that carries everyone's fortune. Next, craft. The ship image makes loyalty to the city sound like a rule of safety, and "Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" puts the public bond above every private one. The strongest word is "ship": it makes the State the vessel that holds every private fortune. Then, effect. What do lines 175–182 reveal about Creon's first speech and the Guard? My answer: Creon's principle sounds measured at first, but it is already rigid. The Guard's later fear in this episode shows what that rigidity does to ordinary people who serve him.

> *For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck* *(Episode 1, lines 175–182)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" slowly and put it in my own words: Creon swears by Zeus that he will speak out against any plot to weaken the State, and he will not treat a public enemy as a private friend, because the State is the ship that carries everyone's fortune. Next, craft. The ship image makes loyalty to the city sound like a rule of safety, and "Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" puts the public bond above every private one. The strongest word is "ship": it makes the State the vessel that holds every private fortune. Then, effect. What do lines 175–182 reveal about Creon's first speech and the Guard? My answer: Creon's principle sounds measured at first, but it is already rigid. The Guard's later fear in this episode shows what that rigidity does to ordinary people who serve him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Besprinkled", "thirsty dust" and "proper ritual" stand out. A light covering of dust was enough to count as burial, so the Guard's news means the edict has already been defied. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. (Guard, lines 238–240.)

> *Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone (Episode 1, lines 238–240)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Besprinkled", "thirsty dust" and "proper ritual" stand out in lines 238–240. A light covering of dust was enough to count as burial, so the Guard's news means the edict has already been defied. "Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" makes the rite look brief, exact, and already finished.
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. (Guard, lines 238–240.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Creon's first speech and the Guard? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 155–323) develops the idea of Creon's first speech and the Guard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. When the text says "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" (Episode 1, lines 175–182), it shows this directly. Creon, the new king, explains to the elders that loyalty to the State comes before friendship, and that the traitor Polyneices will not be buried. A frightened Guard reports that someone has sprinkled dust on the body. Creon suspects bribery and threatens the guards.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Creon's first speech and the Guard? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 155–323) develops the idea of Creon's first speech and the Guard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. When the text says "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" (Episode 1, lines 175–182), it shows this directly. Creon, the new king, explains to the elders that loyalty to the State comes before friendship, and that the traitor Polyneices will not be buried. A frightened Guard reports that someone has sprinkled dust on the body. Creon suspects bribery and threatens the guards.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family? Ask: Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family?

Anchor question: Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family?

Facilitation: Ask: Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Creon's first speech and the Guard? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. ("For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue", Episode 1, lines 175–182). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Creon's first speech and the Guard? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. ("For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue", Episode 1, lines 175–182). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Creon's first speech and the Guard. Key takeaway: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Creon argues like a practical ruler who puts the "good ship" of the State first; the Guard's comic fear shows how that rigidity already frightens ordinary men.
- **Irony:** Creon swears he will never shelter a public foe, while the audience knows the "foe" who has just been buried is his own niece acting from piety.
- **Conflict:** The first clash is not yet Antigone versus Creon face to face, but an unseen burial against a new king's law, reported by a terrified Guard.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** A light covering of "thirsty dust" counts as burial, so the smallest ritual gesture is enough to break Creon's edict and honour the gods.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" (Episode 1, lines 175–182) Creon, lines 175–182.
- "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240) Guard, lines 238–240.
- "Of evils current upon earth / The worst is money" (Episode 1, lines 286–287) Creon, lines 286–287.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler.
Evidence: "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend / A public foe, well knowing that the State / Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all: / Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck" (Episode 1, lines 175–182)
Reasoning: Creon, the new king, explains to the elders that loyalty to the State comes before friendship, and that the traitor Polyneices will not be buried. A frightened Guard reports that someone has sprinkled dust on the body. Creon suspects bribery and threatens the guards.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 155–156
155 **Creon:** Elders, the gods have righted once again
156 **Creon:** Our storm-tossed ship of state, now safe in port.

Lines 155–166
155 **Creon:** Elders, the gods have righted once again
156 **Creon:** Our storm-tossed ship of state, now safe in port.
157 **Creon:** But you by special summons I convened
158 **Creon:** As my most trusted councillors; first, because
159 **Creon:** I knew you loyal to Laius of old;
160 **Creon:** Again, when Oedipus restored our State,
161 **Creon:** Both while he ruled and when his rule was o'er,
162 **Creon:** Ye still were constant to the royal line.
163 **Creon:** Now that his two sons perished in one day,
164 **Creon:** Brother by brother murderously slain,
165 **Creon:** By right of kinship to the Princes dead,
166 **Creon:** I claim and hold the throne and sovereignty.

Line 169
169 **Creon:** Till he be proved by exercise of power;

Lines 175–182

175 **Creon:** Before his country. For myself, I call
176 **Creon:** To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere,
177 **Creon:** If I perceive some mischievous design
178 **Creon:** To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue;
179 **Creon:** Nor would I reckon as my private friend
180 **Creon:** A public foe, well knowing that the State
181 **Creon:** Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all:
182 **Creon:** Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck.

Line 182

182 **Creon:** Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck.

Line 190

190 **Creon:** That are the guerdon of the heroic dead.

Line 210

210 **Creon:** Fear not, I've posted guards to watch the corpse.

Line 213

213 **Chorus:** No man is mad enough to court his death.

Lines 216–229

216 **Guard:** My lord, I will not make pretence to pant
217 **Guard:** And puff as some light-footed messenger.
218 **Guard:** In sooth my soul beneath its pack of thought
219 **Guard:** Made many a halt and turned and turned again;
220 **Guard:** For conscience plied her spur and curb by turns.
221 **Guard:** "Why hurry headlong to thy fate, poor fool?"
222 **Guard:** She whispered. Then again, "If Creon learn
223 **Guard:** This from another, thou wilt rue it worse."
224 **Guard:** Thus leisurely I hastened on my road;
225 **Guard:** Much thought extends a furlong to a league.
226 **Guard:** But in the end the forward voice prevailed,
227 **Guard:** To face thee. I will speak though I say nothing.
228 **Guard:** For plucking courage from despair methought,
229 **Guard:** "Let the worst hap, thou canst but meet thy fate."

Line 227

227 **Guard:** To face thee. I will speak though I say nothing.

Line 236

236 **Guard:** The bearer of dread tidings needs must quake.

Lines 238–240

238 **Guard:** Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone

239 **Guard:** E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust,
240 **Guard:** Performed the proper ritual—and was gone.

Line 273
273 **Creon:** I am like to think you dote in your old age.

Lines 286–287
286 **Creon:** By bribes. Of evils current upon earth
287 **Creon:** The worst is money. Money 'tis that sacks

Line 288
288 **Creon:** Cities, and drives men forth from hearth and home;

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
miscreants (noun)	wrongdoers; villains	*So am I purposed; never by my will Shall miscreants take precedence of true men, But all good patriots, alive or dead, Shall be by me preferred and honourèd.*
patriots (noun)	people devoted to their country	*So am I purposed; never by my will Shall miscreants take precedence of true men, But all good patriots, alive or dead, Shall be by me preferred and honourèd.*
convened (verb)	called together for a meeting	*But you by special summons I convened / As my most trusted councillors; first, because*
unburied (adjective)	left without a grave or funeral rites	*But leave his corpse unburied, to be meat*
interred (verb)	placed in a grave	*The corpse had vanished, not interred in earth,*
precedence (noun)	the right to be ranked first	*Shall miscreants take precedence of true men, / But all good patriots, alive or dead,*

Discussion questions

1. Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and stubbornness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Creon call "the worst" evil on earth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Money.
   Answer guidance: Money.
2. Why did Creon choose these elders as his councillors (lines 157–162)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They were loyal to Laius and stayed constant to the royal line under Oedipus and after.
   Answer guidance: They were loyal to Laius and stayed constant to the royal line under Oedipus and after.
3. What traces did the guards find at the body (lines 242–251)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** No mark of pick or mattock, no wheel rut and no sign of beasts; the corpse was only strewn with dust.
   Answer guidance: No mark of pick or mattock, no wheel rut and no sign of beasts; the corpse was only strewn with dust.
4. What did the guards offer to do to prove their innocence (lines 256–260)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To handle red-hot iron or pass through fire, swearing on oath that they neither did the deed nor knew who did.
   Answer guidance: To handle red-hot iron or pass through fire, swearing on oath that they neither did the deed nor knew who did.
5. What image does Creon use for the State in his first speech? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A ship that holds everyone's fortunes
   Answer guidance: A ship that holds everyone's fortunes.
6. What has the Guard come to report? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Someone has covered the body with dust
   Answer guidance: Someone has covered the body with dust.
7. Whom does Creon first suspect? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Malcontents who bribed the guards
   Answer guidance: Malcontents who bribed the guards.
8. Why is the Guard afraid to speak? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He fears Creon's anger
   Answer guidance: He fears Creon's anger.
9. What is ironic about Creon's speech on the State? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His rigid loyalty to the State will destroy his own family
   Answer guidance: His rigid loyalty to the State will destroy his own family.
10. Retell the most important events of “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Creon, the new king, explains to the elders that loyalty to the State comes before friendship, and that the traitor Polyneices will not be buried. A frightened Guard reports that someone has sprinkled dust on the body. Creon suspects bribery and threatens the guards.
    Answer guidance: Creon, the new king, explains to the elders that loyalty to the State comes before

friendship, and that the traitor Polyneices will not be buried. A frightened Guard reports that someone has sprinkled dust on the body. Creon suspects bribery and threatens the guards.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Creon assume the burial was done for money? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He cannot imagine a motive of duty or love; he thinks in terms of rebels and bribes.
   Answer guidance: He cannot imagine a motive of duty or love; he thinks in terms of rebels and bribes.
2. What does "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" suggest about Creon's first speech and the Guard? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler.
   Answer guidance: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Evidence to accept: "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend" (Episode 1, lines 175–182): Creon, lines 175–182. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of characterization in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)". What does it reveal about Creon's first speech and the Guard that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240): Guard, lines 238–240. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the irony in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" shape what we understand about Creon's first speech and the Guard? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend" (Episode 1, lines 175–182): Creon, lines 175–182. On irony: Creon swears he will never shelter a public foe, while the audience knows the "foe" who has just been buried is his own niece acting from piety. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Elders, the gods have righted once again Our storm-tossed ship of state, now safe in port.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Of evils current upon earth / The worst is money" (Episode 1, lines 286–287): Creon, lines 286–287. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Creon's rule that the State comes before friendship; the Guard's report that the body has been covered with dust; the effect, Creon's threats against the guards.
   Answer guidance: Look for: Creon's rule that the State comes before friendship; the Guard's report that the body has been covered with dust; the effect, Creon's threats against the guards. Evidence to accept: "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend" (Episode 1, lines 175–182): Creon, lines 175–182. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" build on "Parodos (lines 99–154)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240): Guard, lines 238–240. Theme link: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Creon's first speech and the Guard, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Of evils current upon earth / The worst is money" (Episode 1, lines 286–287): Creon, lines 286–287. On characterization: Creon argues like a practical ruler who puts the "good ship" of the State first; the Guard's comic fear shows how that rigidity already frightens ordinary men. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Should loyalty to your country always come before loyalty to family?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240): Guard, lines 238–240. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does conflict appear in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)", and how does it connect Creon's first speech and the Guard to the larger concern with pride and stubbornness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "For

myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend" (Episode 1, lines 175–182): Creon, lines 175–182. On conflict: The first clash is not yet Antigone versus Creon face to face, but an unseen burial against a new king's law, reported by a terrified Guard. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Creon's ship-of-state principle wise? Evaluate it with lines 175–182. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. Creon says a ruler who keeps silent out of fear is 'the basest of the base.' Does he live up to that standard here? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
3. Is the Guard a comic figure, a sympathetic one, or a mix? Argue with lines 216–229 and 319–323. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240): Guard, lines 238–240. Theme link: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Which character in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" acts most wisely in the matter of Creon's first speech and the Guard, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Of evils current upon earth / The worst is money" (Episode 1, lines 286–287): Creon, lines 286–287. On characterization: Creon argues like a practical ruler who puts the "good ship" of the State first; the Guard's comic fear shows how that rigidity already frightens ordinary men. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. You are directing "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Creon's first speech and the Guard.

[DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend" (Episode 1, lines 175–182): Creon, lines 175–182. Theme link: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240): Guard, lines 238–240. Theme link: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)", with its focus on Creon's first speech and the Guard, to gender and power: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Of evils current upon earth / The worst is money" (Episode 1, lines 286–287): Creon, lines 286–287. Theme link: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the characterization in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" effective in presenting Creon's first speech and the Guard, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "For myself, I call / To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere, / If I perceive some mischievous design / To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue; / Nor would I reckon as my private friend" (Episode 1, lines 175–182): Creon, lines 175–182. On characterization: Creon argues like a practical ruler who puts the "good ship" of the State first; the Guard's comic fear shows how that rigidity already frightens ordinary men. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" treats Creon's first speech and the Guard with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon's reasonable-sounding principle becomes rigid. The comic Guard lowers the tension but also shows how people fear a harsh ruler. Useful evidence: "Well, it must out; the corpse is buried; someone / E'en now besprinkled it with thirsty dust, / Performed the proper ritual—and was gone" (Episode 1, lines 238–240): Guard, lines 238–240. Theme link: Creon makes loyalty to the State outrank private friendship, while the dust on the body is already a quiet act of divine rite against that human rule. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Creon address at the start of his first speech?
    A. The elders
    B. The army of Argos
    C. His son and his wife
    D. The priests of Zeus

    Key: A (The elders)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] By what right does Creon claim the throne?
    A. Victory in single combat
    B. Kinship to the princes
    C. Election by the people
    D. A command from Delphi

    Key: B (Kinship to the princes)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what does Creon compare the State?
    A. A house built on rock
    B. A tree with many branches
    C. A ship carrying all
    D. A flock that needs a shepherd

    Key: C (A ship carrying all)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's line: "I've posted guards to watch the _____."
    Key: corpse

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does the Guard bring?

   A. The Argive army has returned

   B. A riot has broken out in the city

   C. The guards have run away

   D. Dust was sprinkled on the body

   Key: D (Dust was sprinkled on the body)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Guard come so slowly?

   A. He fears the king's anger

   B. He was wounded in the battle

   C. He stopped to pray at a temple

   D. He lost his way in the dark

   Key: A (He fears the king's anger)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Whom does Creon suspect of being behind the burial?

   A. The gods themselves

   B. Men with bribes

   C. The priests of the city

   D. Soldiers from Argos

   Key: B (Men with bribes)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's claim: "Money 'tis that sacks _____, and drives men forth from hearth and home"

   Key: Cities

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Creon threaten to do to the guards if they do not find the culprit?

   Sample answer: Creon swears by Zeus that death alone will not be enough: the guards will be hanged up alive until they confess. He wants to frighten them into finding the man who performed the burial. The threat shows how angry and suspicious he has become.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the Guard add humour to a serious scene?

    Sample answer: The Guard talks about how his conscience argued with him on the road, so that he turned back again and again. He fusses about his own innocence before giving his news and answers Creon's insults with quick replies. His fear and chatter lighten the scene while showing how frightening Creon is.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does Creon say he chose the elders as councillors?

    A. They were loyal to the royal line

    B. They fought bravely in the war

    C. They are the richest men in Thebes

    D. They are related to him by blood

    Key: A (They were loyal to the royal line)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: "Farewell to friendship, if she suffers _____."

    Key: wreck

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did the guards find around the body?

    A. Footprints leading to the palace

    B. No sign of digging or wheels

    C. A torn piece of a woman's robe

    D. A broken spear by the grave

    Key: B (No sign of digging or wheels)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How was the Guard chosen to bring the news?

    A. He volunteered

    B. Creon summoned him by name

    C. The guards cast lots

    D. The others forced him at sword point

    Key: C (The guards cast lots)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Creon mean when he says that a ruler "tongue-tied By fear" is the basest of the base?

    A. A ruler must not take advice from anyone

    B. A ruler must hide his fears from the people

    C. A ruler must speak only through heralds

    D. A ruler must speak out for the State

    Key: D (A ruler must speak out for the State)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Chorus first react to the Guard's news?

    A. It wonders if the gods did it

    B. It demands that the guards be punished

    C. It praises the person who buried him

    D. It says nothing at all

    Key: A (It wonders if the gods did it)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon reject the Chorus's suggestion?

    A. He believes the gods do not exist

    B. He thinks the gods would not honour a traitor

    C. He thinks the Chorus is plotting with the guards

    D. He fears that the Chorus is right

    Key: B (He thinks the gods would not honour a traitor)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Creon's speech on the duty of rulers to accept good counsel?

    A. He asks the guards for their advice

    B. He resigns from the throne at once

    C. He rejects the first counsel he hears

    D. He agrees with every word the Chorus says

    Key: C (He rejects the first counsel he hears)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Creon justify treating the two brothers differently?

    Sample answer: Creon says that one brother fought and fell as the city's foremost champion, while the other came back from exile to burn the city and its gods and drink his kinsmen's blood. He holds that patriots, alive or dead, must be honoured above traitors. For him, the burial law follows loyalty to the State.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's speech about money (lines 286–290) reveal about him?

    Sample answer: Creon faults money for sacking cities, driving men from home and corrupting the innocent. He assumes at once that the guards were bribed, without evidence. The speech shows a ruler quick to suspect plots and slow to consider that the burial might have come from loyalty or the gods.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Creon mean by "Till he be proved by exercise of power"?

    A. Power reveals a man's character
    B. A man must win a war before he can rule
    C. Power should go only to the old
    D. A king must prove his birth before he rules

    Key: A (Power reveals a man's character)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "No man is mad enough to court his _____."

    Key: death

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Guard say "I will speak though I say nothing"?

    A. He has been told to keep the matter secret
    B. He has news but no culprit
    C. He has forgotten the message he carried
    D. He plans to lie to the king

    Key: B (He has news but no culprit)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Guard's account of the burial suggest about the deed?

    A. It was done by a large band of men
    B. It was done in daylight before the guards
    C. It was secret and left no trace
    D. It was done by wild animals

    Key: C (It was secret and left no trace)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the tone of Creon's words "I am like to think you dote in your old age"?

    A. Grateful
    B. Sorrowful
    C. Amused
    D. Contemptuous

    Key: D (Contemptuous)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device is at work in the Guard's line about a furlong becoming a league?

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Simile

    C. Personification

    D. Alliteration

    Key: A (Hyperbole)

27. [mc · synthesis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the episode suggest about Creon as a new ruler?

    A. He is gentle and slow to anger

    B. He fears disorder and treats dissent as treason

    C. He trusts the gods above his own judgment

    D. He wants to divide power with the elders

    Key: B (He fears disorder and treats dissent as treason)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the ship of State image in Creon's first speech.

    Sample answer: Creon opens by saying the gods have brought the storm-tossed ship of state safe to port, and later calls the State the good ship that holds our fortunes all. The image makes the city's safety the first duty of every citizen, above friendship. It justifies his edict, since anyone who threatens the ship threatens everyone aboard.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Guard's speech about his conscience (lines 218–229) mirror the larger conflict of the play?

    Sample answer: The Guard describes two voices inside him, one urging him to stay away and the other warning him that Creon will learn the news anyway. He is torn between fear and duty, as Antigone and Ismene were in the Prologue. On a comic scale, his inner debate shows how the edict puts ordinary people in an impossible position.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Creon's policy that a public foe can never be a private friend.

    Sample answer: Creon's policy has strength: a ruler who favoured friends over the city could endanger it. But applied to a dead man and his family, it denies even burial and ignores the bonds of kinship. A strong answer weighs the policy's logic against its cost and uses Creon's own words.

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Creon mean by “the guerdon of the heroic dead”?

    A. The honours owed to those who die for the city

    B. The treasure buried with a king

    C. The fame that poets give to heroes

    D. The punishment for traitors

    Key: A (The honours owed to those who die for the city)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Guard's line: “The bearer of dread tidings needs must _____.”

    Key: quake

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What effect does the Guard's phrase “thirsty dust” create?

    A. It shows that the land is in a drought

    B. It makes the earth seem to welcome the rite

    C. It suggests the guards were careless

    D. It hints that the body has been moved

Key: B (It makes the earth seem to welcome the rite)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Guard mention the ordeal of red-hot iron?

    A. To describe the torture Creon has ordered

    B. To explain how the body was burned

    C. To prove how desperately the guards swore their innocence

    D. To show the guards' skill as smiths

    Key: C (To prove how desperately the guards swore their innocence)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic effect of Creon's long speech before the Guard enters?

    A. It shows that Creon has no plans at all

    B. It reveals who performed the burial

    C. It ends the conflict before it begins

    D. It sets out the principle that the news will test

    Key: D (It sets out the principle that the news will test)

36. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the scene complicate the audience's view of Creon?

    A. His principles sound reasonable but his anger is rash

    B. He seems wise in every way

    C. He shows no interest in the city

    D. He openly admits that his edict is wrong

    Key: A (His principles sound reasonable but his anger is rash)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Creon's language shifts between his speech to the elders and his reply to the Guard's news.

    Sample answer: To the elders Creon speaks calmly, in measured statements of policy about the ship of State and loyalty. After the Guard's news he becomes angry: he calls the elders dotards, faults money and malcontents, and swears oaths of terrible punishment. The shift reveals how quickly his reasoned principle turns into suspicion and rage when it is challenged.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Discuss the significance of the Chorus's suggestion that something “more than natural” is at work.

    Sample answer: The elders wonder whether the gods covered the body, since the ground showed no trace of human work. Their suggestion raises the possibility that the gods disapprove of the edict. Creon's furious rejection shows that he will not consider that his law might offend heaven, a blindness the play will test.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare Creon's view of loyalty with Antigone's view in the Prologue.

    Sample answer: For Creon, loyalty belongs first to the State; a man who puts a friend before his country is base, and a traitor cannot be honoured even in death. For Antigone, loyalty belongs first to family and the gods below; she would die rather than betray a brother. The two speeches set out the play's central conflict in opposite terms.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the Guard as a character. Is he only comic relief, or does he add meaning?

    Sample answer: The Guard is funny: he dithers, quibbles and admits he cares chiefly for his own safety. Yet his fear shows

the terror a ruler like Creon inspires, and his lack of heroism contrasts with the sisters' strong choices. A strong answer argues for his role with evidence from his speeches.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 155–323) develops the idea of Creon's first speech and the Guard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)” could deliver about Creon's first speech and the Guard. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon's first speech and the Guard in “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 1 (lines 155–323) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Creon's first speech and the Guard. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)” could deliver about Creon's first speech and the Guard. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon's first speech and the Guard in “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 1 (lines 155–323) suggests about Creon's first speech and the Guard. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" could deliver about Creon's first speech and the Guard. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon's first speech and the Guard in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 1 (lines 155–323) to complicate the reader's understanding of Creon's first speech and the Guard. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)" could deliver about Creon's first speech and the Guard. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon's first speech and the Guard in "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Elders, the gods have righted once again Our storm-tossed ship of state, now safe in port. But you by special summons I convened As my most trusted councillors; first, because I knew you loyal to Laius of old; Again, when Oedipus restored our State, Both while he ruled and when his rule was o'er, Ye still were constant to the royal line. Now that his two sons perished in one day, Brother by brother murderously slain, By right of kinship to the Princes dead, I claim and hold the throne and sovereignty.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 155–323)"?

   A. Creon's first speech and the Guard

   B. A hymn praising human skill and invention

   C. The Guard's claim that he himself sprinkled the dust

   D. Creon's order that Polyneices be honoured with a public funeral

SAT key: 1. A (Creon's first speech and the Guard)

Lesson 5: Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)

Focus: the Ode on Man

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus sings of human wonders: sailing, farming, taming animals, speech, thought and cities. Humans can solve almost everything except death. Whoever honours the laws and the gods makes the city stand; whoever departs from right becomes an outcast.

Background: This is one of the most famous choral odes in Greek drama, praising human skill in the age of Athens' greatness.

Significance: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is human cleverness a gift or a danger? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....
Prompt: Is human cleverness a gift or a danger?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Chorus says a city stands when a man "honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State," binding human law and divine reverence in one measure.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context.
Today's words: provision — a means of meeting a need; wondrous — causing amazement; firth — a narrow inlet of the sea; furrows — cuts long grooves in the soil; snare — a trap made to catch an animal; outcast — a person driven out of the community.
Words: provision: a means of meeting a need · wondrous: causing amazement · firth: a narrow inlet of the sea · furrows: cuts long grooves in the soil · snare: a trap made to catch an animal · outcast: a person driven out of the community

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
This is one of the most famous choral odes in Greek drama, praising human skill in the age of Athens' greatness. The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Theme: The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power. Imagery: Sailing, ploughing, taming and speech pile up as pictures of mastery, then stop at death, the one limit no craft can cure. Structure: The ode moves from wonder at humankind to a law about the cityless outcast, so praise turns into a test that either Antigone or Creon may fail. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The ode never names the corpse, yet its outcast who departs from right hangs over the body Creon has left unburied outside the walls.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines the Chorus reaches the end of its list of human achievements: man "hath provision for all" and has even learned to endure plague. Next, craft. I notice the turn on "yet": every triumph in the list stops at death, since "for death he hath found no cure." The strongest word is "provision": the word "provision" sums up man's foresight, which makes the one thing he cannot provide for stand out. Then, effect. What do lines 338–339 reveal about the Ode on Man? My answer: Lines 338–339 reveal the ode's turning point: human skill is vast but bounded by death. That limit prepares the last stanza's warning that cleverness can lead "now to counsels of ill," a warning that can be read against Antigone or against Creon.

> *He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure* *(Stasimon 1, lines 338–339)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines the Chorus reaches the end of its list of human achievements: man "hath provision for all" and has even learned to endure plague. Next, craft. I notice the turn on "yet": every triumph in the list stops at death, since "for death he hath found no cure." The strongest word is "provision": the word "provision" sums up man's foresight, which makes the one thing he cannot provide for stand out. Then, effect. What do lines 338–339 reveal about the Ode on Man? My answer: Lines 338–339 reveal the ode's turning point: human skill is vast but bounded by death. That limit prepares the last stanza's warning that cleverness can lead "now to counsels of ill," a warning that can be read against Antigone or against Creon.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Honours", "reveres" and "cityless outcast" stand out. The ode ties a city's strength to respect for both its laws and its gods, and it warns that pride can cut a person off from the community. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: The Chorus says a city stands when a man "honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State," binding human law and divine reverence in one measure. (Chorus, lines 342–345.)

> *If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart; / Ne'er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Honours", "reveres" and "cityless outcast" stand out in lines 342–345. The ode ties a city's strength to respect for both its laws and its gods, and it warns that pride can cut a person off from the community. "Cityless outcast" names that penalty in two words, set against the city that "shall stand."
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: The Chorus says a city stands when a man "honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State," binding human law and divine reverence in one measure. (Chorus, lines 342–345.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Ode on Man? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353) develops the idea of the Ode on Man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. When the text says "If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart; / Ne'er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart" (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345), it shows this directly. The Chorus sings of human wonders: sailing, farming, taming animals, speech, thought and cities. Humans can solve almost everything except death. Whoever honours the laws and the gods makes the city stand; whoever departs from right becomes an outcast.

Task: Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Ode on Man? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353) develops the idea of the Ode on Man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. When the text says "If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart; / Ne'er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart" (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345), it shows this directly. The Chorus sings of human wonders: sailing, farming, taming animals, speech, thought and cities. Humans can solve almost everything except death. Whoever honours the laws and the gods makes the city stand; whoever departs from right becomes an outcast.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is human cleverness a gift or a danger? Ask: Is human cleverness a gift or a danger?

Anchor question: Is human cleverness a gift or a danger?

Facilitation: Ask: Is human cleverness a gift or a danger?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Ode on Man? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. ("If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate", Stasimon 1, lines 342–345). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Ode on Man? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. ("If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate", Stasimon 1, lines 342–345). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes the Ode on Man. Key takeaway: The Chorus says a city stands when a man "honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State," binding human law and divine reverence in one measure.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power.
- **Imagery:** Sailing, ploughing, taming and speech pile up as pictures of mastery, then stop at death, the one limit no craft can cure.
- **Structure:** The ode moves from wonder at humankind to a law about the cityless outcast, so praise turns into a test that either Antigone or Creon may fail.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The Chorus says a city stands when a man "honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State," binding human law and divine reverence in one measure.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The ode never names the corpse, yet its outcast who departs from right hangs over the body Creon has left unburied outside the walls.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure" (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339) Chorus, lines 338–339.
- "If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart; / Ne'er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart" (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345) Chorus, lines 342–345.
- "Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: / Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan" (Stasimon 1, lines 324–325) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon.
Evidence: "If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart; / Ne'er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart" (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345)
Reasoning: The Chorus sings of human wonders: sailing, farming, taming animals, speech, thought and cities. Humans can solve almost everything except death. Whoever honours the laws and the gods makes the city stand; whoever departs from right becomes an outcast.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 324–325
324 **Chorus:** Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man:
325 **Chorus:** Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan,

Lines 324–327
324 **Chorus:** Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man:
325 **Chorus:** Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan,
326 **Chorus:** Through the foam of the firth, man makes his perilous way;
327 **Chorus:** And the eldest of deities Earth that knows not toil nor decay

Lines 324–339
324 **Chorus:** Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man:
325 **Chorus:** Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan,
326 **Chorus:** Through the foam of the firth, man makes his perilous way;
327 **Chorus:** And the eldest of deities Earth that knows not toil nor decay
328 **Chorus:** Ever he furrows and scores, as his team, year in year out,
329 **Chorus:** With breed of the yokèd horse, the ploughshare turneth about.
330 **Chorus:** The light-witted birds of the air, the beasts of the weald and the wood
331 **Chorus:** He traps with his woven snare, and the brood of the briny flood.
332 **Chorus:** Master of cunning he: the savage bull, and the hart
333 **Chorus:** Who roams the mountain free, are tamed by his infinite art;
334 **Chorus:** And the shaggy rough-maned steed is broken to bear the bit.
335 **Chorus:** Speech and the wind-swift speed of counsel and civic wit,

336 **Chorus:** He hath learnt for himself all these; and the arrowy rain to fly
337 **Chorus:** And the nipping airs that freeze, 'neath the open winter sky.
338 **Chorus:** He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure;
339 **Chorus:** Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure.

Lines 325–326
325 **Chorus:** Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan,
326 **Chorus:** Through the foam of the firth, man makes his perilous way;

Line 332
332 **Chorus:** Master of cunning he: the savage bull, and the hart

Lines 332–334
332 **Chorus:** Master of cunning he: the savage bull, and the hart
333 **Chorus:** Who roams the mountain free, are tamed by his infinite art;
334 **Chorus:** And the shaggy rough-maned steed is broken to bear the bit.

Line 335
335 **Chorus:** Speech and the wind-swift speed of counsel and civic wit,

Lines 338–339
338 **Chorus:** He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure;
339 **Chorus:** Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure.

Line 339
339 **Chorus:** Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure.

Line 340
340 **Chorus:** Passing the wildest flight thought are the cunning and skill,

Line 341
341 **Chorus:** That guide man now to the light, but now to counsels of ill.

Line 342
342 **Chorus:** If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State

Lines 342–345
342 **Chorus:** If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State
343 **Chorus:** Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate
344 **Chorus:** Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart;
345 **Chorus:** Ne'er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context

provision (noun)	a means of meeting a need	*He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure.*
wondrous (adjective)	causing amazement	*Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man:*
firth (noun)	a narrow inlet of the sea	*Through the foam of the firth, man makes his perilous way;*
furrows (verb)	cuts long grooves in the soil	*Ever he furrows and scores, as his team, year in year out,*
snare (noun)	a trap made to catch an animal	*He traps with his woven snare, and the brood of the briny flood.*
outcast (noun)	a person driven out of the community	*Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate*

Discussion questions

1. Is human cleverness a gift or a danger?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with gender and power?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What has man "found no cure" for? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Death.
   Answer guidance: Death.
2. How does man cross the sea, according to lines 325–326? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He makes his perilous way through the foam, before a whitening south wind.
   Answer guidance: He makes his perilous way through the foam, before a whitening south wind.
3. Which animals has man tamed, according to lines 332–334? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The savage bull, the hart that roams the mountain and the shaggy rough-maned horse, broken to the bit.
   Answer guidance: The savage bull, the hart that roams the mountain and the shaggy rough-maned horse, broken to the bit.
4. What sight surprises the elders at the end of the ode (lines 346–353)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Antigone, the hapless child of a hapless sire, being led in by the guards.
   Answer guidance: Antigone, the hapless child of a hapless sire, being led in by the guards.

5. What is the ode mainly about? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The wonders and limits of humankind
   Answer guidance: The wonders and limits of humankind.
6. What is the one thing humans cannot overcome? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Death
   Answer guidance: Death.
7. Who makes the city stand, according to lines 342–345? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** One who honours the laws and the gods
   Answer guidance: One who honours the laws and the gods.
8. What happens to one who leaves the path of right? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He becomes a cityless outcast
   Answer guidance: He becomes a cityless outcast.
9. Why can the ode's ending apply to both Antigone and Creon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Each claims to honour law and right in a different way
   Answer guidance: Each claims to honour law and right in a different way.
10. Retell the most important events of “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus sings of human wonders: sailing, farming, taming animals, speech, thought and cities. Humans can solve almost everything except death. Whoever honours the laws and the gods makes the city stand; whoever departs from right becomes an outcast.
    Answer guidance: The Chorus sings of human wonders: sailing, farming, taming animals, speech, thought and cities. Humans can solve almost everything except death. Whoever honours the laws and the gods makes the city stand; whoever departs from right becomes an outcast.

Inferential / analytical

1. Whom might the elders have in mind as the "outcast"? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Probably the unknown burier, though the words also fit Creon later.
   Answer guidance: Probably the unknown burier, though the words also fit Creon later.
2. What does “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)” suggest about the Ode on Man? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon.
   Answer guidance: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Evidence to accept: “He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate’er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure” (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339): Chorus, lines 338–339. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of theme in “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)”. What does it reveal about the Ode on Man that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas. Evidence to

accept: “If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart” (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345): Chorus, lines 342–345. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the imagery in “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)” shape what we understand about the Ode on Man? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate’er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure” (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339): Chorus, lines 338–339. On imagery: Sailing, ploughing, taming and speech pile up as pictures of mastery, then stop at death, the one limit no craft can cure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan, Through the foam of the firth, man makes his perilous way; And the…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: / Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan” (Stasimon 1, lines 324–325): Chorus, in this part of the section. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the praise of human skill; the warning that one who departs from right becomes an outcast; the effect, the sight of Antigone being led in.
   Answer guidance: Look for: the praise of human skill; the warning that one who departs from right becomes an outcast; the effect, the sight of Antigone being led in. Evidence to accept: “He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate’er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure” (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339): Chorus, lines 338–339. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)” build on “Episode 1 (lines 155–323)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart” (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345): Chorus, lines 342–345. On structure: The ode moves from wonder at humankind to a law about the cityless outcast, so praise turns into a test that either Antigone or Creon may fail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the Ode on Man, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a

quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: / Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan” (Stasimon 1, lines 324–325): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The Chorus says a city stands when a man “honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State,” binding human law and divine reverence in one measure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is human cleverness a gift or a danger?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart” (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345): Chorus, lines 342–345. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does structure appear in “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)”, and how does it connect the Ode on Man to the larger concern with gender and power? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate’er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure” (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339): Chorus, lines 338–339. On structure: The ode moves from wonder at humankind to a law about the cityless outcast, so praise turns into a test that either Antigone or Creon may fail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the Ode on Man celebrate or warn? Argue with both quoted passages. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.

2. The ode says man learnt speech and counsel 'for himself.' Is the Chorus too proud of human skill? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.

3. Should a person who breaks a city's law be cast out, as the ode's last stanza suggests? Argue with lines 342–345. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.

4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. How far do

you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: "If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart" (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345): Chorus, lines 342–345. On theme: The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)" acts most wisely in the matter of the Ode on Man, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: "Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: / Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan" (Stasimon 1, lines 324–325): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The Chorus says a city stands when a man "honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State," binding human law and divine reverence in one measure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. You are directing "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Ode on Man. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: "He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure" (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339): Chorus, lines 338–339. On structure: The ode moves from wonder at humankind to a law about the cityless outcast, so praise turns into a test that either Antigone or Creon may fail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: "If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart" (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345): Chorus, lines 342–345. On theme: The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)”, with its focus on the Ode on Man, to learning too late: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: / Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan” (Stasimon 1, lines 324–325): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Is the theme in “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)” effective in presenting the Ode on Man, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; / Safe whate’er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure” (Stasimon 1, lines 338–339): Chorus, lines 338–339. On theme: The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Compare how “Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)” treats the Ode on Man with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode is double-edged: human cleverness can serve right or wrong. Its last lines can be read against either Antigone or Creon. Useful evidence: “If he honours the laws of the land, and reveres the Gods of the State / Proudly his city shall stand; but a cityless outcast I rate / Whoso bold in his pride from the path of right doth depart” (Stasimon 1, lines 342–345): Chorus, lines 342–345. On theme: The Ode on Man praises human skill and then ties a standing city to honouring both land-laws and the gods, so cleverness is judged by piety as well as power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which creature roams the mountain free before man tames it?
   A. The hart

B. The eagle

C. The wolf

D. The lion

Key: A (The hart)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Across what does man make his perilous way in the first stanza?

A. A burning desert

B. The surging sea

C. A frozen mountain pass

D. A dark underground river

Key: B (The surging sea)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does man use to plough the Earth?

A. Teams of slaves

B. His bare hands

C. Yoked horses

D. Wooden spades alone

Key: C (Yoked horses)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "And the nipping airs that _____, 'neath the open winter sky"

Key: freeze

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which animal is "broken to bear the bit"?

A. The savage bull

B. The mountain hart

C. The light-witted bird

D. The rough-maned steed

Key: D (The rough-maned steed)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What new skill does man teach himself, according to the third stanza?

A. Speech

B. Prayer

C. Healing

D. Sailing

Key: A (Speech)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] According to the Chorus, what happens to the city of a man who honours its laws and gods?

A. It falls to its enemies

B. It stands proudly

C. It grows rich through trade

D. It is struck by plague

Key: B (It stands proudly)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does the Chorus see being led in at the end of the ode?

   A. Ismene

   B. Creon's herald

   C. Antigone

   D. An Argive captive

   Key: C (Antigone)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Name three things the Chorus says man has learned or mastered.

   Sample answer: The Chorus says man crosses the stormy sea and ploughs the Earth year after year with horses. He snares birds, beasts and fish, and tames the bull and the horse. He has taught himself speech, quick thought and the ways of city life, and he has shelter from frost and rain.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What warning does the Chorus give near the end of the Ode on Man?

    Sample answer: The Chorus warns that man's skill can lead him to good or to evil. A man who honours the laws of the land and the gods makes his city great, but one who boldly leaves the path of right becomes a cityless outcast. The elders say they would not sit beside such a man.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus call “the eldest of deities”?

    A. Earth

    B. Zeus

    C. The sea

    D. Night

    Key: A (Earth)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Master of _____ he: the savage bull, and the hart”

    Key: cunning

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the phrase “infinite art” suggest about man?

    A. He is a gifted painter of scenes

    B. His skill seems to have no limit

    C. He will live on for ever

    D. He is favoured by every god

    Key: B (His skill seems to have no limit)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does the Chorus describe the birds of the air?

    A. Swift-winged

    B. Sweet-voiced

    C. Light-witted

    D. Bright-feathered

    Key: C (Light-witted)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why is the line “yet for death he hath found no cure” a turning point in the ode?

    A. It praises man's victory over death

B. It begins a new story about a hero

C. It describes a plague now in Thebes

D. It names the limit of man's power

Key: D (It names the limit of man's power)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by a “cityless outcast”?

A. One cut off by his own pride

B. A traveller who has lost his road

C. A soldier whose city was burned

D. A beggar without any friends

Key: A (One cut off by his own pride)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone does the ode open with?

A. Grief

B. Awe

C. Anger

D. Mockery

Key: B (Awe)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] At this point in the play, whom are the elders most likely thinking of when they speak of one who leaves “the path of right”?

A. Creon, for his harsh edict

B. The Guard, for his fear

C. Whoever buried the body

D. Ismene, for her refusal

Key: C (Whoever buried the body)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Ode on Man move from praise to warning?

Sample answer: The first stanzas praise man's daring: he crosses the sea, ploughs the Earth, tames beasts and invents speech and city life. Then the Chorus names a limit, death, for which he has found no cure. The last stanza warns that his skill can lead to good or ill, and that a man who leaves the path of right becomes an outcast.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Why does the Chorus's question to Antigone at the end of the ode create dramatic irony?

Sample answer: The elders can hardly believe that the king's niece is the culprit, so they ask whether she recklessly conspired to brave the King's decree. The audience already knows from the Prologue that she planned the burial on purpose. The elders' surprise sharpens the tension, because we know what they are about to discover.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the word “weald” (line 330) refer to?

A. Wooded country

B. The deep sea

C. A city market

D. A mountain peak

Key: A (Wooded country)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Speech and the wind-swift speed of counsel and civic _____”

    Key: wit

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus suggest about human counsel by calling its speed “wind-swift”?

    A. It is easily blown off course

    B. It moves as fast as the wind

    C. It cannot be trusted at all

    D. It comes only from the gods

    Key: B (It moves as fast as the wind)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device is at work in “the arrowy rain”?

    A. Alliteration

    B. Onomatopoeia

    C. Metaphor

    D. Understatement

    Key: C (Metaphor)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What paradox lies at the heart of the ode?

    A. Man is weak and yet rules over the gods

    B. Man loves the sea yet fears its storms

    C. Man is wise because he knows nothing

    D. Man's cleverness cuts both ways

    Key: D (Man's cleverness cuts both ways)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How is the ode built?

    A. Paired stanzas, then a short chant

    B. One long speech by a single elder

    C. A dialogue between two half-choruses

    D. A prayer to the gods, then a curse

    Key: A (Paired stanzas, then a short chant)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the closing chant change the mood of the ode?

    A. From grief to joy

    B. From reflection to shock

    C. From anger to calm

    D. From fear to triumph

    Key: B (From reflection to shock)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which line best expresses man's mastery of the land?

    A. “yet for death he hath found no cure”

    B. “Ne’er may I sit by his side, or share the thoughts of his heart”

    C. “Ever he furrows and scores, as his team, year in year out”

    D. “That guide man now to the light, but now to counsels of ill”

Key: C (“Ever he furrows and scores, as his team, year in year out”)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the ode's catalogue of human achievements builds toward its warning.

    Sample answer: The ode lists man's conquests in rising order: the sea, the Earth, the creatures of air, land and water, then speech, thought and city life. Each achievement makes him seem more godlike, so the sudden limit, death, and the warning about counsels of ill land with greater force. The catalogue makes the danger of pride clear by first showing how much man can do.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the Chorus's claim that man is the greatest wonder. Does the play so far support it?

    Sample answer: The play so far shows remarkable human daring: Antigone defies a king for her brother, and Creon builds a new order after a war. But it also shows that daring turning dangerous, in Creon's harsh edict and Antigone's refusal to bend. A strong answer agrees that humans are wondrous, but notes that the play shows their wonder and their danger together.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does man's ploughing of “the eldest of deities” suggest?

    A. His boldness reaches even the gods
    B. He worships the Earth above all the gods
    C. He fears the anger of the Earth
    D. He has made peace with nature

    Key: A (His boldness reaches even the gods)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “That guide man now to the light, but now to counsels of _____”

    Key: ill

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of the ode's verbs of conquest, such as traps, tames and breaks?

    A. They show that man is cruel to animals
    B. They stress man's mastery over nature
    C. They describe the war against Argos
    D. They mock man's skill as a hunter

    Key: B (They stress man's mastery over nature)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the phrase “cityless outcast” echo the play's conflict?

    A. It points to the Argive king
    B. It describes the fleeing army
    C. It recalls the exiled Polyneices
    D. It names the Guard's own fate

    Key: C (It recalls the exiled Polyneices)

35. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about the elders' praise of one who “honours the laws of the land” just before Antigone enters?

    A. She is about to praise Creon's law
    B. She knows nothing of the king's edict
    C. She has come to beg the elders' pardon
    D. She obeyed the gods, not the State

Key: D (She obeyed the gods, not the State)

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does “haling” (line 353) mean?

    A. Dragging

    B. Greeting

    C. Healing

    D. Praising

    Key: A (Dragging)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The ode calls man “Master of cunning”. Analyze how the play so far tests that claim.

    Sample answer: The ode praises human cleverness, yet the play's clever people are already in trouble. Creon has devised a careful policy for the State, but the burial has slipped past his guards. Antigone has secretly carried out her plan, but she is caught and brought in. Cunning lets humans act boldly, but it cannot control what follows.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the ode's ideal citizen with Creon's ideal citizen in Episode 1.

    Sample answer: Both prize loyalty to the city: Creon wants citizens who put the State above friends, and the ode praises the man who honours the laws of the land. But the ode adds that the good citizen also reveres the Gods of the State. That addition opens a gap Creon has ignored, since his edict may offend the gods.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode's last stanza let the elders avoid taking sides?

    Sample answer: The elders praise whoever honours the laws of the land and reveres the gods, and reject whoever leaves the path of right. They do not say whose law or which gods. Both Creon, who speaks for the State, and Antigone, who speaks for the gods, can claim to be the good citizen, so the elders stay cautious and leave the judgment open.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Discuss what the Ode on Man contributes to the play's debate between human law and divine law.

    Sample answer: The ode celebrates human law and city life as man's own inventions, but it sets them alongside reverence for the gods and the limit of death. It suggests that human law is great only while it stays within divine bounds. A strong answer connects this idea to Creon's edict and Antigone's defiance and uses lines from the ode as evidence.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353) develops the idea of the Ode on Man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)" could deliver about the Ode on Man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode on Man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the Ode on Man. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)" could deliver about the Ode on Man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode on Man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353) suggests about the Ode on Man. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)" could deliver about the Ode on Man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode on Man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353) to complicate the reader's understanding of the Ode on Man. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)" could deliver about the Ode on Man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode on Man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Many wonders there be, but naught more wondrous than man: Over the surging sea, with a whitening south wind wan, Through the foam of the firth, man makes his perilous way; And the eldest of deities Earth that knows not toil nor decay Ever he furrows and scores, as his team, year in year out, With breed of the yokèd horse, the ploughshare turneth about. The light-witted birds of the air, the beasts of the weald and the wood He traps with his woven snare, and the brood of the briny flood. Master of cunning he: the savage bull, and the hart Who roams the mountain free, are tamed by his infinite art; And the shaggy rough-maned steed is broken to bear the bit. Speech and the wind-swift speed of counsel and civic wit, He hath learnt for himself all these; and the arrowy rain to fly And the nipping airs that freeze, 'neath the open winter sky. He hath provision for all: fell plague he hath learnt to endure; Safe whate'er may befall: yet for death he hath found no cure.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)"?

   A. Two sisters, one choice
   B. The city's victory song
   C. The Ode on Man
   D. A prayer that desire loosen its hold on the city

SAT key: 1. C (The Ode on Man)

Lesson 6: Episode 2 (lines 354–548)

Focus: Antigone before Creon

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The Guard brings in Antigone, caught performing the rites again. She admits the act and defends it: Creon's edict cannot override the unwritten laws of the gods. Creon condemns her. Ismene tries to share the blame; Antigone refuses her. Creon orders both sisters held.

Background: Antigone appeals to divine, unwritten law; Creon to the authority of the State. Hegel reads the play as a collision of two powers: Antigone reverences the ties of blood and the gods below, while Creon recognizes Zeus as the power of public life (Hegel, 1838/1920, sec. "The Concrete Development of Dramatic Poetry and its Types").

Significance: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....*
> **Prompt:** Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Antigone refuses Creon’s edict because “immutable unwritten laws of Heaven” outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city’s decree.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)**
> Six key words in context.
> *Today's words: immutable — unchangeable; annul — to cancel a law or decision; piety — duty and reverence toward the gods or family; stubborn — refusing to change or give way; kinsman — a male relative; culprit — the person guilty of an offence.*
> **Words:** immutable: unchangeable · annul: to cancel a law or decision · piety: duty and reverence toward the gods or family · stubborn: refusing to change or give way · kinsman: a male relative · culprit: the person guilty of an offence

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Antigone appeals to divine, unwritten law; Creon to the authority of the State. Hegel reads the play as a collision of two powers: Antigone reverences the ties of blood and the gods below, while Creon recognizes Zeus as the power of public life (Hegel, 1838/1920, sec. "The Concrete Development of Dramatic Poetry and its Types"). Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Characterization: Antigone answers with open admission and a long appeal to unwritten law; Creon's retort that he is "woman, she the man" shows his anger is about gender and power as well as the State. Conflict: Two stubborn wills meet: divine, unwritten custom against a mortal edict; Ismene's late offer to share the blame is refused by Antigone, and Creon condemns both sisters. Theme: The scene stages the play's central question—whether a ruler's breath can override laws "not born today nor yesterday"—in a single confrontation. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The second burial she was caught performing is treated as proof of guilt and as proof of piety, depending on whether one hears Creon or Antigone.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Guilty. I did it, I deny it not" slowly and put it in my own words: Antigone admits the burial at once and refuses to hide or soften what she has done. Next, craft. The three short clauses—"Guilty," "I did it," "I deny it not"—leave no room for plea or excuse; the wording is open and defiant in a single breath. The strongest word is "Guilty": it is the first word, and it admits the deed without a plea. Then, effect. What does line 410 reveal about Antigone before Creon? My answer: Two stubborn wills meet here. Antigone's admission stands before Creon without excuse, and Creon's later fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power, not only about the law.

> *Guilty. I did it, I deny it not (Episode 2, line 410)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Guilty. I did it, I deny it not" slowly and put it in my own words: Antigone admits the burial at once and refuses to hide or soften what she has done. Next, craft. The three short clauses—"Guilty," "I did it," "I deny it not"—leave no room for plea or excuse; the wording is open and defiant in a single breath. The strongest word is "Guilty": it is the first word, and it admits the deed without a plea. Then, effect. What does line 410 reveal about Antigone before Creon? My answer: Two stubborn wills meet here. Antigone's admission stands before Creon without excuse, and Creon's later fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power, not only about the law.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Unwritten", "immutable" and "mortal man" stand out. Antigone sets laws that never change against the order of one human ruler, so she argues that the gods' law outranks Creon's. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: Antigone refuses Creon's edict because "immutable unwritten laws of Heaven" outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city's decree. (Antigone, lines 417–424.)

> *Yea, for these laws were not ordained of Zeus, / And she who sits enthroned with gods below, / Justice, enacted not these human laws. / Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man, / Could'st by a breath annul and override / The immutable unwritten laws of Heaven. / They were not born today nor yesterday; / They die not; and none knoweth whence they sprang (Episode 2, lines 417–424)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Unwritten", "immutable" and "mortal man" stand out in lines 417–424. Antigone sets laws that never change against the order of one human ruler, so she argues that the gods' law outranks Creon's. "By a breath annul" makes his edict sound slight beside laws no mortal can override.
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: Antigone refuses Creon's edict because "immutable unwritten laws of Heaven" outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city's decree. (Antigone, lines 417–424.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Antigone before Creon? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 354–548) develops the idea of Antigone before Creon. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. When the text says "Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man" (Episode 2, lines 449–450), it shows this directly. The Guard brings in Antigone, caught performing the rites again. She admits the act and defends it: Creon's edict cannot override the unwritten laws of the gods. Creon condemns her. Ismene tries to share the blame; Antigone refuses her. Creon orders both sisters held.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Antigone before Creon? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 354–548) develops the idea of Antigone before Creon. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. When the text says "Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man" (Episode 2, lines 449–450), it shows this directly. The Guard brings in Antigone, caught performing the rites again. She admits the act and defends it: Creon's edict cannot override the unwritten laws of the gods. Creon condemns her. Ismene tries to share the blame; Antigone refuses her. Creon orders both sisters held.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are? Ask: Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are?

Anchor question: Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are?

Facilitation: Ask: Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Antigone before Creon? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. ("Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man", Episode 2, lines 449–450). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Antigone before Creon? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. ("Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man", Episode 2, lines 449–450). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Antigone before Creon. Key takeaway: Antigone refuses Creon's edict because "immutable unwritten laws of Heaven" outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city's decree.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Antigone answers with open admission and a long appeal to unwritten law; Creon's retort that he is "woman, she the man" shows his anger is about gender and power as well as the State.
- **Conflict:** Two stubborn wills meet: divine, unwritten custom against a mortal edict; Ismene's late offer to share the blame is refused by Antigone, and Creon condemns both sisters.
- **Theme:** The scene stages the play's central question—whether a ruler's breath can override laws "not born today nor yesterday"—in a single confrontation.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** Antigone refuses Creon's edict because "immutable unwritten laws of Heaven" outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city's decree.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The second burial she was caught performing is treated as proof of guilt and as proof of piety, depending on whether one hears Creon or Antigone.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Guilty. I did it, I deny it not" (Episode 2, line 410) Antigone, line 410.

- "Yea, for these laws were not ordained of Zeus, / And she who sits enthroned with gods below, / Justice, enacted not these human laws. / Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man, / Could'st by a breath annul and override / The immutable unwritten laws of Heaven. / They were not born today nor yesterday; / They die not; and none knoweth whence they sprang" (Episode 2, lines 417–424) Antigone, lines 417–424.
- "Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man" (Episode 2, lines 449–450) Creon, lines 449–450.
- "Not even death can make a foe a friend" (Episode 2, line 487) Creon, line 487.
- "My nature is for mutual love, not hate" (Episode 2, line 488) Antigone, line 488.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power.
Evidence: "Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man" (Episode 2, lines 449–450)
Reasoning: The Guard brings in Antigone, caught performing the rites again. She admits the act and defends it: Creon's edict cannot override the unwritten laws of the gods. Creon condemns her. Ismene tries to share the blame; Antigone refuses her. Creon orders both sisters held.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 391

391 **Guard:** At last it ceased, and lo! there stood this maid.

Lines 391–407

391 **Guard:** At last it ceased, and lo! there stood this maid.
392 **Guard:** A piercing cry she uttered, sad and shrill,
393 **Guard:** As when the mother bird beholds her nest
394 **Guard:** Robbed of its nestlings; even so the maid
395 **Guard:** Wailed as she saw the body stripped and bare,
396 **Guard:** And cursed the ruffians who had done this deed.
397 **Guard:** Anon she gathered handfuls of dry dust,
398 **Guard:** Then, holding high a well-wrought brazen urn,
399 **Guard:** Thrice on the dead she poured a lustral stream.
400 **Guard:** We at the sight swooped down on her and seized
401 **Guard:** Our quarry. Undismayed she stood, and when
402 **Guard:** We taxed her with the former crime and this,
403 **Guard:** She disowned nothing. I was glad—and grieved;
404 **Guard:** For 'tis most sweet to 'scape oneself scot-free,
405 **Guard:** And yet to bring disaster to a friend
406 **Guard:** Is grievous. Take it all in all, I deem
407 **Guard:** A man's first duty is to serve himself.

Line 407

407 **Guard:** A man's first duty is to serve himself.

Line 410

410 **Antigone:** Guilty. I did it, I deny it not.

Lines 417–424

417 **Antigone:** Yea, for these laws were not ordained of Zeus,
418 **Antigone:** And she who sits enthroned with gods below,
419 **Antigone:** Justice, enacted not these human laws.
420 **Antigone:** Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man,
421 **Antigone:** Could'st by a breath annul and override
422 **Antigone:** The immutable unwritten laws of Heaven.
423 **Antigone:** They were not born today nor yesterday;
424 **Antigone:** They die not; and none knoweth whence they sprang.

Line 436

436 **Antigone:** Methinks the judge of folly's not acquit.

Line 437

437 **Chorus:** A stubborn daughter of a stubborn sire,

Lines 445–450

445 **Creon:** But this proud girl, in insolence well-schooled,
446 **Creon:** First overstepped the established law, and then—
447 **Creon:** A second and worse act of insolence—
448 **Creon:** She boasts and glories in her wickedness.
449 **Creon:** Now if she thus can flout authority
450 **Creon:** Unpunished, I am woman, she the man.

Lines 449–450

449 **Creon:** Now if she thus can flout authority
450 **Creon:** Unpunished, I am woman, she the man.

Line 450

450 **Creon:** Unpunished, I am woman, she the man.

Lines 464–472

464 **Antigone:** Why dally then? To me no word of thine
465 **Antigone:** Is pleasant: God forbid it e'er should please;
466 **Antigone:** Nor am I more acceptable to thee.
467 **Antigone:** And yet how otherwise had I achieved
468 **Antigone:** A name so glorious as by burying
469 **Antigone:** A brother? so my townsmen all would say,
470 **Antigone:** Where they not gagged by terror. Manifold
471 **Antigone:** A king's prerogatives, and not the least
472 **Antigone:** That all his acts and all his words are law.

Line 486

486 **Antigone:** Who knows if this world's crimes are virtues there?

Line 487

487 **Creon:** Not even death can make a foe a friend.

Line 488

488 **Antigone:** My nature is for mutual love, not hate.

Line 515

515 **Antigone:** Ask Creon, he's thy kinsman and best friend.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
immutable (adjective)	unchangeable	*Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man, Could'st by a breath annul and override The immutable unwritten laws of Heaven.*
annul (verb)	to cancel a law or decision	*Could'st by a breath annul and override*
piety (noun)	duty and reverence toward the gods or family	*Thy work of piety, and with thee die.*
stubborn (adjective)	refusing to change or give way	*A stubborn daughter of a stubborn sire, / This ill-starred maiden kicks against the pricks.*
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*Was his dead foeman not thy kinsman too?*
culprit (noun)	the person guilty of an offence	*Here is the culprit taken in the act*

Discussion questions

1. Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with learning too late?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Antigone say about the age of the unwritten laws? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They were not born today or yesterday; no one knows where they came from.
   Answer guidance: They were not born today or yesterday; no one knows where they came from.

2. What did the guards do at the body after leaving Creon (lines 379–383)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They swept away the dust, bared the body and sat on the ridge upwind, keeping one another awake.
   Answer guidance: They swept away the dust, bared the body and sat on the ridge upwind, keeping one another awake.
3. What happened just before Antigone appeared (lines 386–391)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A sudden whirlwind raised a cloud of dust that blotted out the sky and swept the plain.
   Answer guidance: A sudden whirlwind raised a cloud of dust that blotted out the sky and swept the plain.
4. To what does the Guard compare Antigone's cry (lines 392–395)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To a mother bird wailing when she finds her nest robbed of its nestlings.
   Answer guidance: To a mother bird wailing when she finds her nest robbed of its nestlings.
5. How does Antigone answer the charge? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She admits it openly
   Answer guidance: She admits it openly.
6. What laws does Antigone say are higher than Creon's edict? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The unwritten laws of the gods
   Answer guidance: The unwritten laws of the gods.
7. Why does Creon say he would be "woman" if she goes unpunished? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He sees her defiance as a threat to his manhood and power
   Answer guidance: He sees her defiance as a threat to his manhood and power.
8. What does Ismene try to do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Share the blame with Antigone
   Answer guidance: Share the blame with Antigone.
9. What does Antigone mean by "My nature is for mutual love, not hate"? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She acts from love for family, not enmity
   Answer guidance: She acts from love for family, not enmity.
10. Retell the most important events of “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Guard brings in Antigone, caught performing the rites again. She admits the act and defends it: Creon's edict cannot override the unwritten laws of the gods. Creon condemns her. Ismene tries to share the blame; Antigone refuses her. Creon orders both sisters held.
    Answer guidance: The Guard brings in Antigone, caught performing the rites again. She admits the act and defends it: Creon's edict cannot override the unwritten laws of the gods. Creon condemns her. Ismene tries to share the blame; Antigone refuses her. Creon orders both sisters held.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antigone refuse Ismene's offer to share the guilt? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Ismene chose not to act; Antigone will

not let her take credit or die needlessly.

Answer guidance: Ismene chose not to act; Antigone will not let her take credit or die needlessly.

2. What does "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" suggest about Antigone before Creon? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power.

   Answer guidance: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Evidence to accept: "Guilty. I did it, I deny it not" (Episode 2, line 410): Antigone, line 410. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of characterization in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)". What does it reveal about Antigone before Creon that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: "Yea, for these laws were not ordained of Zeus, / And she who sits enthroned with gods below, / Justice, enacted not these human laws. / Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man" (Episode 2, lines 417–424): Antigone, lines 417–424. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the conflict in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" shape what we understand about Antigone before Creon? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: "Guilty. I did it, I deny it not" (Episode 2, line 410): Antigone, line 410. On conflict: Two stubborn wills meet: divine, unwritten custom against a mortal edict; Ismene's late offer to share the blame is refused by Antigone, and Creon condemns both sisters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with "At last it ceased, and lo!", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man" (Episode 2, lines 449–450): Creon, lines 449–450. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Antigone's appeal to the unwritten laws; Creon's refusal to let a woman defy him; the effect, the sentence on both sisters and Ismene's plea to share it.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Antigone's appeal to the unwritten laws; Creon's refusal to let a woman defy him; the effect, the sentence on both sisters and Ismene's plea to share it. Evidence to accept: "Not even death can make a foe a friend" (Episode 2, line 487): Creon, line 487. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" build on "Stasimon 1 (lines 324–353)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Yea, for these laws were not ordained of Zeus, / And she who sits enthroned with gods below, / Justice, enacted not these human laws. / Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man” (Episode 2, lines 417–424): Antigone, lines 417–424. Theme link: Antigone refuses Creon’s edict because “immutable unwritten laws of Heaven” outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city’s decree. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Antigone before Creon, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man” (Episode 2, lines 449–450): Creon, lines 449–450. On characterization: Antigone answers with open admission and a long appeal to unwritten law; Creon’s retort that he is “woman, she the man” shows his anger is about gender and power as well as the State. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Are there laws higher than a government's laws? Who decides what they are?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “My nature is for mutual love, not hate” (Episode 2, line 488): Antigone, line 488. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does theme appear in “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)”, and how does it connect Antigone before Creon to the larger concern with learning too late? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Not even death can make a foe a friend” (Episode 2, line 487): Creon, line 487. On theme: The scene stages the play’s central question—whether a ruler’s breath can override laws “not born today nor yesterday”—in a single confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Hegel saw two rightful claims; is one side more right? Argue with lines 417–424 and 487–488. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. The Guard says 'A man's first duty is to serve himself.' Is his attitude more honest or more shameful than Creon's? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and

explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

Answer guidance: A defended position.

3. Creon says the hardest iron shatters soonest (lines 439–442). Whom does this warning fit best? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position that applies the "hardest iron" warning (lines 439–442) to Antigone, Creon, or both, with evidence.

   Answer guidance: The warning fits Antigone in Creon's mouth, because he applies the "hardest iron" image to "this proud girl" in the next lines (439–448). It also fits Creon himself: he will not bend, and Haemon's flood-trees (lines 667–669) restate the same idea from the other side. A strong answer names one or both and cites the lines.

4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: "Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man" (Episode 2, lines 449–450): Creon, lines 449–450. On theme: The scene stages the play's central question—whether a ruler's breath can override laws "not born today nor yesterday"—in a single confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" acts most wisely in the matter of Antigone before Creon, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: "Not even death can make a foe a friend" (Episode 2, line 487): Creon, line 487. On characterization: Antigone answers with open admission and a long appeal to unwritten law; Creon's retort that he is "woman, she the man" shows his anger is about gender and power as well as the State. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. You are directing "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Antigone before Creon. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: "My nature is for mutual love, not hate" (Episode 2, line 488): Antigone, line 488. Theme link: Antigone refuses Creon's edict because "immutable unwritten laws of Heaven" outrank a mortal order, so divine law is named as older and higher than the city's decree. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Guilty. I did it, I deny it not” (Episode 2, line 410): Antigone, line 410. On theme: The scene stages the play’s central question—whether a ruler’s breath can override laws “not born today nor yesterday”—in a single confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)”, with its focus on Antigone before Creon, to divine law and human law: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Yea, for these laws were not ordained of Zeus, / And she who sits enthroned with gods below, / Justice, enacted not these human laws. / Nor did I deem that thou, a mortal man” (Episode 2, lines 417–424): Antigone, lines 417–424. On theme: The scene stages the play’s central question—whether a ruler’s breath can override laws “not born today nor yesterday”—in a single confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the characterization in “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)” effective in presenting Antigone before Creon, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Now if she thus can flout authority / Unpunished, I am woman, she the man” (Episode 2, lines 449–450): Creon, lines 449–450. On characterization: Antigone answers with open admission and a long appeal to unwritten law; Creon’s retort that he is “woman, she the man” shows his anger is about gender and power as well as the State. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how “Episode 2 (lines 354–548)” treats Antigone before Creon with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Two stubborn wills meet. Creon's fear that "I am woman, she the man" (lines 449–450) shows that his anger is also about gender and power. Useful evidence: “Not even death can make a foe a friend” (Episode 2, line 487): Creon, line 487. On theme: The scene stages the play’s central question—whether a ruler’s breath can override laws “not born today nor yesterday”—in a single confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What was Antigone doing when the guards caught her?
   A. Burying her brother
   B. Praying at a temple
   C. Hiding in the palace
   D. Running from the city

   Key: A (Burying her brother)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did the guards do to the body before they sat on the ridge?
   A. Burned it on a pyre
   B. Swept away the dust
   C. Moved it to the palace
   D. Covered it with stones

   Key: B (Swept away the dust)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What natural event hid Antigone's approach?
   A. A thunderstorm
   B. A thick fog
   C. A whirlwind of dust
   D. An eclipse of the sun

   Key: C (A whirlwind of dust)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what does the Guard compare Antigone's cry at the bare body?
   A. A wolf howling at the moon at night
   B. A child lost in a crowded market
   C. A trumpet calling the army to war
   D. A mother bird at an empty nest

   Key: D (A mother bird at an empty nest)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Antigone's answer: "_____. I did it, I deny it not."
   Key: Guilty
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon say happens to the hardest iron when it is over-heated?
   A. It shatters soonest
   B. It shines more brightly
   C. It grows stronger

D. It bends easily

Key: A (It shatters soonest)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Creon accuse along with Antigone?

   A. The Guard

   B. Ismene

   C. The elders

   D. The priests

   Key: B (Ismene)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the Chorus describe Ismene as she enters?

   A. Laughing with the guards

   B. Proud and defiant

   C. Weeping for her sister

   D. Calm and smiling

   Key: C (Weeping for her sister)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How did the guards finally catch Antigone?

   Sample answer: After sweeping the dust off the body, the guards kept watch from a ridge. At noon a whirlwind raised a cloud of dust, and when it passed they saw Antigone wailing over the bare body. She sprinkled dust and poured libations from a bronze urn, and the guards rushed down and took her.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Antigone say that dying early would be a gain for her?

    Sample answer: Antigone says her life is full of misery, so an early death is gain. She would have grieved more if she had left her mother's son unburied. Facing death for the burial seems to her not sad but blissful, which shows how completely she has accepted the cost of her choice.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does the Guard say no man should make a vow?

    A. Later thoughts can overturn it

    B. The gods dislike all oaths

    C. Vows cost too much money

    D. Only kings may swear

    Key: A (Later thoughts can overturn it)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Guard's line: “A man’s first duty is to serve _____.”

    Key: himself

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Antigone pour on the body three times?

    A. Wine from a golden cup

    B. Libations from a bronze urn

    C. Oil from a silver lamp

    D. Honey from a clay jar

    Key: B (Libations from a bronze urn)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Guard feel about catching Antigone?

    A. Proud and joyful

    B. Angry and afraid

C. Glad and grieved at once

D. Bored and tired

Key: C (Glad and grieved at once)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What image does Creon use to say that even the proudest can be controlled?

A. A ship turned back by a storm

B. A hawk tied to a falconer's glove

C. A river held back by a dam

D. A snaffle curbing a fiery steed

Key: D (A snaffle curbing a fiery steed)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon think Ismene is guilty too?

A. He saw her frenzied and distraught

B. She confessed to him earlier

C. The Guard saw her at the grave that morning

D. She was carrying the urn

Key: A (He saw her frenzied and distraught)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone claim the townsmen would say if they were not afraid?

A. That Creon is the wisest of all kings

B. That she has won a glorious name

C. That Ismene should rule

D. That the edict is just

Key: B (That she has won a glorious name)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Antigone mean when she tells Ismene, “Ask Creon, he’s thy kinsman and best friend”?

A. She truly wants Ismene to ask Creon for help

B. She thinks Creon loves Ismene

C. She mocks Ismene's choice to obey

D. She is begging Creon for mercy

Key: C (She mocks Ismene's choice to obey)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Creon interpret Antigone's defiance in lines 445–450?

Sample answer: Creon sees two crimes: she broke his law, and then she boasted of it. He says that if she can flout his authority unpunished, he is the woman and she the man. He treats her defiance as an attack on his power and his manhood, which makes him more determined to punish her.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do the Guard's feelings about catching Antigone reveal his character?

Sample answer: The Guard is glad to escape punishment himself but sorry to bring disaster on someone he pities. He sums it up by saying a man's first duty is to serve himself. He is honest about his selfishness, which makes him both comic and human, and his plain self-interest contrasts with Antigone's willingness to die for her brother.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “treasure-trove” suggest about how the Guard sees Antigone?

    A. As a lucky find that saves him

    B. As a thief who stole the king's treasure

    C. As a prize to be sold

    D. As a gift from the gods

    Key: A (As a lucky find that saves him)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “A stubborn daughter of a stubborn _____”

    Key: sire

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone suggest with “the judge of folly’s not acquit”?

    A. The judges of Thebes are corrupt

    B. Creon himself may be the fool

    C. She deserves death for her folly

    D. No one can judge a fool

    Key: B (Creon himself may be the fool)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device shapes Creon's line “I am woman, she the man”?

    A. Simile

    B. Onomatopoeia

    C. Antithesis

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Antithesis)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Creon's image of a “viper” in his house suggest?

    A. He fears snakes in the palace

    B. He respects Ismene's cunning

    C. He thinks the gods sent a curse

    D. He sees family as hidden enemies

    Key: D (He sees family as hidden enemies)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Antigone mean by “I died long ago”?

    A. She gave her life when she chose the burial

    B. She was gravely ill as a young child

    C. She has seen her own ghost

    D. She is speaking of her mother's death

    Key: A (She gave her life when she chose the burial)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone does Antigone take toward Creon in lines 464–472?

    A. Pleading

    B. Scornful

C. Respectful

D. Fearful

Key: B (Scornful)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the line-by-line exchange between Creon and Antigone (lines 473–490) emphasize?

    A. Their slow move toward agreement

    B. Creon's growing doubt about the edict

    C. The clash of two unbending wills

    D. Antigone's fear of death

    Key: C (The clash of two unbending wills)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze Creon's iron and horse images (lines 439–444).

    Sample answer: Creon says the stubbornest wills are the soonest bent, as over-heated iron shatters, and that a snaffle curbs the fieriest steed. The images present Antigone as a material to be broken or an animal to be tamed. They reveal his belief that power must master defiance, and they ironically fit his own rigid will, which will also break.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Antigone's treatment of Ismene in this episode. Is she cruel or protective?

    Sample answer: Antigone refuses Ismene's offer to share the guilt and mocks her for siding with Creon. This sounds cruel, but she also tells Ismene to save herself and says one death is enough. A strong answer weighs her harsh words against her wish to keep Ismene alive and decides which motive matters more.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Antigone's appeal to "Justice" and "the gods below" challenge Creon?

    A. It denies that his edict has divine authority

    B. It accuses him of breaking a treaty

    C. It claims she is above the law because of birth

    D. It asks the elders to vote on the edict

    Key: A (It denies that his edict has divine authority)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: "No woman shall be _____ while I live."

    Key: master

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's line "Not even death can make a foe a friend" reveal?

    A. He believes the dead can return as enemies

    B. He sees loyalty as political, even after death

    C. He wants peace with Argos

    D. He fears his own death

    Key: B (He sees loyalty as political, even after death)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about the Guard's maxim that "A man's first duty is to serve himself"?

    A. It is exactly what Antigone believes

    B. It is one of Creon's own laws

    C. It contrasts with Antigone's self-sacrifice

D. It is spoken by the gods

Key: C (It contrasts with Antigone's self-sacrifice)

35. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Antigone's question "Who knows if this world's crimes are virtues there?" introduces which idea?

    A. The dead will soon punish the living

    B. Every crime will be forgiven in time

    C. Virtue means nothing to the gods

    D. Human verdicts may not bind the dead

    Key: D (Human verdicts may not bind the dead)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the Chorus's phrase "kicks against the pricks" characterize Antigone?

    A. As resisting a force she cannot beat

    B. As a dancer at a festival

    C. As cruel to the animals in her care

    D. As a coward who runs from danger

    Key: A (As resisting a force she cannot beat)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Creon's language about gender (lines 449–450, 490, 545–546) shapes the conflict.

    Sample answer: Creon fears that if Antigone goes unpunished he will be the woman and she the man, and he swears no woman shall be master while he lives. At the end he orders that the sisters learn to live as women should, not roam at large. His language turns a dispute about burial into a contest over male authority, which makes him less able to back down.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare Antigone's idea of law (lines 417–424) with Creon's (lines 446–455).

    Sample answer: Antigone places the unwritten laws of the gods above any human decree; they are eternal and no mortal can override them. Creon treats the established law of the city as absolute and says not even kinship can excuse breaking it. The contrast is between divine law that is timeless and human law that depends on the ruler's authority.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Ismene's attempt to share the guilt. Is it courage, guilt or love?

    Sample answer: Ismene claims a share in a deed she refused to do, saying life would be worthless without her sister. It could be courage, since she now faces Creon; guilt, since she failed to help; or love, since she would rather die with Antigone. A strong answer chooses one motive and supports it with her lines, while noting the others.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Sophocles use the Guard's long report (lines 377–407) to shape our view of Antigone?

    Sample answer: The Guard describes Antigone as a grieving bird crying over a robbed nest and shows her calmly pouring libations and denying nothing. Because the witness is a plain, self-interested man, his report seems trustworthy. It makes her look devoted and unafraid before she speaks, so the audience meets her in Creon's presence already moved by her courage.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 0

HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 354–548) develops the idea of Antigone before Creon. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" could deliver about Antigone before Creon. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone before Creon in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 2 (lines 354–548) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Antigone before Creon. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" could deliver about Antigone before Creon. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone before Creon in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 2 (lines 354–548) suggests about Antigone before Creon. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" could deliver about Antigone before Creon. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone before Creon in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)": each member takes one passage,

quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 2 (lines 354–548) to complicate the reader's understanding of Antigone before Creon. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)" could deliver about Antigone before Creon. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone before Creon in "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *At last it ceased, and lo! there stood this maid. A piercing cry she uttered, sad and shrill, As when the mother bird beholds her nest Robbed of its nestlings; even so the maid Wailed as she saw the body stripped and bare, And cursed the ruffians who had done this deed. Anon she gathered handfuls of dry dust, Then, holding high a well-wrought brazen urn, Thrice on the dead she poured a lustral stream. We at the sight swooped down on her and seized Our quarry. Undismayed she stood, and when We taxed her with the former crime and this, She disowned nothing. I was glad—and grieved; For 'tis most sweet to 'scape oneself scot-free, And yet to bring disaster to a friend Is grievous. Take it all in all, I deem A man's first duty is to serve himself.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)"?

   A. The Guard's report that the maid denied the deed
   B. Antigone before Creon
   C. The city's victory song
   D. Two sisters, one choice

SAT key: 1. B (Antigone before Creon)

Lesson 7: Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)

Focus: the curse on the house

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588) (the curse on the house) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus sings that when the gods shake a house, ruin passes from generation to generation, as in the house of Labdacus. Zeus' power never sleeps, and hope can deceive until the ground burns underfoot.

Background: The house of Labdacus is the family of Laius, Oedipus and his children.

Significance: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Do families pass down trouble as well as gifts? How can someone break the pattern? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....*
> **Prompt:** Do families pass down trouble as well as gifts? How can someone break the pattern?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Today's words: blest — made happy or fortunate; attaint — to stain a family with a curse or disgrace; malison — a curse upon a person or family; scourges — punishes severely, as with a whip; omnipotent — having unlimited power; forlorn — pitifully alone and unhappy. The house of Labdacus is the family of Laius, Oedipus and his children. The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Theme: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern. Imagery: Hope "flits about on never-wearying wings" until the ground burns, so hope itself becomes a treacherous landscape underfoot. Foreshadowing: Ruin that "lingers on and speeds apace" from age to age points forward to the deaths still to come in Creon's house as well as Oedipus's. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The curse-song keeps the family's past graves in view, while Polyneices's present lack of a grave is the fresh wound the curse is feeding on.
Words: blest: made happy or fortunate · attaint: to stain a family with a curse or disgrace · malison: a curse upon a person or family · scourges: punishes severely, as with a whip · omnipotent: having unlimited power · forlorn: pitifully alone and unhappy

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes the curse on the house. Key takeaway: The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern.
- **Imagery:** Hope "flits about on never-wearying wings" until the ground burns, so hope itself becomes a treacherous landscape underfoot.
- **Foreshadowing:** Ruin that "lingers on and speeds apace" from age to age points forward to the deaths still to come in Creon's house as well as Oedipus's.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The curse-song keeps the family's past graves in view, while Polyneices's present lack of a grave is the fresh wound the curse is feeding on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549) Chorus, line 549.
- "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578) Chorus, lines 575–578.
- "The infection lingers on and speeds apace, / Age after age, and each the cup must drain" (Stasimon 2, lines 551–552) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility.
Evidence: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549)
Reasoning: The Chorus sings that when the gods shake a house, ruin passes from generation to generation, as in the house of Labdacus. Zeus' power never sleeps, and hope can deceive until the ground burns underfoot.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 549
549 **Chorus:** Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain!

Lines 549–564
549 **Chorus:** Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain!
550 **Chorus:** If once the curse of Heaven attaint a race,
551 **Chorus:** The infection lingers on and speeds apace,
552 **Chorus:** Age after age, and each the cup must drain.
553 **Chorus:** So when Etesian blasts from Thrace downpour
554 **Chorus:** Sweep o'er the blackening main and whirl to land
555 **Chorus:** From Ocean's cavernous depths his ooze and sand,
556 **Chorus:** Billow on billow thunders on the shore.
557 **Chorus:** On the Labdacidae I see descending
558 **Chorus:** Woe upon woe; from days of old some god
559 **Chorus:** Laid on the race a malison, and his rod
560 **Chorus:** Scourges each age with sorrows never ending.
561 **Chorus:** The light that dawned upon its last born son
562 **Chorus:** Is vanished, and the bloody axe of Fate
563 **Chorus:** Has felled the goodly tree that blossomed late.
564 **Chorus:** O Oedipus, by reckless pride undone!

Line 550
550 **Chorus:** If once the curse of Heaven attaint a race,

Lines 551–552
551 **Chorus:** The infection lingers on and speeds apace,
552 **Chorus:** Age after age, and each the cup must drain.

Line 553

553 **Chorus:** So when Etesian blasts from Thrace downpour

Line 556

556 **Chorus:** Billow on billow thunders on the shore.

Lines 557–564

557 **Chorus:** On the Labdacidae I see descending
558 **Chorus:** Woe upon woe; from days of old some god
559 **Chorus:** Laid on the race a malison, and his rod
560 **Chorus:** Scourges each age with sorrows never ending.
561 **Chorus:** The light that dawned upon its last born son
562 **Chorus:** Is vanished, and the bloody axe of Fate
563 **Chorus:** Has felled the goodly tree that blossomed late.
564 **Chorus:** O Oedipus, by reckless pride undone!

Lines 561–562

561 **Chorus:** The light that dawned upon its last born son
562 **Chorus:** Is vanished, and the bloody axe of Fate

Lines 561–563

561 **Chorus:** The light that dawned upon its last born son
562 **Chorus:** Is vanished, and the bloody axe of Fate
563 **Chorus:** Has felled the goodly tree that blossomed late.

Line 564

564 **Chorus:** O Oedipus, by reckless pride undone!

Line 565

565 **Chorus:** Thy might, O Zeus, what mortal power can quell?

Lines 571–572

571 **Chorus:** Past, present, and to be,
572 **Chorus:** All bow to thy decree,

Lines 573–574

573 **Chorus:** All that exceeds the mean by Fate
574 **Chorus:** Is punished, Love or Hate.

Lines 575–578

575 **Chorus:** Hope flits about never-wearying wings;
576 **Chorus:** Profit to some, to some light loves she brings,
577 **Chorus:** But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn,
578 **Chorus:** Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn.

Lines 575–582

575 **Chorus:** Hope flits about never-wearying wings;

576 **Chorus:** Profit to some, to some light loves she brings,
577 **Chorus:** But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn,
578 **Chorus:** Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn.
579 **Chorus:** Sure 'twas a sage inspired that spake this word;
580 **Chorus:** If evil good appear
581 **Chorus:** To any, Fate is near;
582 **Chorus:** And brief the respite from her flaming sword.

Line 582

582 **Chorus:** And brief the respite from her flaming sword.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
blest (adjective)	made happy or fortunate	*Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain!*
attaint (verb)	to stain a family with a curse or disgrace	*If once the curse of Heaven attaint a race,*
malison (noun)	a curse upon a person or family	*Laid on the race a malison, and his rod*
scourges (verb)	punishes severely, as with a whip	*Scourges each age with sorrows never ending. / The light that dawned upon its last born son*
omnipotent (adjective)	having unlimited power	*Thou reignest King, omnipotent, sublime. / Past, present, and to be,*
forlorn (adjective)	pitifully alone and unhappy	*Maid forlorn, Antigone?*

Discussion questions

1. Do families pass down trouble as well as gifts? How can someone break the pattern?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with divine law and human law?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does hope bring to some, according to lines 575–578? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Profit to some and light loves to others. **Answer guidance:** Profit to some and light loves to others.
2. Which god's might does the Chorus say neither sleep nor time can touch (lines 565–570)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Zeus,

who reigns untouched by time in the light of Olympus.

Answer guidance: Zeus, who reigns untouched by time in the light of Olympus.

3. Who enters at the end of the ode, and what do the elders wonder about him (lines 583–588)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Haemon, Creon's youngest son; they wonder whether he comes grieving for his bride, Antigone.

   Answer guidance: Haemon, Creon's youngest son; they wonder whether he comes grieving for his bride, Antigone.

4. What has the bloody axe of Fate done, according to lines 561–563? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It has felled the goodly tree that blossomed late, so the light that dawned on the family has vanished.

   Answer guidance: It has felled the goodly tree that blossomed late, so the light that dawned on the family has vanished.

5. Whose house does the Chorus say is cursed? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The house of Labdacus

   Answer guidance: The house of Labdacus.

6. Whom does the Chorus call "thrice blest"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Those who never tasted pain

   Answer guidance: Those who never tasted pain.

7. How is hope described? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** As winged and able to deceive

   Answer guidance: As winged and able to deceive.

8. What does "treacherous ashes burn" suggest? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Danger hidden underfoot until too late

   Answer guidance: Danger hidden underfoot until too late.

9. What does the ode foreshadow? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** More ruin for the family

   Answer guidance: More ruin for the family.

10. Retell the most important events of “Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus sings that when the gods shake a house, ruin passes from generation to generation, as in the house of Labdacus. Zeus' power never sleeps, and hope can deceive until the ground burns underfoot.

    Answer guidance: The Chorus sings that when the gods shake a house, ruin passes from generation to generation, as in the house of Labdacus. Zeus' power never sleeps, and hope can deceive until the ground burns underfoot.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Chorus speak of hope right after Antigone's sentence? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Hope can deceive a person as ruin approaches, citing the ode’s wording.

   Answer guidance: The ode turns from the sentence just passed to Hope that “flits about on never-wearying wings” and may hide “treacherous ashes” (lines 575–578). The elders suggest that hope can deceive a person just as ruin approaches, a warning that hangs over Creon as well as over the doomed house.

2. What does "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" suggest about the curse on the house? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility.

   Answer guidance: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Evidence to accept: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549): Chorus, line 549. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of theme in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)". What does it reveal about the curse on the house that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas. Evidence to accept: "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578): Chorus, lines 575–578. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the imagery in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" shape what we understand about the curse on the house? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549): Chorus, line 549. On imagery: Hope "flits about on never-wearying wings" until the ground burns, so hope itself becomes a treacherous landscape underfoot. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain!", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "The infection lingers on and speeds apace, / Age after age, and each the cup must drain" (Stasimon 2, lines 551–552): Chorus, in this part of the section. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the curse passed from one generation to the next; hope that deceives; the effect, Haemon's arrival at a dangerous moment.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the curse passed from one generation to the next; hope that deceives; the effect, Haemon's arrival at a dangerous moment. Evidence to accept: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549): Chorus, line 549. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" build on "Episode 2 (lines 354–548)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her

gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578): Chorus, lines 575–578. Theme link: The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the curse on the house, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "The infection lingers on and speeds apace, / Age after age, and each the cup must drain" (Stasimon 2, lines 551–552): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Do families pass down trouble as well as gifts? How can someone break the pattern?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578): Chorus, lines 575–578. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does foreshadowing appear in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)", and how does it connect the curse on the house to the larger concern with divine law and human law? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549): Chorus, line 549. On foreshadowing: Ruin that "lingers on and speeds apace" from age to age points forward to the deaths still to come in Creon's house as well as Oedipus's. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Antigone doomed by her family's curse or by her own choice? Defend your answer. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.

2. The Chorus says no man knows how Hope's gifts may turn. Is hope more a comfort or a danger in the play so far? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.

3. Do the elders pity the house of Labdacus or judge it? Argue with lines 557–564. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.

4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578): Chorus, lines 575–578. On theme: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" acts most wisely in the matter of the curse on the house, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "The infection lingers on and speeds apace, / Age after age, and each the cup must drain" (Stasimon 2, lines 551–552): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. You are directing "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the curse on the house. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549): Chorus, line 549. Theme link: The elders trace ruin to the gods' shaking of a house, so divine judgment frames the human stubbornness that will not bend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her

gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578): Chorus, lines 575–578. On theme: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)", with its focus on the curse on the house, to family and the State: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "The infection lingers on and speeds apace, / Age after age, and each the cup must drain" (Stasimon 2, lines 551–552): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Is the theme in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" effective in presenting the curse on the house, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain" (Stasimon 2, line 549): Chorus, line 549. On theme: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Compare how "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" treats the curse on the house with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse, yet her choice is her own: the play balances fate and responsibility. Useful evidence: "Hope flits about on never-wearying wings; / Profit to some, to some light loves she brings, / But no man knoweth how her gifts may turn, / Till 'neath his feet the treacherous ashes burn" (Stasimon 2, lines 575–578): Chorus, lines 575–578. On theme: The ode places Antigone inside an inherited curse on Labdacus's house, yet still leaves room for her own choice inside that pattern. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens once the curse of Heaven strikes a family?
   A. It passes from age to age
   B. It ends with the first death
   C. It falls only on its kings
   D. It can be washed away

   Key: A (It passes from age to age)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From where do the storm winds in the Chorus's simile blow?
   A. Egypt
   B. Thrace
   C. Argos
   D. Delphi

   Key: B (Thrace)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the waves bring up from Ocean's depths?
   A. Shells and pearls
   B. Wrecked ships
   C. Ooze and sand
   D. Dead fish

   Key: C (Ooze and sand)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "O Oedipus, by reckless _____ undone!"

   Key: pride
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Zeus reign, according to the Chorus?
   A. Beneath the sea
   B. In the city of Thebes
   C. In the world below
   D. On Olympus' height

   Key: D (On Olympus' height)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What two things cannot overcome the might of Zeus?
   A. Sleep and the tireless moons
   B. Fire and the flooding sea
   C. War and plague
   D. Kings and armies

   Key: A (Sleep and the tireless moons)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus call Haemon as he arrives?
   A. Glory of the army
   B. Latest of thy brood
   C. Heir of the throne
   D. Friend of the people

   Key: B (Latest of thy brood)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does the Chorus say happens to "All that exceeds the mean"?

   A. It is rewarded by Zeus

   B. It is soon forgotten

   C. It is punished by Fate

   D. It becomes the law

   Key: C (It is punished by Fate)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the Chorus describe the curse on the house of Oedipus?

   Sample answer: The Chorus says that once Heaven curses a family, the infection spreads from age to age, and each generation must drain the cup. It compares the curse to storm waves pounding the shore and says some god laid a curse on the race long ago. Now even the family's last hope has been cut down.

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus say about the power of Zeus?

    Sample answer: The Chorus says no mortal power can check the might of Zeus. Neither sleep nor the tireless moons touch him; he reigns untouched by time in the light of Olympus. Past, present and future bow to his decree, and whatever goes beyond the mean is punished.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "attaint" mean in "If once the curse of Heaven attaint a race"?

    A. Infect

    B. Reward

    C. Abandon

    D. Name

    Key: A (Infect)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Past, present, and to be, All bow to thy _____"

    Key: decree

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus compare the curse to waves on the shore?

    A. Both bring up hidden treasure

    B. Both strike again and again

    C. Both are calm in summer

    D. Both come only at night

    Key: B (Both strike again and again)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does "malison" (line 559) mean?

    A. A blessing

    B. A disease

    C. An evil spell

    D. A law

    Key: C (An evil spell)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] According to the Chorus, what is true when "evil good appear" to someone?

    A. He is rewarded

    B. He is forgiven

    C. The gods forget him

    D. Fate is near

    Key: D (Fate is near)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone dominates the first half of the ode?

    A. Mournful

    B. Joyful

    C. Mocking

    D. Triumphant

    Key: A (Mournful)

17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the effect of calling Zeus "untouched by Time"?

    A. It shows Zeus is growing old and weary

    B. It contrasts his power with mortal ruin

    C. It suggests Zeus sleeps through the ages

    D. It means Zeus cares nothing for mortals

    Key: B (It contrasts his power with mortal ruin)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does the Chorus address Oedipus directly in line 564?

    A. To summon his ghost back to the city at last

    B. To praise his wisdom as a ruler

    C. To mourn the ancestor whose fall began it

    D. To ask him to forgive Creon

    Key: C (To mourn the ancestor whose fall began it)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode connect Antigone's fate to her family's past?

    Sample answer: The Chorus sees Antigone's sentence as the latest blow of a curse laid on the family long ago. Oedipus was undone by reckless pride, and now the last hope of his line is cut down. The ode suggests that her suffering repeats a pattern that runs through every generation of the house.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Explain the Chorus's warning about hope in lines 575–582.

    Sample answer: The Chorus says hope flies about and brings profit or light loves, but no one knows how her gifts will turn until the ground burns beneath him. When evil seems good to someone, Fate is close, and the respite is short. Hope can mislead people into ruin before they see the danger.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does "Etesian" describe in line 553?

    A. Seasonal winds

    B. Ancient gods

    C. Sea monsters

    D. Thracian ships

Key: A (Seasonal winds)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Thy might, O Zeus, what mortal power can _____?”

    Key: quell

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device is at work in “Billow on billow thunders on the shore”?

    A. Understatement and irony

    B. Repetition and sound imagery

    C. Personification of the shore and sea

    D. A direct address to a god

    Key: B (Repetition and sound imagery)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What paradox lies in “If evil good appear”?

    A. Good people are the ones who suffer most

    B. Evil is a gift from the gods

    C. Wrong can look right to the doomed

    D. The wise cannot be deceived

    Key: C (Wrong can look right to the doomed)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode move from start to finish?

    A. From war to peace to joy

    B. From love to hate to death

    C. From prayer to curse to song

    D. From curse to Zeus to hope

    Key: D (From curse to Zeus to hope)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “All that exceeds the mean by Fate Is punished” suggest about excess?

    A. Any extreme invites ruin

    B. Only kings are ever punished

    C. Moderation is cowardly

    D. Fate rewards boldness

    Key: A (Any extreme invites ruin)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of ending the ode with Haemon's arrival?

    A. It ends the play's main action at once

    B. It aims the warning at the next scene

    C. It brings comic relief to the scene

    D. It shows that Creon has triumphed

    Key: B (It aims the warning at the next scene)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of Fate's “flaming sword” suggest?

    A. Fate protects the city

    B. A new war is coming from Argos

C. Punishment is swift and violent

D. Zeus is a warrior king

Key: C (Punishment is swift and violent)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the storm-wave simile (lines 553–556) conveys the nature of the family curse.

Sample answer: The Chorus compares the curse to Etesian storms that whip the black sea and hurl ooze and sand from the depths, so that billow after billow thunders on the shore. The image makes the curse seem natural, relentless and impossible to stop. It also suggests that what lies buried in the family's past keeps rising to the surface.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the ode presents Antigone as guilty, unlucky, or both.

Sample answer: The ode stresses an inherited curse, which makes Antigone unlucky, the last victim of a family doomed by the gods. Yet it also says that all who exceed the mean are punished, which hints at her own excess. A strong answer weighs both ideas and decides how the elders see her, with lines as evidence.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode's opening blessing frame what follows?

A. By contrast with a cursed family

B. By praising Creon's rule

C. By naming the gods of Thebes

D. By recalling the war with the Argives

Key: A (By contrast with a cursed family)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “And brief the respite from her flaming _____”

Key: sword

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by “The light that dawned upon its last born son Is vanished”?

A. The sun has set over Thebes

B. The family's last hope is gone

C. A child has been born to Creon

D. Oedipus has regained his sight

Key: B (The family's last hope is gone)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The idea that whatever “exceeds the mean” is punished recalls which earlier argument?

A. Creon's image of the ship of State

B. The Guard's maxim about serving himself

C. Ismene's appeal to the golden mean

D. Antigone's praise of the unwritten laws

Key: C (Ismene's appeal to the golden mean)

35. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode complicate the question of responsibility?

A. It holds the gods alone responsible for everything

B. It makes Creon alone guilty of the sentence

C. It declares Antigone wholly innocent

D. It mixes inherited curse with personal excess

Key: D (It mixes inherited curse with personal excess)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which word best describes the Chorus's view of human hope?

    A. Unreliable

    B. Divine

    C. Foolish

    D. Everlasting

    Key: A (Unreliable)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the ode's two images of time: “Age after age” and “untouched by Time”.

    Sample answer: Age after age describes the curse moving through generations of mortals, each forced to drain the cup. Untouched by Time describes Zeus, who stands outside that process. The contrast shows human beings caught in time and suffering, while the divine power that punishes excess is permanent and beyond reach.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the view of humanity in this ode with the Ode on Man.

    Sample answer: The Ode on Man celebrated human daring and skill, limited only by death and by the need to honour law and the gods. This ode is darker: humans are victims of inherited curses and deceptive hope, and Zeus's power crushes all excess. Together the odes show human greatness and human helplessness side by side.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode prepare the audience for the confrontation between Haemon and Creon?

    Sample answer: The ode ends with Haemon's arrival and the Chorus's question whether he grieves for his bride. Its warnings about excess, deceptive hope and Fate's sword hang over the scene to come. The audience expects a clash between son and father and suspects that whoever exceeds the mean will be punished.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the elders' role as commentators in this ode. Are they wise, fearful or evasive?

    Sample answer: The elders speak wisely about the dangers of excess and false hope, but they never name Creon or criticise his sentence directly. Their talk of curses and Fate can be read as insight or as a way to avoid accusing the king. A strong answer judges their stance and supports it with lines from the ode.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588) develops the idea of the curse on the house. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" could deliver about the curse on the house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse on the house in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the curse on the house. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" could deliver about the curse on the house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse on the house in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588) suggests about the curse on the house. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" could deliver about the curse on the house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse on the house in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588) to complicate the reader's understanding of the curse on the house. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)" could deliver about the curse on the house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse on the house in "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Thrice blest are they who never tasted pain! If once the curse of Heaven attaint a race, The infection lingers on and speeds apace, Age after age, and each the cup must drain. So when Etesian blasts from Thrace downpour Sweep o'er the blackening main and whirl to land From Ocean's cavernous depths his ooze and sand, Billow on billow thunders on the shore. On the Labdacidae I see descending Woe upon woe; from days of old some god Laid on the race a malison, and his rod Scourges each age with sorrows never ending. The light that dawned upon its last born son Is vanished, and the bloody axe of Fate Has felled the goodly tree that blossomed late. O Oedipus, by reckless pride undone!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)"?

   A. The curse on the house

   B. A praise of desire as a force none can resist

   C. A catalog of prisoners held in underground cells

   D. Antigone before Creon

SAT key: 1. A (The curse on the house)

Lesson 8: Episode 3 (lines 589–736)

Focus: Haemon and his father

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Episode 3 (lines 589–736)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: “What does this passage make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Haemon, Creon's son and Antigone's betrothed, at first speaks respectfully, then urges his father to listen: the city secretly sympathizes with Antigone, and a wise man bends. Creon refuses; the argument grows bitter and Haemon leaves. Creon spares Ismene and sentences Antigone to be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.

Background: In Athens, ideas about rule by one man were debated openly; Haemon's "A State for one man is no State at all" (line 692) speaks to that debate.

Significance: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to pride and stubbornness because....
Prompt: How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to pride and stubbornness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Haemon’s flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon’s refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context.
Today's words: homicide — the killing of a person; consort — to keep company or associate (with); taint — a stain or pollution, especially of guilt; untrod — not walked on by people; spaniel — a dog that fawns and follows; helm — the tiller or wheel that steers a ship.
Words: homicide: the killing of a person · consort: to keep company or associate (with) · taint: a stain or pollution, especially of guilt · untrod: not walked on by people · spaniel: a dog that fawns and follows · helm: the tiller or wheel that steers a ship

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In Athens, ideas about rule by one man were debated openly; Haemon's "A State for one man is no State at all" (line 692) speaks to that debate. The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Conflict: Father and son argue over how a city should be ruled: Creon's "Am I to rule for others, or myself?" against Haemon's "A State for one man is no State at all." Characterization: Haemon begins in deference and ends in bitter warning; Creon hardens from principle into the refusal to yield that the play will punish. Imagery: Trees that yield in flood survive, and trees that resist perish "root and branch," so Haemon turns political advice into a picture of bending or breaking. Watch for burial and the unburied body: Creon changes Antigone's sentence from open stoning to a rock-hewn cave with a little food, a living tomb that keeps her death officially off his hands.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong" slowly and put it in my own words: Haemon asks his father not to lock himself into a single mood or to assume that only he is right. Next, craft. "Cling not to one mood" makes stubbornness sound like a grip, and "thou art right, all others wrong" exposes the isolation of that grip in four plain words. The strongest word is "cling": it makes the father's one mood sound like a grip he will not loosen. Then, effect. What do lines 660–661 reveal about Haemon and his father? My answer: Haemon is still speaking as a son, but he is already warning the king. The trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) state the lesson Creon will not take in time.

> *Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong (Episode 3, lines 660–661)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong" slowly and put it in my own words: Haemon asks his father not to lock himself into a single mood or to assume that only he is right. Next, craft. "Cling not to one mood" makes stubbornness sound like a grip, and "thou art right, all others wrong" exposes the isolation of that grip in four plain words. The strongest word is "cling": it makes the father's one mood sound like a grip he will not loosen. Then, effect. What do lines 660–661 reveal about Haemon and his father? My answer: Haemon is still speaking as a son, but he is already warning the king. The trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) state the lesson Creon will not take in time.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Yield", "unharmed" and "perish root and branch" stand out. Trees that bend survive and trees that resist are destroyed, so Haemon urges his father to give way before it is too late. Ask: How does this line connect to pride and stubbornness? Expected student answer: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. (Haemon, lines 667–669.)

> *See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch (Episode 3, lines 667–669)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Yield", "unharmed" and "perish root and branch" stand out in lines 667–669. Trees that bend in a flood survive, and trees that resist are destroyed, so Haemon urges his father to give way before it is too late. The wording makes stubbornness look like a root that can be torn up.
Ask: How does this line connect to pride and stubbornness?
Expected student answer: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. (Haemon, lines 667–669.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Haemon and his father? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 589–736) develops the idea of Haemon and his father. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. When the text says "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669), it shows this directly. Haemon, Creon's son and Antigone's betrothed, at first speaks respectfully, then urges his father to listen: the city secretly sympathizes with Antigone, and a wise man bends. Creon refuses; the argument grows bitter and Haemon leaves. Creon spares Ismene and sentences Antigone to be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.

Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Haemon and his father? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 589–736) develops the idea of Haemon and his father. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. When the text says "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669), it shows this directly. Haemon, Creon's son and Antigone's betrothed, at first speaks respectfully, then urges his father to listen: the city secretly sympathizes with Antigone, and a wise man bends. Creon refuses; the argument grows bitter and Haemon leaves. Creon spares Ismene and sentences Antigone to be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect? Ask: How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect?

Anchor question: How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect?

Facilitation: Ask: How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Haemon and his father? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. ("See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch", Episode 3, lines 667–669). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Haemon and his father? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. ("See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch", Episode 3, lines 667–669). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes Haemon and his father. Key takeaway: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Father and son argue over how a city should be ruled: Creon's "Am I to rule for others, or myself?" against Haemon's "A State for one man is no State at all."
- **Characterization:** Haemon begins in deference and ends in bitter warning; Creon hardens from principle into the refusal to yield that the play will punish.
- **Imagery:** Trees that yield in flood survive, and trees that resist perish "root and branch," so Haemon turns political advice into a picture of bending or breaking.

Themes and how they develop

- **pride and stubbornness:** Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** Creon changes Antigone's sentence from open stoning to a rock-hewn cave with a little food, a living tomb that keeps her death officially off his hands.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong" (Episode 3, lines 660–661) Haemon, lines 660–661.

- "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669) Haemon, lines 667–669.
- "Am I to rule for others, or myself" (Episode 3, line 691) Creon, line 691.
- "A State for one man is no State at all" (Episode 3, line 692) Haemon, line 692.
- "The State is his who rules it, so 'tis held" (Episode 3, line 693) Creon, line 693.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late.
Evidence: "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669)
Reasoning: Haemon, Creon's son and Antigone's betrothed, at first speaks respectfully, then urges his father to listen: the city secretly sympathizes with Antigone, and a wise man bends. Creon refuses; the argument grows bitter and Haemon leaves. Creon spares Ismene and sentences Antigone to be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 592
592 **Creon:** Know'st not whate'er we do is done in love?

Line 594
594 **Haemon:** Thy wisdom as the helm to steer withal.

Lines 597–598
597 **Creon:** Well spoken: so right-minded sons should feel,
598 **Creon:** In all deferring to a father's will.

Lines 597–610
597 **Creon:** Well spoken: so right-minded sons should feel,
598 **Creon:** In all deferring to a father's will.
599 **Creon:** For 'tis the hope of parents they may rear
600 **Creon:** A brood of sons submissive, keen to avenge
601 **Creon:** Their father's wrongs, and count his friends their own.
602 **Creon:** But who begets unprofitable sons,
603 **Creon:** He verily breeds trouble for himself,
604 **Creon:** And for his foes much laughter. Son, be warned
605 **Creon:** And let no woman fool away thy wits.
606 **Creon:** Ill fares the husband mated with a shrew,
607 **Creon:** And her embraces very soon wax cold.
608 **Creon:** For what can wound so surely to the quick
609 **Creon:** As a false friend? So spue and cast her off,
610 **Creon:** Bid her go find a husband with the dead.

Lines 622–623
622 **Creon:** I never will allow. Whome'er the State
623 **Creon:** Appoints must be obeyed in everything,

Line 629

629 **Creon:** What evils are not wrought by Anarchy!

Lines 633–636

633 **Creon:** Therefore we must maintain authority
634 **Creon:** And yield to tittle to a woman's will.
635 **Creon:** Better, if needs be, men should cast us out
636 **Creon:** Than hear it said, a woman proved his match.

Lines 635–636

635 **Creon:** Better, if needs be, men should cast us out
636 **Creon:** Than hear it said, a woman proved his match.

Lines 639–640

639 **Haemon:** Father, the gods implant in mortal men
640 **Haemon:** Reason, the choicest gift bestowed by heaven.

Lines 660–661

660 **Haemon:** Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood,
661 **Haemon:** And deem not thou art right, all others wrong.

Line 664

664 **Haemon:** Such oracles are empty breath when tried.

Lines 667–669

667 **Haemon:** See how the trees beside a stream in flood
668 **Haemon:** Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed,
669 **Haemon:** But by resisting perish root and branch.

Line 684

684 **Haemon:** Weigh me upon my merit, not my years.

Line 691

691 **Creon:** Am I to rule for others, or myself?

Line 692

692 **Haemon:** A State for one man is no State at all.

Line 693

693 **Creon:** The State is his who rules it, so 'tis held.

Line 694

694 **Haemon:** As monarch of a desert thou wouldst shine.

Line 701

701 **Creon:** O heart corrupt, a woman's minion thou!

Line 716

716 **Creon:** At once, beside her bridegroom, in his sight.

Line 734

734 **Creon:** The King of Death, the one god she reveres,

Line 736

736 **Creon:** 'Tis labour lost, to reverence the dead.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
homicide (noun)	the killing of a person	*She shall be taken to some desert place By man untrod, and in a rock-hewn cave, With food no more than to avoid the taint That homicide might bring on all the State, Buried alive.*
consort (verb)	to keep company or associate (with)	*Go, consort With friends who like a madman for their mate.*
taint (noun)	a stain or pollution, especially of guilt	*With food no more than to avoid the taint*
untrod (adjective)	not walked on by people	*By man untrod, and in a rock-hewn cave,*
spaniel (noun)	a dog that fawns and follows	*Play not the spaniel, thou a woman's slave.*
helm (noun)	the tiller or wheel that steers a ship	*Thy wisdom as the helm to steer withal.*

Discussion questions

1. How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with family and the State?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Haemon warn his father against in lines 660–661? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Clinging to one mood and thinking he alone is right.
   Answer guidance: Clinging to one mood and thinking he alone is right.

2. What does Haemon call reason in lines 639–640? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The choicest gift that heaven has planted in mortal men.

   Answer guidance: The choicest gift that heaven has planted in mortal men.
3. Why does Creon refuse to be taught by Haemon (lines 681–682)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He scorns being schooled in prudence, at his age, by a beardless boy.

   Answer guidance: He scorns being schooled in prudence, at his age, by a beardless boy.
4. What makes Creon change his sentence on Ismene (lines 725–727)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The elders ask whether he means to put both sisters to death, and he limits it to the one who touched the body.

   Answer guidance: The elders ask whether he means to put both sisters to death, and he limits it to the one who touched the body.
5. Who is Haemon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Creon's son, engaged to Antigone

   Answer guidance: Creon's son, engaged to Antigone.
6. What does Haemon say the city thinks? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** People secretly sympathize with Antigone

   Answer guidance: People secretly sympathize with Antigone.
7. What do the trees in a flood teach? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Those that bend survive; those that resist are destroyed

   Answer guidance: Those that bend survive; those that resist are destroyed.
8. How does Creon answer "A State for one man is no State at all"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The State belongs to whoever rules it

   Answer guidance: The State belongs to whoever rules it.
9. What sentence does Creon decide for Antigone? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food

   Answer guidance: To be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.
10. Retell the most important events of “Episode 3 (lines 589–736)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Haemon, Creon's son and Antigone's betrothed, at first speaks respectfully, then urges his father to listen: the city secretly sympathizes with Antigone, and a wise man bends. Creon refuses; the argument grows bitter and Haemon leaves. Creon spares Ismene and sentences Antigone to be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.

    Answer guidance: Haemon, Creon's son and Antigone's betrothed, at first speaks respectfully, then urges his father to listen: the city secretly sympathizes with Antigone, and a wise man bends. Creon refuses; the argument grows bitter and Haemon leaves. Creon spares Ismene and sentences Antigone to be shut in a rock-hewn cave with a little food.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Creon grow angrier as Haemon argues? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He hears his son's advice as a challenge to his authority, with evidence from the quarrel.

   Answer guidance: Creon hears Haemon's counsel as a challenge to his rule, not as advice. He asks whether "the mob" shall dictate policy and whether he is "to rule for others, or myself" (lines 689–691), calls his son "a woman's minion" (line 701), and finally threatens Antigone's death "beside her bridegroom, in his sight" (lines 715–716). The anger rises because the son's argument threatens the king's authority.
2. What does "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" suggest about Haemon and his father? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late.

   Answer guidance: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Evidence to accept: "Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong" (Episode 3, lines 660–661): Haemon, lines 660–661. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of conflict in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)". What does it reveal about Haemon and his father that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other. Evidence to accept: "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669): Haemon, lines 667–669. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" shape what we understand about Haemon and his father? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong" (Episode 3, lines 660–661): Haemon, lines 660–661. On characterization: Haemon begins in deference and ends in bitter warning; Creon hardens from principle into the refusal to yield that the play will punish. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Well spoken: so right-minded sons should feel, In all deferring to a father's will.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Am I to rule for others, or myself" (Episode 3, line 691): Creon, line 691. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Haemon's report that the city pities Antigone; the quarrel in which father and son stop listening; the effect, Antigone's sentence to be shut in a rock cave.

Answer guidance: Look for: Haemon's report that the city pities Antigone; the quarrel in which father and son stop listening; the effect, Antigone's sentence to be shut in a rock cave. Evidence to accept: "A State for one man is no State at all" (Episode 3, line 692): Haemon, line 692. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" build on "Stasimon 2 (lines 549–588)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669): Haemon, lines 667–669. Theme link: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Haemon and his father, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "Am I to rule for others, or myself" (Episode 3, line 691): Creon, line 691. On characterization: Haemon begins in deference and ends in bitter warning; Creon hardens from principle into the refusal to yield that the play will punish. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How should you disagree with a parent or authority figure you respect?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "The State is his who rules it, so 'tis held" (Episode 3, line 693): Creon, line 693. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does imagery appear in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)", and how does it connect Haemon and his father to the larger concern with family and the State? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "A State for one man is no State at all" (Episode 3, line 692): Haemon, line 692. On imagery: Trees that yield in flood survive, and trees that resist perish "root and branch," so Haemon turns political advice into a picture of bending or breaking. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Haemon loyal or disloyal to his father? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position, loyal or disloyal, that cites Haemon's own lines (for example 593, 683, 692, 696, 700).
   Answer guidance: A strong answer can defend loyalty: Haemon begins "O father, I am thine" (line 593) and says he prizes his father's good name (lines 656–659); he pleads "for justice, father, nothing more" (line 683) and "My thought's for thee" (line 696). It can also argue disloyalty: he tells Creon "A State for one man is no State at all" (line 692) and that Creon "spurn'st the due of Heaven" (line 700). The best answers show that Haemon claims loyalty while opposing the edict.
2. Haemon says the wisest man lets himself be swayed. Is that good advice for a ruler in every case? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
3. How much does pride in being a man drive Creon's choices? Argue with lines 633–636 and 695–701. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "Am I to rule for others, or myself" (Episode 3, line 691): Creon, line 691. Theme link: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Which character in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" acts most wisely in the matter of Haemon and his father, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "A State for one man is no State at all" (Episode 3, line 692): Haemon, line 692. On characterization: Haemon begins in deference and ends in bitter warning; Creon hardens from principle into the refusal to yield that the play will punish. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. You are directing "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Haemon and his father. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669)

states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "The State is his who rules it, so 'tis held" (Episode 3, line 693): Creon, line 693. Theme link: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "Therefore, my father, cling not to one mood, / And deem not thou art right, all others wrong" (Episode 3, lines 660–661): Haemon, lines 660–661. Theme link: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)", with its focus on Haemon and his father, to pride and stubbornness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "See how the trees beside a stream in flood / Save, if they yield to force, each spray unharmed, / But by resisting perish root and branch" (Episode 3, lines 667–669): Haemon, lines 667–669. Theme link: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the conflict in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" effective in presenting Haemon and his father, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "Am I to rule for others, or myself" (Episode 3, line 691): Creon, line 691. On conflict: Father and son argue over how a city should be ruled: Creon's "Am I to rule for others, or myself?" against Haemon's "A State for one man is no State at all." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" treats Haemon and his father with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The image of trees that bend in a flood (lines 667–669) states the play's lesson that Creon learns too late. Useful evidence: "A State for one man is no State at all" (Episode 3, line 692): Haemon, line 692. Theme link: Haemon's flood-trees urge Creon to bend before he

snaps; Creon's refusal to hear the city or his son is the stubbornness that divine warning will later break. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Haemon first answer his father?

   A. He promises to follow his father's wisdom

   B. He threatens to leave Thebes for ever with her

   C. He begs at once for Antigone's life to be spared

   D. He refuses to speak

   Key: A (He promises to follow his father's wisdom)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon tell Haemon to do with Antigone?

   A. Marry her at once

   B. Cast her off

   C. Hide her in the palace

   D. Send her to Argos

   Key: B (Cast her off)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon say discipline preserves?

   A. The city's wealth

   B. The temples of the gods

   C. The ordered ranks

   D. The royal family

   Key: C (The ordered ranks)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's line: "What evils are not wrought by _____!"

   Key: Anarchy

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Haemon say the people think Antigone deserves?

   A. Death by stoning

   B. Exile from Thebes

   C. A trial before the elders

   D. Her name written in gold

   Key: D (Her name written in gold)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Haemon's image, what happens to a mariner who keeps the sail taut in a gale?

   A. The ship overturns

B. The ship reaches port first

C. The gods praise the sailor

D. The crew rebels

Key: A (The ship overturns)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Haemon leave, according to the Chorus?

   A. Laughing

   B. In angry haste

   C. In chains

   D. Weeping quietly

   Key: B (In angry haste)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Creon decide to spare after the Chorus questions him?

   A. Antigone

   B. The Guard

   C. Ismene

   D. Haemon

   Key: C (Ismene)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Creon defend his sentence on Antigone in his first speech to Haemon?

   Sample answer: Creon says he caught Antigone openly rebelling, the one malcontent among his subjects, and he will not be a traitor to the State. If he allows rebellion in his own house, he will encourage it in the city. A ruler who governs his household well will govern the city well, so he must punish her.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What arguments does Haemon use to change his father's mind?

    Sample answer: Haemon says the people secretly praise Antigone, though they fear to say so before the king. He warns his father not to think he alone is right and compares him to trees that break in a flood and a sailor whose ship overturns. He urges Creon to listen to good advice and relent.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon say a father wants obedient sons?

    A. To take his side against his enemies

    B. To inherit his wealth as quickly as possible

    C. To keep the house quiet at night

    D. To care for him when he grows old

    Key: A (To take his side against his enemies)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: “Whome’er the State Appoints must be _____ in everything”

    Key: obeyed

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon mean by “Better, if needs be, men should cast us out Than hear it said, a woman proved his match”?

    A. He secretly wants to leave Thebes for good

    B. Defeat by a woman is worse than exile

C. He respects Antigone's courage

D. He fears that the people will rebel

Key: B (Defeat by a woman is worse than exile)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say after Creon's speech on Anarchy?

A. He has lost his mind

B. He should set Antigone free at once

C. His words seem reasonable and wise

D. He speaks like a tyrant

Key: C (His words seem reasonable and wise)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Haemon say he can hear what Creon cannot?

A. He spies on the elders

B. He has a gift from the gods

C. Antigone tells him everything in secret

D. People fear to speak before the king

Key: D (People fear to speak before the king)

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Haemon mean by "Such oracles are empty breath when tried"?

A. Self-certain wisdom fails when tested

B. Prophets cannot be trusted

C. Only the gods are truly wise

D. Words matter less than deeds

Key: A (Self-certain wisdom fails when tested)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's question "Am I to rule for others, or myself?" reveal?

A. He wants the people to vote on the matter

B. He thinks a ruler answers to no one

C. He plans to give up the throne soon

D. He fears the anger of the gods

Key: B (He thinks a ruler answers to no one)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone does Creon use toward Haemon in lines 701 and 711?

A. Gentle

B. Fearful

C. Insulting

D. Grateful

Key: C (Insulting)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the argument between father and son change from calm to angry?

Sample answer: Haemon begins respectfully, calling himself his father's and praising reason as a gift of the gods. Creon

dismisses him as a beardless boy, and the talk turns into one-line retorts. Haemon accuses Creon of spurning the gods, Creon calls him a woman's slave, and the scene ends with Haemon storming out.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Haemon say he speaks as a loyal son, not an enemy?

    Sample answer: Haemon says nothing is more precious to him than his father's well-being, since children take pride in a father's good name. He reports the people's murmurs so that Creon will not damage his reputation. He presents his advice as care for his father, not as rebellion.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Haemon mean by taking his father's wisdom "as the helm to steer withal"?

    A. He will be guided by it

    B. He will seize the throne

    C. He will sail away from Thebes

    D. He will reject it in time

    Key: A (He will be guided by it)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Haemon's line: "Weigh me upon my merit, not my _____."

    Key: years

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device appears in "As monarch of a desert thou wouldst shine"?

    A. Simile

    B. Sarcasm

    C. Alliteration

    D. Understatement

    Key: B (Sarcasm)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Creon link the household to the State?

    A. The family must obey the people

    B. The State should pay for every household

    C. Order at home proves fitness to rule

    D. Only married men may hold office

    Key: C (Order at home proves fitness to rule)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why is Creon's demand that the State be obeyed "just and unjust alike" troubling?

    A. It gives the people too much power

    B. It honours the gods too highly

    C. It limits the power of the king

    D. It puts obedience above justice

    Key: D (It puts obedience above justice)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Haemon's shift from respectful speech to sharp retorts show?

    A. His patience has run out

B. He has changed sides

C. He is afraid of Creon

D. He now agrees with Creon

Key: A (His patience has run out)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon reveal by calling Haemon “a woman’s slave”?

A. He admires Haemon's loyalty to his bride

B. He treats any defiance as unmanly

C. He thinks Haemon is a servant in the house

D. He fears that Ismene controls his son

Key: B (He treats any defiance as unmanly)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's “I stand corrected” about Ismene show?

A. He has forgiven Antigone

B. He is afraid of his son's threats

C. He can still yield on small points

D. He has decided to trust the gods

Key: C (He can still yield on small points)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze Haemon's flood and sail images (lines 667–672).

Sample answer: Haemon says trees that bend beside a flooding stream keep every branch, while those that resist are torn up by the roots; a sailor who will not slacken his sheet in a gale capsizes. Both images teach that strength lies in yielding. They warn Creon that his rigid will is the very thing that will destroy him.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate who wins the argument between Creon and Haemon.

Sample answer: Haemon argues with reason, reports the people's view and offers clear images of the danger of rigidity, while Creon answers with insults about youth and women. Yet Creon keeps his power and Haemon leaves in anger. A strong answer distinguishes between who argues better and who prevails, and supports the judgment with lines.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in Creon's question “Know’st not whate’er we do is done in love?”?

A. His decree destroys his son's love

B. He secretly loves Antigone himself

C. He is lying to the elders

D. He has no son to love

Key: A (His decree destroys his son's love)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: “’Tis labour lost, to reverence the _____.”

Key: dead

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon want Antigone to die “beside her bridegroom, in his sight”?

A. To honour their marriage

B. To punish Haemon's defiance

C. To test Haemon's loyalty

D. To please the people

Key: B (To punish Haemon's defiance)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Haemon's argument appeal to Creon's own values?

A. He threatens to raise the army against him

B. He quotes the ancient laws of Argos

C. He presents it as concern for Creon's name

D. He praises Antigone's courage above all

Key: C (He presents it as concern for Creon's name)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Creon's phrase "The King of Death, the one god she reveres" suggest?

A. He fears the god of death

B. He respects her faith

C. He worships death himself

D. He mocks her piety

Key: D (He mocks her piety)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] The Chorus's "both have spoken well" characterizes the elders as

A. Cautious and unwilling to take sides

B. Bold critics of the king

C. Loyal only to Haemon

D. Ignorant of the issue

Key: A (Cautious and unwilling to take sides)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how this episode develops the play's tension between gender and power.

Sample answer: Creon warns Haemon not to let a woman fool his wits, insists on yielding no tittle to a woman's will, and calls his son a woman's slave. Haemon answers that his thought is for Creon, if Creon is the woman. Creon's fear of being beaten by a woman makes compromise impossible, because yielding would feel like losing his manhood and his rule.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare Haemon's idea of the State with Creon's.

Sample answer: Creon says the State belongs to whoever rules it and that its appointed ruler must be obeyed in everything, just or unjust. Haemon replies that a State for one man is no State at all and that the people's voice matters. Creon sees the State as the ruler's possession; Haemon sees it as a community the ruler serves.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the end of the episode change the stakes of the play?

Sample answer: Haemon leaves vowing that his father will never see his face again, and Creon fixes Antigone's punishment: to be taken to a lonely place and shut in a rock-hewn cave. The conflict now threatens Creon's own family as well as Antigone. The audience fears that the decree will cost Creon his son.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Haemon's love for Antigone weakens or strengthens his argument.

Sample answer: Creon dismisses Haemon as pleading for a woman, so his love lets his father ignore his reasons. Yet Haemon argues mostly from the city's view, his father's reputation and the danger of rigidity, not from love. A strong answer weighs whether his feelings undercut his case or give it urgency, using his lines as evidence.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 589–736) develops the idea of Haemon and his father. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" could deliver about Haemon and his father. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Haemon and his father in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 3 (lines 589–736) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Haemon and his father. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" could deliver about Haemon and his father. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Haemon and his father in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 3 (lines 589–736) suggests about Haemon and his father. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" could deliver about Haemon and his father. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Haemon and his father in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Episode 3 (lines 589–736) to complicate the reader's understanding of Haemon and his father. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)" could deliver about Haemon and his father. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Haemon and his father in "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Well spoken: so right-minded sons should feel, In all deferring to a father's will. For 'tis the hope of parents they may rear A brood of sons submissive, keen to avenge Their father's wrongs, and count his friends their own. But who begets unprofitable sons, He verily breeds trouble for himself, And for his foes much laughter. Son, be warned And let no woman fool away thy wits. Ill fares the husband mated with a shrew, And her embraces very soon wax cold. For what can wound so surely to the quick As a false friend? So spue and cast her off, Bid her go find a husband with the dead.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 589–736)"?

   A. Two sisters, one choice
   B. Haemon and his father
   C. The city's victory song
   D. The Ode on Man

SAT key: 1. B (Haemon and his father)

Lesson 9: Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)

Focus: the Ode to Love

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752) (the Ode to Love) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus sings of the irresistible power of Love, which overcomes gods and mortals and has set son against father.

Background: Eros (Love) was a powerful god in Greek belief; the elders trace the quarrel to Love they have just seen.

Significance: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can strong feelings be a good reason for an argument, or do they cloud judgment? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....*
> **Prompt:** Can strong feelings be a good reason for an argument, or do they cloud judgment?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Even as they grant Love's power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Today's words: resistless — (poetic) impossible to resist; trackless — having no path or trail; winsome — charming in a sweet or appealing way; yearning — a deep longing; invincible — impossible to defeat; bower — a leafy shelter or inner chamber. Eros (Love) was a powerful god in Greek belief; the elders trace the quarrel to Love they have just seen. The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Imagery: Love is given eyes, a pillow and a roaming path over folds and sea, so an abstract power becomes a figure that touches bodies and places. Theme: The elders blame the quarrel on Love's irresistible force, reducing Haemon's argument about the State to passion alone. Tone / mood: The ode is half hymn and half confession: the Chorus admits it is "borne aside, From Justice" as it looks at the bride. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The "bride" they pity is walking toward a tomb, so the love-song is already a burial song in disguise.
Words: resistless: (poetic) impossible to resist · trackless: having no path or trail · winsome: charming in a sweet or appealing way · yearning: a deep longing · invincible: impossible to defeat · bower: a leafy shelter or inner chamber

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the Ode to Love. Key takeaway: Even as they grant Love's power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Love is given eyes, a pillow and a roaming path over folds and sea, so an abstract power becomes a figure that touches bodies and places.
- **Theme:** The elders blame the quarrel on Love's irresistible force, reducing Haemon's argument about the State to passion alone.
- **Tone / mood:** The ode is half hymn and half confession: the Chorus admits it is "borne aside, From Justice" as it looks at the bride.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** Even as they grant Love's power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The "bride" they pity is walking toward a tomb, so the love-song is already a burial song in disguise.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea" (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739) Chorus, lines 737–739.
- "Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride" (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748) Chorus, lines 747–748.
- "Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart / Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart" (Stasimon 3, lines 741–742) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support.
Evidence: "Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea" (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739)
Reasoning: The Chorus sings of the irresistible power of Love, which overcomes gods and mortals and has set son against father.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 737–739

737 **Chorus:** Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye,
738 **Chorus:** Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie,
739 **Chorus:** Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea.

Lines 737–752

737 **Chorus:** Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye,
738 **Chorus:** Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie,
739 **Chorus:** Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea.
740 **Chorus:** Love the gods captive holds. Shall mortals not yield to thee?
741 **Chorus:** Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart
742 **Chorus:** Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart.
743 **Chorus:** Thou didst kindle the strife, this feud of kinsman with kin,
744 **Chorus:** By the eyes of a winsome wife, and the yearning her heart to win.
745 **Chorus:** For as her consort still, enthroned with Justice above,
746 **Chorus:** Thou bendest man to thy will, O all invincible Love.
747 **Chorus:** Lo I myself am borne aside,
748 **Chorus:** From Justice, as I view this bride.
749 **Chorus:** (O sight an eye in tears to drown)
750 **Chorus:** Antigone, so young, so fair,
751 **Chorus:** Thus hurried down
752 **Chorus:** Death's bower with the dead to share.

Line 740

740 **Chorus:** Love the gods captive holds. Shall mortals not yield to thee?

Lines 741–742
741 **Chorus:** Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart
742 **Chorus:** Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart.

Lines 743–744
743 **Chorus:** Thou didst kindle the strife, this feud of kinsman with kin,
744 **Chorus:** By the eyes of a winsome wife, and the yearning her heart to win.

Lines 743–746
743 **Chorus:** Thou didst kindle the strife, this feud of kinsman with kin,
744 **Chorus:** By the eyes of a winsome wife, and the yearning her heart to win.
745 **Chorus:** For as her consort still, enthroned with Justice above,
746 **Chorus:** Thou bendest man to thy will, O all invincible Love.

Line 746
746 **Chorus:** Thou bendest man to thy will, O all invincible Love.

Line 747
747 **Chorus:** Lo I myself am borne aside,

Lines 747–748
747 **Chorus:** Lo I myself am borne aside,
748 **Chorus:** From Justice, as I view this bride.

Lines 747–752
747 **Chorus:** Lo I myself am borne aside,
748 **Chorus:** From Justice, as I view this bride.
749 **Chorus:** (O sight an eye in tears to drown)
750 **Chorus:** Antigone, so young, so fair,
751 **Chorus:** Thus hurried down
752 **Chorus:** Death's bower with the dead to share.

Line 748
748 **Chorus:** From Justice, as I view this bride.

Lines 749–750
749 **Chorus:** (O sight an eye in tears to drown)
750 **Chorus:** Antigone, so young, so fair,

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
resistless (adjective)	(poetic) impossible to resist	*Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie, Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea.*

trackless (adjective)	having no path or trail	*Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea.*
winsome (adjective)	charming in a sweet or appealing way	*By the eyes of a winsome wife, and the yearning her heart to win.*
yearning (noun)	a deep longing	*By the eyes of a winsome wife, and the yearning her heart to win.*
invincible (adjective)	impossible to defeat	*Thou bendest man to thy will, O all invincible Love.*
bower (noun)	a leafy shelter or inner chamber	*Death's bower with the dead to share.*

Discussion questions

1. Can strong feelings be a good reason for an argument, or do they cloud judgment?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and stubbornness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Where does Love lie "all night"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** On a maiden's cheek.
   Answer guidance: On a maiden's cheek.
2. What does the Chorus say happens to even the wisest heart at a touch of Love's dart (lines 741–742)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It falls straight to folly.
   Answer guidance: It falls straight to folly.
3. What sight moves the elders to tears at the end of the ode (lines 747–752)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Antigone, so young and fair, led down to the bower of Death.
   Answer guidance: Antigone, so young and fair, led down to the bower of Death.
4. Whom does Love hold captive, according to line 740? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Even the gods, so mortals cannot hope to resist.
   Answer guidance: Even the gods, so mortals cannot hope to resist.
5. What power does the Chorus praise? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The irresistible power of Love
   Answer guidance: The irresistible power of Love.

6. What do all do at a glance of Love's eye? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Yield
   Answer guidance: Yield.
7. What quarrel does the Chorus trace to Love? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Haemon's quarrel with his father
   Answer guidance: Haemon's quarrel with his father.
8. Where does Love roam, according to lines 737–739? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Over upland folds and the trackless sea
   Answer guidance: Over upland folds and the trackless sea.
9. How would you describe the tone of the ode to Love? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Awed and wondering
   Answer guidance: Awed and wondering.
10. Retell the most important events of "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus sings of the irresistible power of Love, which overcomes gods and mortals and has set son against father.
    Answer guidance: The Chorus sings of the irresistible power of Love, which overcomes gods and mortals and has set son against father.

Inferential / analytical

1. Is the Chorus fair to Haemon in tracing the quarrel to Love? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Arguable: he also gave political reasons.
   Answer guidance: Arguable: he also gave political reasons.
2. What does "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" suggest about the Ode to Love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support.
   Answer guidance: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Evidence to accept: "Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea" (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739): Chorus, lines 737–739. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of imagery in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)". What does it reveal about the Ode to Love that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: "Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride" (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748): Chorus, lines 747–748. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the theme in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" shape what we understand about the Ode to Love? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden’s cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam’st, and the trackless sea” (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739): Chorus, lines 737–739. On theme: The elders blame the quarrel on Love’s irresistible force, reducing Haemon’s argument about the State to passion alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, Love who pillowed all night on a maiden’s cheek dost lie, Over the upland folds thou roam’st, and the trackless sea.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart / Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart” (Stasimon 3, lines 741–742): Chorus, in this part of the section. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Love's power over gods and mortals; the elders' tears at the sight of Antigone; the effect, pity entering the judgment of the play.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Love's power over gods and mortals; the elders' tears at the sight of Antigone; the effect, pity entering the judgment of the play. Evidence to accept: “Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden’s cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam’st, and the trackless sea” (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739): Chorus, lines 737–739. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)” build on “Episode 3 (lines 589–736)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride” (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748): Chorus, lines 747–748. Theme link: Even as they grant Love’s power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the Ode to Love, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart / Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart” (Stasimon 3, lines 741–742): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: Even as they grant Love’s power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can strong feelings be a good reason for an argument, or do they cloud judgment?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride” (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748): Chorus, lines 747–748. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)”, and how does it connect the Ode to Love to the larger concern with pride and stubbornness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden’s cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam’st, and the trackless sea” (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739): Chorus, lines 737–739. On tone / mood: The ode is half hymn and half confession: the Chorus admits it is “borne aside, From Justice” as it looks at the bride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the play present Love as a cause of ruin or of loyalty? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. The elders say pity bears them aside from Justice. Is it right for feeling to sway their judgment here? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
3. Is it fitting to call Love the consort of Justice just after it has stirred a family feud? Argue with lines 743–746. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defended position.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride” (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748): Chorus, lines 747–748. On theme: The elders blame the quarrel on Love’s irresistible force, reducing Haemon’s argument about the State to passion alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" acts most wisely in the matter of the Ode to Love, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: "Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart / Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart" (Stasimon 3, lines 741–742): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: Even as they grant Love's power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. You are directing "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Ode to Love. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: "Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea" (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739): Chorus, lines 737–739. Theme link: Even as they grant Love's power, the elders still speak of Justice and authority, so divine eros and human judgment pull them in opposite directions. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: "Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride" (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748): Chorus, lines 747–748. On theme: The elders blame the quarrel on Love's irresistible force, reducing Haemon's argument about the State to passion alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Connect "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)", with its focus on the Ode to Love, to gender and power: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: "Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart / Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart" (Stasimon 3, lines 741–742): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders blame the quarrel on Love's irresistible force, reducing Haemon's argument about the State to passion alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Is the imagery in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" effective in presenting the Ode to Love, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that

matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, / Love who pillowed all night on a maiden’s cheek dost lie, / Over the upland folds thou roam’st, and the trackless sea” (Stasimon 3, lines 737–739): Chorus, lines 737–739. On imagery: Love is given eyes, a pillow and a roaming path over folds and sea, so an abstract power becomes a figure that touches bodies and places. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)” treats the Ode to Love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders reduce Haemon's principled argument to passion, a judgment the play does not fully support. Useful evidence: “Lo I myself am borne aside, / From Justice, as I view this bride” (Stasimon 3, lines 747–748): Chorus, lines 747–748. On theme: The elders blame the quarrel on Love’s irresistible force, reducing Haemon’s argument about the State to passion alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] With what does the Chorus say Love's dart is tipped?

   A. Poison

   B. Gold

   C. Fire

   D. Honey

   Key: A (Poison)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Love's dart do to even the wisest heart?

   A. Makes it wiser and calmer than before

   B. Sends it straight into madness and error

   C. Turns it to stone and freezes all its feeling

   D. Heals its old grief

   Key: B (Sends it straight into madness and error)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “Antigone, so young, so _____”

   Key: fair

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the sight of Antigone do to the elders' eyes?

   A. Fills them with anger

   B. Closes them in sleep

   C. Drowns them in tears

   D. Blinds them with light

   Key: C (Drowns them in tears)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Beside whom does the Chorus say Love sits enthroned?

   A. Zeus

   B. Death

   C. Prudence

   D. Justice

   Key: D (Justice)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What kind of strife does the Chorus say Love has stirred?

   A. A strife between kinsmen

   B. A war between two cities

   C. A quarrel among the gods

   D. A contest among suitors

   Key: A (A strife between kinsmen)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the elders describe Antigone in lines 749–750?

   A. Proud and cold

   B. Young and lovely

   C. Old and very weary

   D. Wild and cruel

   Key: B (Young and lovely)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What feeling does the ode end with?

   A. Triumph

   B. Scorn

   C. Sorrow

   D. Boredom

   Key: C (Sorrow)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus say Love can do to gods and mortals?

   Sample answer: The Chorus says that all yield at a glance of Love's eye. Love roams over the upland folds and the trackless sea and holds even the gods captive, so mortals cannot hope to resist. Love even drives the wisest heart to folly with its poisoned dart.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why do the elders say they are borne aside from Justice?

    Sample answer: When the elders see Antigone, so young and fair, being led toward the bower of Death, they cannot hold back their tears. Their pity pulls them away from simply agreeing with Creon's justice, and they begin to feel for the girl they are watching go to her death.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In lines 743–744, what does the Chorus say stirred the strife?

    A. A bride's beauty and the longing to win her

B. A bitter dispute over who should hold the throne

C. A god's angry decree against the city

D. An old curse passed down in the family

Key: A (A bride's beauty and the longing to win her)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Thou didst _____ the strife"

Key: kindle

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom do the elders mean by "this bride" in line 748?

A. Ismene

B. Antigone

C. A priestess of Zeus

D. A maiden of Argos

Key: B (Antigone)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the ode's tone change in lines 747–752?

A. From quiet grief to wild joy at the news

B. From anger at Creon to calm acceptance

C. From praise of Love to personal grief

D. From fear of the gods to open mockery

Key: C (From praise of Love to personal grief)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "borne aside" mean in line 747?

A. Born again

B. Left behind

C. Pushed forward

D. Carried away

Key: D (Carried away)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of Love's "poisoned dart" suggest?

A. Love wounds and harms the mind

B. Love hunts wild animals

C. Love cures the sick

D. Love is weak, harmless and easily resisted

Key: A (Love wounds and harms the mind)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus mean by "O all invincible Love"?

A. Love is hidden from sight

B. No power can defeat Love

C. Love has lost its old strength

D. Love fights only for Thebes

Key: B (No power can defeat Love)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the question "Shall mortals not yield to thee?" imply?

A. Mortals should fight Love

B. Love serves mortals

C. Mortals cannot resist Love

D. Mortals are stronger than gods

Key: C (Mortals cannot resist Love)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode connect to the scene between Creon and Haemon?

Sample answer: The Chorus credits Love with the strife it has just watched, saying Love kindled this feud of kinsman with kin through the eyes of a winsome wife. In their view Haemon defied his father because he longs to win his bride, so the ode explains the quarrel as passion rather than principle.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What contrast does the ode draw between the power of Love and the power of mortals?

Sample answer: Love is resistless in fight and holds the gods themselves captive, roaming over land and sea. Mortals, even the wisest, fall into folly at a touch of Love's dart. The Chorus asks how mere mortals can resist a power that bends gods and men alike to its will.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does it mean that Love is "enthroned with Justice above"?

A. Love rules beside the highest laws

B. Love is the king of Thebes

C. Love has defeated Justice in battle at last

D. Love judges the dead below

Key: A (Love rules beside the highest laws)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Thou bendest man to thy will, O all _____ Love."

Key: invincible

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device does the Chorus use in speaking to Love as thou?

A. Hyperbole

B. Apostrophe

C. Irony

D. Onomatopoeia

Key: B (Apostrophe)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the ode judge Haemon's motives?

A. As purely political

B. As cowardly

C. As driven by passion

D. As ordered by the gods

Key: C (As driven by passion)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about the elders' tears at the end of the ode?

A. They weep with joy because she has been rescued

B. They secretly hate Antigone

C. They weep only for Creon

D. They pity the girl they did not defend

Key: D (They pity the girl they did not defend)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the phrase “Death’s bower” suggest?

A. Her tomb is a grim bridal chamber

B. A garden full of flowers

C. A hall in the palace

D. A temple of Zeus

Key: A (Her tomb is a grim bridal chamber)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What shift occurs when the Chorus says “Lo I myself”?

A. A new character suddenly enters the stage

B. The elders turn to their own feelings

C. The ode ends without warning

D. Creon begins to speak

Key: B (The elders turn to their own feelings)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which word best describes Love as the ode presents it?

A. Gentle

B. Foolish

C. Overpowering

D. Feeble

Key: C (Overpowering)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the ode's imagery of Love as a warrior.

Sample answer: The ode opens by calling Love resistless in fight, so that all yield at a glance of its eye, and later describes its poisoned dart. Love is a conqueror that takes the gods captive and makes subjects of mortals. The military imagery recalls the battle with Argos and suggests that passion can be as destructive as war.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how reliable the elders are as judges in this ode.

Sample answer: The elders credit Love with the strife, implying Haemon spoke only from passion for his bride. Yet in the scene before, Haemon argued from the city's view and his father's good name. At the end the elders are themselves carried from Justice by pity. A strong answer weighs these points and supports the judgment with lines.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode's pairing of Love with Justice complicate Creon's position?

A. Love's claims carry divine weight too

B. It proves Creon right after all

C. It shows that Love is unjust

D. It ignores Justice altogether

Key: A (Love's claims carry divine weight too)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “By the eyes of a _____ wife”

Key: winsome

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does placing the ode between Haemon's exit and Antigone's appearance achieve?

    A. It delays Creon's victory

    B. It turns sympathy toward the doomed girl

    C. It reveals the gods' plan

    D. It resolves the conflict

    Key: B (It turns sympathy toward the doomed girl)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The elders' words “borne aside From Justice” suggest that their pity

    A. Supports Creon's decree fully

    B. Comes from fear of Antigone

    C. Conflicts with their duty to the king's law

    D. Is only a pretence

    Key: C (Conflicts with their duty to the king's law)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why might the elders call Antigone “this bride” as she goes to death?

    A. Because she has already married Haemon in secret

    B. To mock her pride

    C. Because Creon has forgiven her

    D. To stress the marriage she will never have

    Key: D (To stress the marriage she will never have)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What view of human reason does the ode imply?

    A. Reason is helpless against passion

    B. Reason wins in the end

    C. Reason is a gift of Love

    D. Reason belongs only to the young and bold

    Key: A (Reason is helpless against passion)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the ode reframes the quarrel between Creon and Haemon.

    Sample answer: Haemon argued from reason, the people's view and his father's reputation, but the Chorus explains his defiance as the work of Love, who kindled this feud of kinsman with kin. By turning a political argument into a story of passion, the elders excuse Creon from having to answer Haemon's case, while also admitting that Love is a divine power no one escapes.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the Chorus's view of Love with Creon's view of women in Episode 3.

    Sample answer: Creon fears being ruled by a woman and calls Haemon a woman's slave; the Chorus agrees that Haemon is driven by love but presents Love as a divine power that bends gods and mortals alike. Creon treats passion as weakness to be crushed, while the elders treat it as an invincible force. Both reduce Haemon's argument to feeling.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the end of the ode prepare for the next scene?

    Sample answer: The elders say they are borne aside from Justice as they see Antigone, so young and fair, led toward

Death's bower. Their tears turn the audience's attention to her suffering and prepare for her appearance. The ode shifts sympathy away from Creon's law toward the girl who will die for her brother.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the ode presents Love as a destructive or an ennobling force.

    Sample answer: The ode shows Love driving the wisest heart to folly and kindling a feud of kinsman with kin, which suggests destruction. Yet it also places Love enthroned with Justice above, as a power with a rightful claim. A strong answer weighs both images, considers Haemon's loyalty to Antigone, and reaches a supported judgment.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752) develops the idea of the Ode to Love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)” could deliver about the Ode to Love. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode to Love in “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the Ode to Love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)” could deliver about the Ode to Love. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode to Love in “Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752) suggests about the Ode to Love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" could deliver about the Ode to Love. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode to Love in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752) to complicate the reader's understanding of the Ode to Love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)" could deliver about the Ode to Love. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Ode to Love in "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Love resistless in fight, all yield at a glance of thine eye, Love who pillowed all night on a maiden's cheek dost lie, Over the upland folds thou roam'st, and the trackless sea. Love the gods captive holds. Shall mortals not yield to thee? Mad are thy subjects all, and even the wisest heart Straight to folly will fall, at a touch of thy poisoned dart. Thou didst kindle the strife, this feud of kinsman with kin, By the eyes of a winsome wife, and the yearning her heart to win. For as her consort still, enthroned with Justice above, Thou bendest man to thy will, O all invincible Love. Lo I myself am borne aside, From Justice, as I view this bride. (O sight an eye in tears to drown) Antigone, so young, so fair, Thus hurried down Death's bower with the dead to share.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)"?

   A. A thanksgiving for Thebes's rescue at the gates

   B. A debate between father and son over the edict

   C. The Ode to Love

   D. Antigone before Creon

SAT key: 1. C (The Ode to Love)

Lesson 10: Episode 4 (lines 753–883)

Focus: Antigone's farewell

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Antigone is led toward her living tomb. She laments "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), compares herself to the daughter of Tantalus (Niobe in myth, though the play does not name her), and argues that a brother, once both parents are dead, can never be replaced. The Chorus both pities and reproaches her. Creon orders the guards to take her away.

Background: Goethe, in conversation with Eckermann, wished the brother argument (lines 849–854) could be removed (Eckermann, 1850, entry of March 28, 1827). It is part of the text and is taught in full.

Significance: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....
Prompt: Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Chorus grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context.
Today's words: sepulchred — buried; placed in a tomb; wither — to dry up and fade away; monstrous — shockingly wrong or unnatural; puissant — powerful or mighty in rank; unwept — not mourned with tears; bridal — of a wedding or a bride.
Words: sepulchred: buried; placed in a tomb · wither: to dry up and fade away · monstrous: shockingly wrong or unnatural · puissant: powerful or mighty in rank · unwept: not mourned with tears · bridal: of a wedding or a bride

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Goethe, in conversation with Eckermann, wished the brother argument (lines 849–854) could be removed (Eckermann, 1850, entry of March 28, 1827). It is part of the text and is taught in full. The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Characterization: Antigone's farewell mixes defiance with fear: "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), yet she still argues the irreplaceable claim of a brother. Tone / mood: Lament and rebuke share the stage; the Chorus pities her and still calls her a "self-willed rebel" who must die. Theme: Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law. Watch for burial and the unburied body: She is to wither "in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead," so her own body becomes the next unburied-and-yet-entombed figure.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" slowly and put it in my own words: Antigone asks whether any fate has been like hers, to be buried in a rock prison, to wither in a living tomb, belonging neither to the living nor to the dead. Next, craft. "Sepulchred" and "living tomb" turn the cave into a burial while she still breathes, and "alien midst the living and the dead" names the in-between place the sentence creates. The strongest word is "sepulchred": it buries her in the wording while she is still speaking. Then, effect. What do lines 793–796 reveal about Antigone's farewell? My answer: Antigone's farewell shows a defiant heroine who is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less; the wording lets us hear the cost of the stand she has already taken.

> *Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead* (Episode 4, lines 793–796)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" slowly and put it in my own words: Antigone asks whether any fate has been like hers, to be buried in a rock prison, to wither in a living tomb, belonging neither to the living nor to the dead. Next, craft. "Sepulchred" and "living tomb" turn the cave into a burial while she still breathes, and "alien midst the living and the dead" names the in-between place the sentence creates. The strongest word is "sepulchred": it buries her in the wording while she is still speaking. Then, effect. What do lines 793–796 reveal about Antigone's farewell? My answer: Antigone's farewell shows a defiant heroine who is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less; the wording lets us hear the cost of the stand she has already taken.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Claims", "rites" and "self-willed rebel" stand out. The elders grant that religion has its claims but still call Antigone a rebel against power, so their judgment is divided. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: The Chorus grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured. (Chorus, lines 813–818.)

> *Religion has her claims, 'tis true, / Let rites be paid when rites are due. / Yet is it ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway. / Thou hast withstood authority, / A self-willed rebel, thou must die (Episode 4, lines 813–818)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Claims", "rites" and "self-willed rebel" stand out in lines 813–818. The elders grant that religion has its claims, and that rites should be paid when they are due, but they still call Antigone a rebel against power, so their judgment is divided. "Self-willed rebel, thou must die" closes the grant with a sentence.
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: The Chorus grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured. (Chorus, lines 813–818.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Antigone's farewell? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 753–883) develops the idea of Antigone's farewell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. When the text says "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796), it shows this directly. Antigone is led toward her living tomb. She laments "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), compares herself to the daughter of Tantalus, and argues that a brother, once both parents are dead, can never be replaced. The Chorus both pities and reproaches her. Creon orders the guards to take her away.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Antigone's farewell? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 753–883) develops the idea of Antigone's farewell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. When the text says "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796), it shows this directly. Antigone is led toward her living tomb. She laments "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), compares herself to the daughter of Tantalus, and argues that a brother, once both parents are dead, can never be replaced. The Chorus both pities and reproaches her. Creon orders the guards to take her away.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time? Ask: Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time?

Anchor question: Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time?

Facilitation: Ask: Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Antigone's farewell? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. ("Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb", Episode 4, lines 793–796). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Antigone's farewell? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. ("Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb", Episode 4, lines 793–796). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Antigone's farewell. Key takeaway: The Chorus grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Antigone's farewell mixes defiance with fear: "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), yet she still argues the irreplaceable claim of a brother.
- **Tone / mood:** Lament and rebuke share the stage; the Chorus pities her and still calls her a "self-willed rebel" who must die.
- **Theme:** Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The Chorus grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** She is to wither "in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead," so her own body becomes the next unburied-and-yet-entombed figure.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796) Antigone, lines 793–796.
- "Religion has her claims, 'tis true, / Let rites be paid when rites are due. / Yet is it ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway. / Thou hast withstood authority, / A self-willed rebel, thou must die" (Episode 4, lines 813–818) Chorus, lines 813–818.
- "What is the law I call in aid? 'Tis thus / I argue. Had it been a husband dead / I might have wed another, and have borne / Another child, to take the dead child's place. / But, now my sire and mother both are dead, / No second brother can be born for me" (Episode 4, lines 849–854) Antigone, lines 849–854.
- "Alas, my piety is impious deemed" (Episode 4, line 865) Antigone, line 865.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less.
Evidence: "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796)
Reasoning: Antigone is led toward her living tomb. She laments "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), compares herself to the daughter of Tantalus, and argues that a brother, once both parents are dead, can never be replaced. The Chorus both pities and reproaches her. Creon orders the guards to take her away.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 753–754
753 **Antigone:** Friends, countrymen, my last farewell I make;
754 **Antigone:** My journey's done.

Lines 753–764
753 **Antigone:** Friends, countrymen, my last farewell I make;
754 **Antigone:** My journey's done.
755 **Antigone:** One last fond, lingering, longing look I take
756 **Antigone:** At the bright sun.
757 **Antigone:** For Death who puts to sleep both young and old
758 **Antigone:** Hales my young life,
759 **Antigone:** And beckons me to Acheron's dark fold,
760 **Antigone:** An unwed wife.
761 **Antigone:** No youths have sung the marriage song for me,
762 **Antigone:** My bridal bed
763 **Antigone:** No maids have strewn with flowers from the lea,
764 **Antigone:** 'Tis Death I wed.

Lines 765–770
765 **Chorus:** But bethink thee, thou art sped,
766 **Chorus:** Great and glorious, to the dead.

767 **Chorus:** Thou the sword's edge hast not tasted,
768 **Chorus:** No disease thy frame hath wasted.
769 **Chorus:** Freely thou alone shalt go
770 **Chorus:** Living to the dead below.

Lines 771–778

771 **Antigone:** Nay, but the piteous tale I've heard men tell
772 **Antigone:** Of Tantalus' doomed child,
773 **Antigone:** Chained upon Siphylus' high rocky fell,
774 **Antigone:** That clung like ivy wild,
775 **Antigone:** Drenched by the pelting rain and whirling snow,
776 **Antigone:** Left there to pine,
777 **Antigone:** While on her frozen breast the tears aye flow—
778 **Antigone:** Her fate is mine.

Lines 793–796

793 **Antigone:** Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom,
794 **Antigone:** Within a rock-built prison sepulchred,
795 **Antigone:** To fade and wither in a living tomb,
796 **Antigone:** And alien midst the living and the dead.

Line 796

796 **Antigone:** And alien midst the living and the dead.

Line 800

800 **Chorus:** Thou a father's guild dost bear.

Line 803

803 **Antigone:** The taint of blood, the hereditary stain,

Lines 813–818

813 **Chorus:** Religion has her claims, 'tis true,
814 **Chorus:** Let rites be paid when rites are due.
815 **Chorus:** Yet is it ill to disobey
816 **Chorus:** The powers who hold by might the sway.
817 **Chorus:** Thou hast withstood authority,
818 **Chorus:** A self-willed rebel, thou must die.

Lines 823–824

823 **Creon:** If wail and lamentation aught availed
824 **Creon:** To stave off death, I trow they'd never end.

Line 832

832 **Antigone:** O grave, O bridal bower, O prison house

Lines 846–854

846 **Antigone:** For even had it been some child of mine,
847 **Antigone:** Or husband mouldering in death's decay,
848 **Antigone:** I had not wrought this deed despite the State.
849 **Antigone:** What is the law I call in aid? 'Tis thus
850 **Antigone:** I argue. Had it been a husband dead
851 **Antigone:** I might have wed another, and have borne
852 **Antigone:** Another child, to take the dead child's place.
853 **Antigone:** But, now my sire and mother both are dead,
854 **Antigone:** No second brother can be born for me.

Lines 849–854

849 **Antigone:** What is the law I call in aid? 'Tis thus
850 **Antigone:** I argue. Had it been a husband dead
851 **Antigone:** I might have wed another, and have borne
852 **Antigone:** Another child, to take the dead child's place.
853 **Antigone:** But, now my sire and mother both are dead,
854 **Antigone:** No second brother can be born for me.

Line 862

862 **Antigone:** What ordinance of heaven have I transgressed?

Lines 862–864

862 **Antigone:** What ordinance of heaven have I transgressed?
863 **Antigone:** Hereafter can I look to any god
864 **Antigone:** For succour, call on any man for help?

Line 865

865 **Antigone:** Alas, my piety is impious deemed.

Lines 866–869

866 **Antigone:** Well, if such justice is approved of heaven,
867 **Antigone:** I shall be taught by suffering my sin;
868 **Antigone:** But if the sin is theirs, O may they suffer
869 **Antigone:** No worse ills than the wrongs they do to me!

Lines 870–871

870 **Chorus:** The same ungovernable will
871 **Chorus:** Drives like a gale the maiden still.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
sepulchred (adjective)	buried; placed in a tomb	*O monstrous doom, Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, To fade and wither in a living tomb, An alien midst the living and the dead.*

wither (verb)	to dry up and fade away	*To fade and wither in a living tomb,*
monstrous (adjective)	shockingly wrong or unnatural	*Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom,*
puissant (adjective)	powerful or mighty in rank	*Look, puissant lords of Thebes, on me;*
unwept (adjective)	not mourned with tears	*Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go,*
bridal (adjective)	of a wedding or a bride	*My bridal bed*

Discussion questions

1. Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with gender and power?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Antigone call her prison in lines 793–796? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A rock-built prison and a living tomb.
   Answer guidance: A rock-built prison and a living tomb.
2. What comfort does the Chorus offer Antigone in lines 765–770? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She goes to the dead with glory, untouched by sword or disease, the only mortal to go down living.
   Answer guidance: She goes to the dead with glory, untouched by sword or disease, the only mortal to go down living.
3. To whom does Antigone compare herself in lines 771–778? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To Tantalus' doomed child, chained on Sipylus' rocky height and wept on by rain and snow.
   Answer guidance: To Tantalus' doomed child, chained on Sipylus' rocky height and wept on by rain and snow.
4. What does the Chorus say still drives Antigone, in lines 870–871? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The same ungovernable will, driving her on like a gale.
   Answer guidance: The same ungovernable will, driving her on like a gale.

5. What does Antigone mourn as she is led away? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Going to death alone, without wedding or friends to weep
   Answer guidance: Going to death alone, without wedding or friends to weep.
6. How does the Chorus respond to her? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** With both pity and reproach
   Answer guidance: With both pity and reproach.
7. Why does Antigone say a brother is irreplaceable? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Her parents are dead, so no other brother can be born
   Answer guidance: Her parents are dead, so no other brother can be born.
8. What does "my piety is impious deemed" mean? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Her religious duty is called a crime
   Answer guidance: Her religious duty is called a crime.
9. What is the tone of Antigone's farewell? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Grieving and defiant
   Answer guidance: Grieving and defiant.
10. Retell the most important events of “Episode 4 (lines 753–883)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Antigone is led toward her living tomb. She laments “Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go” (line 819), compares herself to the daughter of Tantalus (Niobe in myth, though the play does not name her), and argues that a brother, once both parents are dead, can never be replaced. The Chorus both pities and reproaches her. Creon orders the guards to take her away.
    Answer guidance: Antigone is led toward her living tomb. She laments “Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go” (line 819), compares herself to the daughter of Tantalus (Niobe in myth, though the play does not name her), and argues that a brother, once both parents are dead, can never be replaced. The Chorus both pities and reproaches her. Creon orders the guards to take her away.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the elders say "Religion has her claims" but still call her a rebel who must die? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** They grant religion its claims but still put human authority first (lines 813–818).
   Answer guidance: The elders grant that “Religion has her claims” and that “rites be paid when rites are due,” yet they conclude that it is “ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway,” and they name her a “self-willed rebel” who “must die” (lines 813–818). They admit the duty she honoured but still put human authority first.
2. What does “Episode 4 (lines 753–883)” suggest about Antigone's farewell? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less.
   Answer guidance: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Evidence to accept: “Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built

prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796): Antigone, lines 793–796. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of characterization in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)". What does it reveal about Antigone's farewell that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: "Religion has her claims, 'tis true, / Let rites be paid when rites are due. / Yet is it ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway. / Thou hast withstood authority" (Episode 4, lines 813–818): Chorus, lines 813–818. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the tone / mood in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" shape what we understand about Antigone's farewell? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796): Antigone, lines 793–796. On tone / mood: Lament and rebuke share the stage; the Chorus pities her and still calls her a "self-willed rebel" who must die. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with "Friends, countrymen, my last farewell I make; My journey's done.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "What is the law I call in aid? 'Tis thus / I argue. Had it been a husband dead / I might have wed another, and have borne / Another child, to take the dead child's place." (Episode 4, lines 849–854): Antigone, lines 849–854. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Antigone's lament that she dies unwed; her argument about a brother who cannot be replaced; the effect, the elders' divided response and Creon's order to take her away.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Antigone's lament that she dies unwed; her argument about a brother who cannot be replaced; the effect, the elders' divided response and Creon's order to take her away. Evidence to accept: "Alas, my piety is impious deemed" (Episode 4, line 865): Antigone, line 865. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" build on "Stasimon 3 (lines 737–752)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Religion has her claims, 'tis true, / Let rites be paid when rites are due. / Yet is it ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway. / Thou hast withstood authority" (Episode 4, lines 813–818): Chorus, lines 813–818. Theme link: The Chorus

grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Antigone's farewell, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "What is the law I call in aid? 'Tis thus / I argue. Had it been a husband dead / I might have wed another, and have borne / Another child, to take the dead child's place." (Episode 4, lines 849–854): Antigone, lines 849–854. On characterization: Antigone's farewell mixes defiance with fear: "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), yet she still argues the irreplaceable claim of a brother. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can someone be brave and afraid at the same time?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796): Antigone, lines 793–796. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does theme appear in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)", and how does it connect Antigone's farewell to the larger concern with gender and power? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Alas, my piety is impious deemed" (Episode 4, line 865): Antigone, line 865. On theme: Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Antigone's brother argument (849–854) strengthen or weaken her case? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position, strengthen or weaken, that quotes lines 846–854.
   Answer guidance: A strong answer can say the argument weakens her case: she claims that, had it been a husband or child, she would not have defied the State, because another husband or child could replace them, whereas no second brother can be born (lines 846–854). Goethe wished these lines removed; they are taught as part of the text. A strong answer can also say it strengthens her case by naming the unique family bond that the unwritten laws protect. Either view must quote the lines.
2. The Chorus tells Antigone that she bears a father's guilt. Is it fair to hold her family's past against her? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why ·

wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

Answer guidance: A defended position.

3. Creon says the city stays guiltless of the maiden's blood (lines 825–830). Does this reasoning hold? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position on Creon's "guiltless" claim (lines 825–830), with evidence.

   Answer guidance: Creon claims that, whether she dies or lives in the tomb, "We in either case / Are guiltless as concerns this maiden's blood" (lines 829–830). A strong answer can reject this: he still walls her up "In a rock-vaulted tomb" (lines 825–826) and leaves her no lodging on earth (line 831), so the city is not outside the deed. A contrasting view can note that he offers her a choice to live in solitude rather than a direct public execution. Evidence from these lines is required.

4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Alas, my piety is impious deemed" (Episode 4, line 865): Antigone, line 865. On theme: Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" acts most wisely in the matter of Antigone's farewell, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796): Antigone, lines 793–796. On characterization: Antigone's farewell mixes defiance with fear: "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), yet she still argues the irreplaceable claim of a brother. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. You are directing "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Antigone's farewell. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Religion has her claims, 'tis true, / Let rites be paid when rites are due. / Yet is it ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway. / Thou hast withstood authority" (Episode 4, lines 813–818): Chorus, lines 813–818. Theme link: The Chorus grants that "Religion has her claims" but still calls Antigone a "self-willed rebel" who must die, so human authority is set above the rite she honoured. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "What is the law I call in aid? 'Tis thus / I argue. Had it been a husband dead / I might have wed another, and have borne / Another child, to take the dead child's place." (Episode 4, lines 849–854): Antigone, lines 849–854. On theme: Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)", with its focus on Antigone's farewell, to learning too late: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Alas, my piety is impious deemed" (Episode 4, line 865): Antigone, line 865. On theme: Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the characterization in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" effective in presenting Antigone's farewell, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Was ever fate like mine? O monstrous doom, / Within a rock-built prison sepulchred, / To fade and wither in a living tomb, / An alien midst the living and the dead" (Episode 4, lines 793–796): Antigone, lines 793–796. On characterization: Antigone's farewell mixes defiance with fear: "Unwept, unwed, unfriended, hence I go" (line 819), yet she still argues the irreplaceable claim of a brother. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" treats Antigone's farewell with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The defiant heroine is also a young woman afraid to die. Her lament makes her more human, not less. Useful evidence: "Religion has her claims, 'tis true, / Let rites be paid when rites are due. / Yet is it ill to disobey / The powers who hold by might the sway. / Thou hast withstood authority" (Episode 4, lines 813–818): Chorus, lines 813–818. On theme: Her argument that a brother cannot be replaced once both parents are dead tests how far family piety can justify breaking the city's law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To whom does Antigone speak her last farewell at the start of the scene?
   A. Her friends and countrymen
   B. Her sister and her uncle in the palace hall
   C. The gods of Olympus
   D. Haemon, her promised husband

   Key: A (Her friends and countrymen)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What last look does Antigone take before she goes?
   A. A look at her brother's body on the plain
   B. A look at the bright sun
   C. A look at the palace
   D. A look at Haemon

   Key: B (A look at the bright sun)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Antigone's line: "'Tis Death I _____."

   Key: wed
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To whose doomed child does Antigone compare herself?
   A. The daughter of a Theban shepherd
   B. Creon's wife
   C. Tantalus' daughter
   D. A priestess of Apollo

   Key: C (Tantalus' daughter)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Against what do the elders say Antigone has dashed her foot?
   A. The gate of the palace
   B. The tomb of her brother
   C. The throne of the king of Thebes
   D. The altar of Justice

   Key: D (The altar of Justice)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon order the guards to do with Antigone?
   A. Shut her in a rock tomb and leave her
   B. Take her back to her sister's room tonight
   C. Set her free outside the city gates
   D. Bring her before the elders for trial

Key: A (Shut her in a rock tomb and leave her)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who does Antigone hope will welcome her below?

   A. The gods who live on Olympus

   B. Her father, mother and brother

   C. Creon's ancestors

   D. Haemon's friends

   Key: B (Her father, mother and brother)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Antigone describe herself at the very end of the scene?

   A. The happiest of all women in Thebes

   B. A traitor to Thebes

   C. The last of the royal house

   D. A servant of Creon

   Key: C (The last of the royal house)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Antigone feel the Chorus is mocking her?

   Sample answer: When Antigone compares herself to Tantalus' daughter, the elders reply that it is a great thing for a mortal to win renown like one sprung from the gods. Antigone hears this as an insult to her face while she is still alive. She feels they offer empty praise instead of real pity, so she calls on the fount of Dirce and the Theban plain as witnesses.

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Antigone say she did for her family when they died?

    Sample answer: Antigone says that she herself washed and dressed the bodies of her father, mother and brother and poured libations on their graves. Last of all she paid due rites to Polyneices, and her reward for that loyalty is the death she now faces.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Antigone mean by calling herself "An alien midst the living and the dead"?

    A. She belongs to neither world

    B. She was born in a foreign city far away

    C. She is a ghost already

    D. She hates the living and the dead

    Key: A (She belongs to neither world)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's line: "Unwept, unwed, _____, hence I go"

    Key: unfriended

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What do the elders say Antigone bears, in line 800?

    A. Her mother's crown

    B. Her father's guilt

    C. Her brother's sword and shield

    D. Creon's anger

    Key: B (Her father's guilt)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Creon claim to avoid guilt for Antigone's death?

    A. The gods themselves ordered the sentence on her

B. The elders voted for it in the council hall

C. She will die in the tomb, not by his hand

D. Haemon agreed to it

Key: C (She will die in the tomb, not by his hand)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon say about Antigone's lament in lines 823–824?

A. It moves him to change his mind at once

B. It is a trick taught to her by her sister

C. It insults the gods of Thebes

D. It would not end if it could stop death

Key: D (It would not end if it could stop death)

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does Antigone call her tomb a bridal bower?

A. It replaces the marriage she will not have

B. She will marry Haemon there in secret tonight

C. It is decorated with flowers

D. Creon built it for a wedding

Key: A (It replaces the marriage she will not have)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone do the elders take in lines 813–818?

A. Joyful and relieved

B. Sympathetic but stern

C. Frightened and silent

D. Openly rebellious against Creon

Key: B (Sympathetic but stern)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone's question in lines 862–864 suggest about her state of mind?

A. She is sure the gods will rescue her soon

B. She regrets her deed

C. She feels deserted by gods and men

D. She wants revenge on Ismene

Key: C (She feels deserted by gods and men)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Antigone use the story of Tantalus' daughter?

Sample answer: Antigone compares herself to Tantalus' child, chained on Sipylus' rocky height, clinging like ivy, drenched by rain and snow, with tears flowing on her frozen breast. She says her fate is the same. The comparison turns her slow death in the rock tomb into mythic suffering and shows her sense of being left alone to waste away.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone's view of her own death change during the scene?

Sample answer: At first she mourns that she dies young and unwed, with no marriage song and Death as her bridegroom. Later she argues that she is justified and hopes for a welcome from her family below. At the end she calls on the gods of Thebes to see how she is punished for her piety, mixing grief with defiance.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of Death leading Antigone to Acheron's dark fold suggest?

    A. Death takes the place of her bridegroom

    B. She will escape across the river

    C. Death is a shepherd who cares for her

    D. She will rule as queen in the underworld

    Key: A (Death takes the place of her bridegroom)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's line: "The taint of blood, the hereditary _____"

    Key: stain

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the triple address "O grave, O bridal bower, O prison house" emphasize?

    A. She is eager to see her new home

    B. Her tomb is all her future holds

    C. She has made peace with Creon

    D. She expects to be rescued before dark

    Key: B (Her tomb is all her future holds)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone's reference to the "monstrous marriage-bed" recall?

    A. Her own wedding to Haemon

    B. Creon's marriage to his wife

    C. Her parents' incestuous marriage

    D. Polyneices' marriage in Argos to a princess

    Key: C (Her parents' incestuous marriage)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Antigone mean by saying her brother's "dead hand" dealt her death-blow?

    A. Polyneices attacked her in battle

    B. His ghost has cursed her

    C. His marriage ruined the family name

    D. Burying him has led to her death

    Key: D (Burying him has led to her death)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in Creon's claim to be guiltless "as concerns this maiden's blood"?

    A. He causes her death while denying responsibility

    B. He has decided to spare her life

    C. He admits his guilt openly

    D. The elders have just declared him guilty before all

    Key: A (He causes her death while denying responsibility)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What do the elders mean by "The same ungovernable will Drives like a gale the maiden still"?

    A. She has calmed down at last

    B. She is as stubborn as ever

    C. A storm is coming to Thebes

    D. She is trying to escape the guards

    Key: B (She is as stubborn as ever)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Antigone's final speech appeal to Thebes?

    A. She asks the people of the city to rise up against Creon

    B. She curses the people for their silence

    C. She calls its gods to witness her unjust fate

    D. She begs Creon for mercy

    Key: C (She calls its gods to witness her unjust fate)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how marriage imagery runs through Antigone's laments.

    Sample answer: Antigone calls herself an unwed wife whose bridal bed no maids have strewn, says 'Tis Death I wed, and calls her tomb a bridal bower. She mourns being led away a bride unwed, without marriage-song or motherhood. The imagery turns her execution into a dark wedding and stresses the life and future Creon's decree takes from her.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the elders' judgment that Antigone is a self-willed rebel.

    Sample answer: The elders admit that religion has her claims and rites should be paid, but say it is ill to disobey those who hold power and call her a self-willed rebel. A strong answer weighs whether her act is rebellion or piety, considers that the elders also pity her, and supports a view with lines from the scene.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the elders' line "Thou a father's guilt dost bear" shift the cause of her fate?

    A. From her choice to an inherited curse

    B. From the gods to Creon alone

    C. From Creon to Haemon's love

    D. From the curse to her sister's betrayal of the family

    Key: A (From her choice to an inherited curse)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's line: "Thus by the law of _____ I was led"

    Key: conscience

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why is Antigone's argument in lines 849–854 often seen as troubling?

    A. It shows that she did not love Polyneices

    B. It seems to narrow her appeal to divine law

    C. It proves that Creon's law was just

    D. It reveals that she plans to marry

    Key: B (It seems to narrow her appeal to divine law)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Antigone's question "What ordinance of heaven have I transgressed?" imply?

    A. She is unsure which god she offended

    B. She admits that she broke a sacred rule

    C. She has kept the gods' law, not broken it

    D. She wants the elders to name her crime

    Key: C (She has kept the gods' law, not broken it)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone's conditional wish in lines 866–869 reveal?

    A. She has accepted that she was wrong

    B. She curses Creon to die at once

    C. She wants to be forgiven by the elders of Thebes

    D. She leaves the final judgment to the gods

    Key: D (She leaves the final judgment to the gods)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] The exchange between Antigone and the Chorus in this scene is best described as

    A. A lament answered by cautious comfort and rebuke

    B. A calm debate that ends in full agreement between them

    C. A trial with witnesses

    D. A prayer for the city's victory

    Key: A (A lament answered by cautious comfort and rebuke)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Antigone's laments move between grief and justification.

    Sample answer: Antigone begins by grieving that she goes unwed to Death and that her friends show no pity. In her long speech she turns to justification: she paid due rites, she is justified in wisdom's eyes, and she was led by the law of conscience. She ends asking what ordinance of heaven she broke. The movement shows a heroine who suffers fully yet does not repent.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Antigone's reasoning about husband, child and brother as part of her defense.

    Sample answer: Antigone says she would not have defied the State for a husband or child, since they could be replaced, but with her parents dead no second brother can be born. Some readers find this argument narrow or strange beside her earlier appeal to the gods' unwritten laws. A strong answer weighs whether it weakens her case or shows the depth of her bond with her brother.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Creon's brief appearance in this scene characterize him?

    Sample answer: Creon interrupts her lament to say that if wailing could stave off death it would never end, orders her walled up in a rock-vaulted tomb, and claims that he and the elders are guiltless of her blood since she is left to die or live alone. He appears cold and legalistic, more concerned with avoiding pollution than with mercy.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Antigone's sense of herself here with her confidence in Episode 2.

    Sample answer: In Episode 2 Antigone boldly defended the unwritten laws and treated death as gain. Here she grieves

openly that she dies unwed, unwept and unfriended, and wonders whether any god will help her. Yet she still insists she is justified. A strong answer explains whether this grief weakens or deepens her heroism, with lines from both scenes.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 753–883) develops the idea of Antigone's farewell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Episode 4 (lines 753–883)” could deliver about Antigone's farewell. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone's farewell in “Episode 4 (lines 753–883)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 4 (lines 753–883) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Antigone's farewell. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Episode 4 (lines 753–883)” could deliver about Antigone's farewell. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone's farewell in “Episode 4 (lines 753–883)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 4 (lines 753–883) suggests about Antigone's farewell. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" could deliver about Antigone's farewell. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone's farewell in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 4 (lines 753–883) to complicate the reader's understanding of Antigone's farewell. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)" could deliver about Antigone's farewell. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Antigone's farewell in "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Friends, countrymen, my last farewell I make; My journey's done. One last fond, lingering, longing look I take At the bright sun. For Death who puts to sleep both young and old Hales my young life, And beckons me to Acheron's dark fold, An unwed wife. No youths have sung the marriage song for me, My bridal bed No maids have strewn with flowers from the lea, 'Tis Death I wed.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)"?

   A. Antigone before Creon

   B. The curse on the house

   C. Two sisters, one choice

   D. Antigone's farewell

SAT key: 1. D (Antigone's farewell)

Lesson 11: Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)

Focus: others who were shut away

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923) (others who were shut away) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus compares Antigone to figures of myth who suffered by fate, imprisoned or blinded: Danae, shut away; Dryas' child, the Edonian king (Lycurgus), brought by Bacchus to a rocky dungeon (lines 897–900); and two step-sons blinded by a jealous step-mother (lines 910–913). No one escapes Fate.

Background: These are allusions to myths the Athenian audience knew: Danae; "Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King" (line 897), whom tradition names Lycurgus; and the two step-sons blinded by a jealous step-mother (lines 910–913).

Significance: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why do people compare their troubles to famous stories? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....*
> **Prompt:** Why do people compare their troubles to famous stories?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed “high disdain,” so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Today's words: disdain — open scorn or contempt; frenzy — wild uncontrolled agitation; gibes — taunting remarks; piteous — deserving or moving pity; lineage — a line of descent from an ancestor; tempest — a violent storm. These are allusions to myths the Athenian audience knew: Danae; "Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King" (line 897), whom tradition names Lycurgus; and the two step-sons blinded by a jealous step-mother (lines 910–913). Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Allusion: Danae in her tower, Lycurgus in a rocky dungeon and the blinded step-sons place Antigone in a line of mythic sufferers shut away by fate or a god. Theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Tone / mood: The comparisons sound consoling and ominous at once: Antigone is not alone, and no one escapes. Watch for burial and the unburied body: Each parallel figure is shut in a tower, dungeon or blindness, mirroring the cave that will hold Antigone's still-living body.
Words: disdain: open scorn or contempt · frenzy: wild uncontrolled agitation · gibes: taunting remarks · piteous: deserving or moving pity · lineage: a line of descent from an ancestor · tempest: a violent storm

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes others who were shut away. Key takeaway: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed "high disdain," so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allusion:** Danae in her tower, Lycurgus in a rocky dungeon and the blinded step-sons place Antigone in a line of mythic sufferers shut away by fate or a god.
- **Theme:** "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming.
- **Tone / mood:** The comparisons sound consoling and ominous at once: Antigone is not alone, and no one escapes.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed "high disdain," so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** Each parallel figure is shut in a tower, dungeon or blindness, mirroring the cave that will hold Antigone's still-living body.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896) Chorus, lines 893–896.
- "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900) Chorus, lines 897–900.
- "Like to thee that maiden bright, / Danaë, in her brass-bound tower" (Stasimon 4, lines 884–885) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon.
Evidence: "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900)
Reasoning: The Chorus compares Antigone to figures of myth who suffered by fate, imprisoned or blinded: Danae, shut away; Dryas' child, the Edonian king (Lycurgus), brought by Bacchus to a rocky dungeon (lines 897–900); and two step-sons blinded by a jealous step-mother (lines 910–913). No one escapes Fate.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 884–885
884 **Chorus:** Like to thee that maiden bright,
885 **Chorus:** Danaë, in her brass-bound tower,

Lines 884–887
884 **Chorus:** Like to thee that maiden bright,
885 **Chorus:** Danaë, in her brass-bound tower,
886 **Chorus:** Once exchanged the glad sunlight
887 **Chorus:** For a cell, her bridal bower.

Lines 884–896
884 **Chorus:** Like to thee that maiden bright,
885 **Chorus:** Danaë, in her brass-bound tower,
886 **Chorus:** Once exchanged the glad sunlight
887 **Chorus:** For a cell, her bridal bower.
888 **Chorus:** And yet she sprang of royal line,
889 **Chorus:** My child, like thine,
890 **Chorus:** And nursed the seed
891 **Chorus:** By her conceived
892 **Chorus:** Of Zeus descending in a golden shower.
893 **Chorus:** Strange are the ways of Fate, her power
894 **Chorus:** Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower;
895 **Chorus:** Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea
896 **Chorus:** From Fate can flee.

Lines 886–887

886 **Chorus:** Once exchanged the glad sunlight
887 **Chorus:** For a cell, her bridal bower.

Line 887

887 **Chorus:** For a cell, her bridal bower.

Lines 893–896

893 **Chorus:** Strange are the ways of Fate, her power
894 **Chorus:** Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower;
895 **Chorus:** Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea
896 **Chorus:** From Fate can flee.

Line 895

895 **Chorus:** Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea

Lines 897–900

897 **Chorus:** Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King,
898 **Chorus:** For words of high disdain
899 **Chorus:** Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring,
900 **Chorus:** To cool the madness of a fevered brain.

Line 900

900 **Chorus:** To cool the madness of a fevered brain.

Line 904

904 **Chorus:** For once he fain had quenched the Maenad's fire;

Line 905

905 **Chorus:** And of the tuneful Nine provoked the ire.

Line 913

913 **Chorus:** The sightless orbits of her step-sons twain.

Line 914

914 **Chorus:** Wasting away they mourned their piteous doom,

Line 917

917 **Chorus:** To great Erecththeus' race;

Line 921

921 **Chorus:** A child of gods; yet she, my child, like thee,

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context

disdain (noun)	open scorn or contempt	*For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring,*
frenzy (noun)	wild uncontrolled agitation	*His frenzy passed, / He learnt at last / 'Twas madness gibes against a god to fling.*
gibes (noun)	taunting remarks	*'Twas madness gibes against a god to fling.*
piteous (adjective)	deserving or moving pity	*Wasting away they mourned their piteous doom, / The blasted issue of their mother's womb.*
lineage (noun)	a line of descent from an ancestor	*But she her lineage could trace / To great Erechtheus' race;*
tempest (noun)	a violent storm	*Reared, where the tempest raves, / Swift as his horses o'er the hills she sped;*

Discussion questions

1. Why do people compare their troubles to famous stories?
2. Where does allusion appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with learning too late?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Danaë exchange the glad sunlight for (lines 884–887)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A cell in a brass-bound tower, which becomes her bridal bower.
   Answer guidance: A cell in a brass-bound tower, which becomes her bridal bower.
2. What does Dryas' child learn in the rocky dungeon (lines 897–903)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** That it is madness to fling gibes against a god.
   Answer guidance: That it is madness to fling gibes against a god.
3. What did Dryas' child try to do to the Maenads (line 904)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He tried to quench their sacred fire, and so he angered the Muses.
   Answer guidance: He tried to quench their sacred fire, and so he angered the Muses.
4. From whom was the mother of the two sons descended (lines 916–919)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** From the race of Erechtheus; she was a child of the North Wind, reared in his vast caves.
   Answer guidance: From the race of Erechtheus; she was a child of the North Wind, reared in his vast caves.

5. What does this ode mainly do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Compares Antigone with mythical figures who suffered by fate (imprisoned or blinded)
   Answer guidance: Compares Antigone with mythical figures who suffered by fate (imprisoned or blinded).
6. What cannot withstand Fate, according to lines 893–896? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Wealth, arms, towers and ships
   Answer guidance: Wealth, arms, towers and ships.
7. What kind of reference is the story of Danae? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** An allusion to myth
   Answer guidance: An allusion to myth.
8. Whom might the ode warn besides Antigone? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Creon
   Answer guidance: Creon.
9. What is the tone of the ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Solemn
   Answer guidance: Solemn.
10. Retell the most important events of "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus compares Antigone to figures of myth who suffered by fate, imprisoned or blinded: Danae, shut away; Dryas' child, the Edonian king (Lycurgus), brought by Bacchus to a rocky dungeon (lines 897–900); and two step-sons blinded by a jealous step-mother (lines 910–913). No one escapes Fate.
    Answer guidance: The Chorus compares Antigone to figures of myth who suffered by fate, imprisoned or blinded: Danae, shut away; Dryas' child, the Edonian king (Lycurgus), brought by Bacchus to a rocky dungeon (lines 897–900); and two step-sons blinded by a jealous step-mother (lines 910–913). No one escapes Fate.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why include a king (Lycurgus) among the examples? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A king as well as a young woman can be shut away; cite the Lycurgus stanza.
   Answer guidance: Among the examples is "Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King," whom Bacchus shut in a "rocky dungeon" for "words of high disdain" (lines 897–900). By including a king who insulted a god, the ode hints that rulers, not only young women, can be locked away by fate—an implicit warning beside Creon.
2. What does "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" suggest about others who were shut away? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon.
   Answer guidance: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Evidence to accept: "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From

Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of allusion in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)". What does it reveal about others who were shut away that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** references to other books, myths, history or religion.
   Answer guidance: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion. Evidence to accept: "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900): Chorus, lines 897–900. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the theme in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" shape what we understand about others who were shut away? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. On theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Like to thee that maiden bright, Danaë, in her brass-bound tower, Once exchanged the glad sunlight For a cell, her bridal bower.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Like to thee that maiden bright, / Danaë, in her brass-bound tower" (Stasimon 4, lines 884–885): Chorus, in this part of the section. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the mythical figures shut away by fate; the claim that no wealth or tower can escape Fate; the effect, Antigone placed among the great sufferers of myth.
   Answer guidance: Look for: the mythical figures shut away by fate; the claim that no wealth or tower can escape Fate; the effect, Antigone placed among the great sufferers of myth. Evidence to accept: "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" build on "Episode 4 (lines 753–883)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900): Chorus, lines 897–900.

Theme link: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed “high disdain,” so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about others who were shut away, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: “Like to thee that maiden bright, / Danaë, in her brass-bound tower” (Stasimon 4, lines 884–885): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed “high disdain,” so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why do people compare their troubles to famous stories?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Thus Dryas’ child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain” (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900): Chorus, lines 897–900. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)”, and how does it connect others who were shut away to the larger concern with learning too late? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: “Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee” (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. On tone / mood: The comparisons sound consoling and ominous at once: Antigone is not alone, and no one escapes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Stasimon 4 excuse Antigone's fate or protest it? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended

position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Like to thee that maiden bright, / Danaë, in her brass-bound tower" (Stasimon 4, lines 884–885): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" acts most wisely in the matter of others who were shut away, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. Theme link: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed "high disdain," so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of others who were shut away. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900): Chorus, lines 897–900. Theme link: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed "high disdain," so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Like to thee that maiden bright, / Danaë, in her brass-bound tower" (Stasimon 4, lines 884–885): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)", with its focus on others who were shut away, to divine law and human law: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. On theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the allusion in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" effective in presenting others who were shut away, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900): Chorus, lines 897–900. On allusion: Danae in her tower, Lycurgus in a rocky dungeon and the blinded step-sons place Antigone in a line of mythic sufferers shut away by fate or a god. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" treats others who were shut away with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Like to thee that maiden bright, / Danaë, in her brass-bound tower" (Stasimon 4, lines 884–885): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Strange are the ways of Fate, her power / Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; / Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea / From Fate can flee" (Stasimon 4, lines 893–896): Chorus, lines 893–896. Theme link: The myths show gods imprisoning mortals who showed "high disdain," so divine punishment of human pride hangs over Creon as much as over Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about others who were shut away? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Myth makes Antigone part of a long pattern of

suffering and implies that even the powerful cannot escape fate, a warning to Creon. Useful evidence: "Thus Dryas' child, the rash Edonian King, / For words of high disdain / Did Bacchus to a rocky dungeon bring, / To cool the madness of a fevered brain" (Stasimon 4, lines 897–900): Chorus, lines 897–900. On theme: "Strange are the ways of Fate": wealth, arms and ships cannot flee it, so the ode makes even the powerful subject to what is coming. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the first figure of myth the Chorus compares to Antigone?

   A. Danaë

   B. Ismene

   C. A Theban queen

   D. A priestess of Bacchus

   Key: A (Danaë)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How did Zeus come to Danaë?

   A. As a white bull from the sea

   B. In a golden shower

   C. As an eagle

   D. In a dream

   Key: B (In a golden shower)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Daughter of _____ in her sire's vast caves"

   Key: Boreas

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who brought Dryas' child to a rocky dungeon?

   A. Ares

   B. Zeus

   C. Bacchus

   D. Poseidon

   Key: C (Bacchus)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where was the Edonian king imprisoned?

   A. In a tower of brass by the sea

   B. In a ship's dark hold

   C. In a temple

D. In a rocky dungeon

Key: D (In a rocky dungeon)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How many step-sons suffered, according to line 913?

   A. Two

   B. Three

   C. Seven

   D. Ten

   Key: A (Two)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Swift as whose horses did the step-mother speed over the hills?

   A. Zeus's

   B. Her father's

   C. Ares'

   D. The Argive army's

   Key: B (Her father's)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does the Chorus address as my child?

   A. Ismene

   B. Danaë

   C. Antigone

   D. Creon's son

   Key: C (Antigone)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] Why does the Chorus tell the story of Danaë?

   Sample answer: Danaë was a princess of royal line who was shut away in a brass-bound tower, exchanging the sunlight for a cell that became her bridal bower. The Chorus compares her to Antigone, who is also of royal blood and is being shut in a tomb. The story shows that even the noble cannot escape Fate.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] What happened to the Edonian king, and what did he learn?

    Sample answer: Dryas' child, the rash Edonian king, spoke words of high disdain against Bacchus and was shut in a rocky dungeon to cool the madness of his brain. When his frenzy passed, he learned that it is madness to fling gibes against a god, since he had tried to quench the fire of the Maenads.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Danaë's cell become, in line 887?

    A. Her bridal chamber

    B. A royal throne room of gold

    C. A temple of Zeus

    D. A grave by the sea

    Key: A (Her bridal chamber)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “On Bosporus’ lone _____”

    Key: strand

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the phrase “To cool the madness of a fevered brain” suggest?

    A. He was sick with a fever caught at sea long ago

B. The prison was meant to calm his frenzy

C. He froze in the dungeon

D. He was mad with love

Key: B (The prison was meant to calm his frenzy)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did the Edonian king try to quench?

A. A burning city on the plain

B. A fire in his palace

C. The Maenads' fire

D. The light of the sun

Key: C (The Maenads' fire)

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] From whose race did the step-mother descend?

A. Labdacus'

B. Dryas'

C. Tantalus'

D. Erechtheus'

Key: D (Erechtheus')

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “the tuneful Nine” refer to?

A. The Muses

B. Nine Theban kings of old

C. Nine Maenads

D. Nine stars

Key: A (The Muses)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What do Danaë and Antigone have in common, according to the ode?

A. Love for a prince of Thebes

B. Royal birth and imprisonment

C. A brother killed at Argos

D. A gift for song and dance at feasts

Key: B (Royal birth and imprisonment)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “the Maenad’s fire” refer to in line 904?

A. A fire set by Theban soldiers

B. The flame burning on the altar of Zeus

C. The frenzy of Bacchus' followers

D. A torch in the dungeon

Key: C (The frenzy of Bacchus' followers)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does each myth in the ode connect to Antigone's situation?

Sample answer: Danaë, a royal maiden, was shut in a brass-bound tower that became her bridal bower, as Antigone goes

to a tomb she calls her bridal chamber. The Edonian king was imprisoned in a rocky dungeon for his pride. The daughter of Boreas, though a child of gods, was vanquished by Destiny. Each myth shows noble people shut away or defeated by fate.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus stress that Danaë was of royal line?
Sample answer: The Chorus says Danaë sprang of royal line, like Antigone, and was loved by Zeus himself, yet she still exchanged the sunlight for a cell. Stressing her royal birth shows that rank and noble blood cannot protect anyone from Fate, which neither wealth nor arms nor towers can resist.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of "brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea" add to the ode?
A. Human strength and skill offer no refuge
B. Sea travel is the safest way to escape
C. Thebes has a great navy
D. Ships were built near Danaë's tower of brass
Key: A (Human strength and skill offer no refuge)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Wasting away they mourned their piteous _____"
Key: doom

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which word best describes the ode's attitude toward the sufferers of myth?
A. Mocking
B. Pitying
C. Joyful
D. Indifferent
Key: B (Pitying)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the story of the Edonian king differ from Danaë's?
A. He was shut away by his father for being beautiful
B. He escaped his prison
C. He was punished for his own insolence
D. He was loved by Zeus
Key: C (He was punished for his own insolence)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the phrase "exchanged the glad sunlight For a cell" stress?
A. Her joy at finding a new home
B. Her love of darkness
C. Her escape to the sea
D. Her loss of light and freedom
Key: D (Her loss of light and freedom)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of addressing Antigone as "my child" twice?
A. It adds tenderness to the warning
B. It shows that the elders are her parents by blood
C. It mocks her youth

D. It shows open anger at her

Key: A (It adds tenderness to the warning)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How is the ode structured?

A. As one long prayer to Zeus

B. As three stories, each ending in suffering

C. As a debate between two singers

D. As a list of Theban kings and their many deeds

Key: B (As three stories, each ending in suffering)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the step-mother's "spindle red" with gore suggest?

A. A sign of her skill at weaving

B. A gift to her sons

C. A household tool turned into a weapon

D. A symbol of her royal blood and noble race

Key: C (A household tool turned into a weapon)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the ode uses imprisonment imagery.

Sample answer: Danaë is shut in a brass-bound tower and a cell, the Edonian king is brought to a rocky dungeon, and the step-sons waste away in their doom. The tower, cell and dungeon mirror the rock tomb waiting for Antigone. The imagery of enclosure suggests that Fate closes around the noble and the proud alike.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Evaluate whether the ode offers Antigone comfort.

Sample answer: The elders call Antigone my child and place her beside royal and divine figures, which honours her. Yet every example ends in imprisonment, blindness or defeat, and the ode insists that no one escapes Fate. A strong answer weighs whether the company of great sufferers comforts her or only confirms her doom.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What tension does the ode create by pairing innocent Danaë with the insolent Edonian king?

A. It leaves unclear whether Antigone suffers innocently or for pride

B. It proves beyond doubt that Antigone is innocent

C. It praises the king for his courage

D. It shows that Fate rewards the virtuous in the end and punishes the proud

Key: A (It leaves unclear whether Antigone suffers innocently or for pride)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "And of the tuneful Nine provoked the _____."

Key: ire

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does naming Ares as witness to the blinding add to the ode's mood?

A. It shows that the gods stepped in to prevent it

B. It links the cruelty to war and bloodshed

C. It makes the scene comic

D. It shows the sons were warriors

Key: B (It links the cruelty to war and bloodshed)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the effect of the ode's dense allusions for its first audience?

    A. They hide the meaning from the elders

    B. They introduce many new characters to the plot

    C. They call up familiar stories of suffering

    D. They advertise other plays

    Key: C (They call up familiar stories of suffering)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] The ode's tone toward Fate is best described as

    A. Angry rebellion against it

    B. Cheerful trust

    C. Scornful doubt

    D. Awed resignation

    Key: D (Awed resignation)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “A child of gods; yet she” was vanquished imply about Antigone?

    A. Noble birth will not save her

    B. She will be rescued by the gods

    C. She is descended from Boreas

    D. She will live for ever

    Key: A (Noble birth will not save her)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the ode's three myths together comment on Antigone's fate.

    Sample answer: Danaë, innocent and royal, was shut in a tower; the Edonian king was imprisoned for insulting a god; the daughter of Boreas, a child of gods, was vanquished by Destiny. Together they suggest that suffering falls on the innocent and the proud alike. The mix leaves open whether Antigone suffers for her piety or for her pride, while insisting that Fate cannot be escaped.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how the ode shapes the audience's view of Creon's sentence.

    Sample answer: The ode never names Creon, but its story of a king who mocked a god and was humbled could apply to him as well as to Antigone. Its pity for royal sufferers keeps sympathy with her. A strong answer weighs whether the ode accepts the sentence as Fate or quietly warns the ruler who imposed it, citing lines.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the role of Fate in this ode with the role of the curse in Stasimon 2.

    Sample answer: Stasimon 2 explains suffering as a curse passed down the house of Labdacus. Stasimon 4 speaks of Fate and Destiny that know not death nor age, striking royal and divine figures from other families. Both odes show forces beyond human control, but this one widens the view from one cursed family to all mortals and even children of gods.

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might the Chorus choose myths of imprisonment and blindness at this point in the play?

    Sample answer: Antigone has just been led to her rock tomb, so stories of a maiden in a tower and a king in a dungeon mirror her fate. The blinding of the step-sons adds horror and suggests that mortals cannot see what Fate holds. The choice keeps the audience's pity with Antigone and deepens the sense of approaching doom.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923) develops the idea of others who were shut away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)” could deliver about others who were shut away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for others who were shut away in “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of others who were shut away. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)” could deliver about others who were shut away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for others who were shut away in “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923) suggests about others who were shut away. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's allusion and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" could deliver about others who were shut away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for others who were shut away in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses allusion in Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923) to complicate the reader's understanding of others who were shut away. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)" could deliver about others who were shut away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for others who were shut away in "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Like to thee that maiden bright, Danaë, in her brass-bound tower, Once exchanged the glad sunlight For a cell, her bridal bower. And yet she sprang of royal line, My child, like thine, And nursed the seed By her conceived Of Zeus descending in a golden shower. Strange are the ways of Fate, her power Nor wealth, nor arms withstand, nor tower; Nor brass-prowed ships, that breast the sea From Fate can flee.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)"?

   A. Others who were shut away

   B. The Ode to Love

   C. The city's victory song

   D. A prayer that the city's wine-god return in healing

SAT key: 1. A (Others who were shut away)

Lesson 12: Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)

Focus: the prophet Teiresias

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported or spoken of)): Cite method lines by number only.
Suggested language: "What warning is given here, and how is it answered?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The blind prophet Teiresias warns Creon that the birds and altars show the gods' anger: the unburied body pollutes the city. He urges Creon to yield. Creon insults him as a money-getter. Teiresias prophesies that Creon will pay with a child of his own. Shaken, Creon decides to bury Polyneices and free Antigone.

Background: Teiresias, the same seer as in Oedipus Rex, brings the gods' judgment. Signs from birds and sacrifices were standard means of divination.

Significance: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....
Prompt: Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context.
Today's words: unwisdom — lack of wisdom; folly; wastrel — a worthless or wasteful person; lucre — money, especially when gained greedily; augury — the practice of reading omens, especially from birds; seer — a prophet who sees what is to come; obstinate — stubbornly unwilling to change course.
Words: unwisdom: lack of wisdom; folly · wastrel: a worthless or wasteful person · lucre: money, especially when gained greedily · augury: the practice of reading omens, especially from birds · seer: a prophet who sees what is to come · obstinate: stubbornly unwilling to change course

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Teiresias, the same seer as in Oedipus Rex, brings the gods' judgment. Signs from birds and sacrifices were standard means of divination. Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Conflict: Teiresias brings the gods' anger into the open: polluted altars against Creon's insults; prophecy against a king who calls all prophets a "money-getting tribe." Foreshadowing: The threat that Creon will pay with a child of his own points straight at Haemon before the Messenger confirms it. Characterization: Creon moves from scorn to the admission that "To yield is grievous," the first crack in the stubbornness that has defined him. Watch for burial and the unburied body: Bird-signs and choked altars make the corpse a civic pollution; Creon's late decision to bury Polyneices and free Antigone tries to undo both wrongs at once.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" slowly and put it in my own words: Teiresias tells Creon that everyone errs, but a man who does not hug his error and who seeks a cure is neither a wastrel nor unwise. Next, craft. "Hugs not his errors" makes stubbornness tactile, as if the mistake were something a person can cling to, and "seeks / The cure" offers a way back before the warning hardens. The strongest word is "repents": it names the turn still offered before the warning hardens. Then, effect. What do lines 962–965 reveal about the prophet Teiresias? My answer: The prophet Teiresias still offers counsel before he offers doom. "To err is common" is the play's lesson held out in time for Creon to take it; whether he will is the test of this scene.

> *O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise (Episode 5, lines 962–965)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" slowly and put it in my own words: Teiresias tells Creon that everyone errs, but a man who does not hug his error and who seeks a cure is neither a wastrel nor unwise. Next, craft. "Hugs not his errors" makes stubbornness tactile, as if the mistake were something a person can cling to, and "seeks / The cure" offers a way back before the warning hardens. The strongest word is "repents": it names the turn still offered before the warning hardens. Then, effect. What do lines 962–965 reveal about the prophet Teiresias? My answer: The prophet Teiresias still offers counsel before he offers doom. "To err is common" is the play's lesson held out in time for Creon to take it; whether he will is the test of this scene.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Prophets" and "money-getting tribe" stand out. Creon dismisses all seers as greedy, so he refuses to hear the warning, as he has refused everyone else. Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law? Expected student answer: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. (Creon, line 993.)

> *Prophets are all a money-getting tribe* (Episode 5, line 993)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Prophets" and "money-getting tribe" stand out in line 993. Creon dismisses all seers as greedy, so he refuses to hear the warning, as he has refused everyone else. The wording turns one counsellor into a whole tribe, which lets him reject the message without answering it.
Ask: How does this line connect to divine law and human law?
Expected student answer: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. (Creon, line 993.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for conflict, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the prophet Teiresias? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 5 (lines 924–1053) develops the idea of the prophet Teiresias. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. When the text says "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" (Episode 5, lines 962–965), it shows this directly. The blind prophet Teiresias warns Creon that the birds and altars show the gods' anger: the unburied body pollutes the city. He urges Creon to yield. Creon insults him as a money-getter. Teiresias prophesies that Creon will pay with a child of his own. Shaken, Creon decides to bury Polyneices and free Antigone.
Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the prophet Teiresias? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 5 (lines 924–1053) develops the idea of the prophet Teiresias. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. When the text says "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" (Episode 5, lines 962–965), it shows this directly. The blind prophet Teiresias warns Creon that the birds and altars show the gods' anger: the unburied body pollutes the city. He urges Creon to yield. Creon insults him as a money-getter. Teiresias prophesies that Creon will pay with a child of his own. Shaken, Creon decides to bury Polyneices and free Antigone.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong? Ask: Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong?
Anchor question: Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the prophet Teiresias? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. ("O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks", Episode 5, lines 962–965). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the prophet Teiresias? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. ("O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks", Episode 5, lines 962–965). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes the prophet Teiresias. Key takeaway: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Teiresias brings the gods' anger into the open: polluted altars against Creon's insults; prophecy against a king who calls all prophets a "money-getting tribe."
- **Foreshadowing:** The threat that Creon will pay with a child of his own points straight at Haemon before the Messenger confirms it.
- **Characterization:** Creon moves from scorn to the admission that "To yield is grievous," the first crack in the stubbornness that has defined him.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** Bird-signs and choked altars make the corpse a civic pollution; Creon's late decision to bury Polyneices and free Antigone tries to undo both wrongs at once.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" (Episode 5, lines 962–965) Teiresias, lines 962–965.
- "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (Episode 5, line 993) Creon, line 993.
- "And kings are all a lucre-loving race" (Episode 5, line 994) Teiresias, line 994.
- "To yield is grievous, but the obstinate soul / That fights with Fate, is smitten grievously" (Episode 5, lines 1035–1036) Creon, lines 1035–1036.
- "Almost I am persuaded it is best / To keep through life the law ordained of old" (Episode 5, lines 1052–1053) Creon, lines 1052–1053.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted.
Evidence: "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" (Episode 5, lines 962–965)
Reasoning: The blind prophet Teiresias warns Creon that the birds and altars show the gods' anger: the unburied body pollutes the city. He urges Creon to yield. Creon insults him as a money-getter. Teiresias prophesies that Creon will pay with a child of his own. Shaken, Creon decides to bury Polyneices and free Antigone.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 924–925

924 **Teiresias:** Princes of Thebes, two wayfarers as one,
925 **Teiresias:** Having betwixt us eyes for one, we are here.

Lines 924–936

924 **Teiresias:** Princes of Thebes, two wayfarers as one,
925 **Teiresias:** Having betwixt us eyes for one, we are here.
926 **Teiresias:** The blind man cannot move without a guide.
927 **Creon:** Why tidings, old Teiresias?
928 **Teiresias:** I will tell thee;
929 **Teiresias:** And when thou hearest thou must heed the seer.
930 **Creon:** Thus far I ne'er have disobeyed thy rede.
931 **Teiresias:** So hast thou steered the ship of State aright.
932 **Creon:** I know it, and I gladly own my debt.
933 **Teiresias:** Bethink thee that thou treadest once again
934 **Teiresias:** The razor edge of peril.
935 **Creon:** What is this?
936 **Creon:** Thy words inspire a dread presentiment.

Line 926
926 **Teiresias:** The blind man cannot move without a guide.

Line 961
961 **Teiresias:** Gorged with the carnival of human gore.

Line 962
962 **Teiresias:** O ponder this, my son. To err is common

Lines 962–965
962 **Teiresias:** O ponder this, my son. To err is common
963 **Teiresias:** To all men, but the man who having erred
964 **Teiresias:** Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks
965 **Teiresias:** The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise.

Line 966
966 **Teiresias:** No fool, the saw goes, like the obstinate fool.

Lines 968–969
968 **Teiresias:** To vex the dead. What glory wilt thou win
969 **Teiresias:** By slaying twice the slain? I mean thee well;

Line 970
970 **Teiresias:** Counsel's most welcome if I promise gain.

Line 976
976 **Creon:** Silver of Sardis change for gold of Ind;

Line 982
982 **Creon:** No human soilure can assail the gods;

Lines 986–1002
986 **Teiresias:** Alas! doth any know and lay to heart—
987 **Creon:** Is this the prelude to some hackneyed saw?
988 **Teiresias:** How far good counsel is the best of goods?
989 **Creon:** True, as unwisdom is the worst of ills.
990 **Teiresias:** Thou art infected with that ill thyself.
991 **Creon:** I will not bandy insults with thee, seer.
992 **Teiresias:** And yet thou say'st my prophesies are frauds.
993 **Creon:** Prophets are all a money-getting tribe.
994 **Teiresias:** And kings are all a lucre-loving race.
995 **Creon:** Dost know at whom thou glancest, me thy lord?
996 **Teiresias:** Lord of the State and saviour, thanks to me.
997 **Creon:** Skilled prophet art thou, but to wrong inclined.
998 **Teiresias:** Take heed, thou wilt provoke me to reveal
999 **Teiresias:** The mystery deep hidden in my breast.

1000 **Creon:** Say on, but see it be not said for gain.
1001 **Teiresias:** Such thou, methinks, till now hast judged my words.
1002 **Creon:** Be sure thou wilt not traffic on my wits.

Line 989
989 **Creon:** True, as unwisdom is the worst of ills.

Line 993
993 **Creon:** Prophets are all a money-getting tribe.

Line 994
994 **Teiresias:** And kings are all a lucre-loving race.

Line 1012
1012 **Teiresias:** In heaven; and thou usurp'st a power not thine.

Lines 1031–1033
1031 **Chorus:** And, O believe me, since these grizzled locks
1032 **Chorus:** Were like the raven, never have I known
1033 **Chorus:** The prophet's warning to the State to fail.

Lines 1035–1036
1035 **Creon:** To yield is grievous, but the obstinate soul
1036 **Creon:** That fights with Fate, is smitten grievously.

Line 1038
1038 **Chorus:** What should I do. Advise me. I will heed.

Lines 1052–1053
1052 **Creon:** Almost I am persuaded it is best
1053 **Creon:** To keep through life the law ordained of old. Exit Creon.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
unwisdom (noun)	lack of wisdom; folly	*True, as unwisdom is the worst of ills.*
wastrel (noun)	a worthless or wasteful person	*To err is common To all men, but the man who having erred Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise.*
lucre (noun)	money, especially when gained greedily	*And kings are all a lucre-loving race.*
augury (noun)	the practice of reading omens, especially from birds	*Sitting upon my throne of augury, / As is my wont, where every fowl of heaven*

seer (noun)	a prophet who sees what is to come	*And when thou hearest thou must heed the seer.*
obstinate (adjective)	stubbornly unwilling to change course	*No fool, the saw goes, like the obstinate fool.*

Discussion questions

1. Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with divine law and human law?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Teiresias answer to "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** "And kings are all a lucre-loving race."
   Answer guidance: "And kings are all a lucre-loving race."
2. What does Teiresias say is polluting the city? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The unburied body
   Answer guidance: The unburied body.
3. What does Teiresias say about error? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Everyone errs; the wise repent and seek a cure
   Answer guidance: Everyone errs; the wise repent and seek a cure.
4. How does Creon insult Teiresias? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He calls prophets a money-getting tribe
   Answer guidance: He calls prophets a money-getting tribe.
5. What does Creon finally decide? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To bury Polyneices and free Antigone
   Answer guidance: To bury Polyneices and free Antigone.
6. Why is Creon's change of mind tragic? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It comes too late
   Answer guidance: It comes too late.
7. Retell the most important events of "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The blind prophet Teiresias warns Creon that the birds and altars show the gods' anger: the unburied body pollutes the city. He urges Creon to yield. Creon insults him as a money-getter. Teiresias prophesies that Creon will pay with a child of his own. Shaken, Creon decides to bury Polyneices and free Antigone.

Answer guidance: The blind prophet Teiresias warns Creon that the birds and altars show the gods' anger: the unburied body pollutes the city. He urges Creon to yield. Creon insults him as a money-getter. Teiresias prophesies that Creon will pay with a child of his own. Shaken, Creon decides to bury Polyneices and free Antigone.

8. Who is on stage in “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “True, as unwisdom is the worst of ills.” What does “unwisdom” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** unwisdom: lack of wisdom; folly.
    Answer guidance: unwisdom: lack of wisdom; folly.

Inferential / analytical

1. What finally persuades Creon to yield? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Teiresias' prophecy and the elders' urging.
   Answer guidance: Teiresias' prophecy and the elders' urging.
2. What does “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)” suggest about the prophet Teiresias? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted.
   Answer guidance: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Evidence to accept: “O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise” (Episode 5, lines 962–965): Teiresias, lines 962–965. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of conflict in “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)”. What does it reveal about the prophet Teiresias that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other. Evidence to accept: “Prophets are all a money-getting tribe” (Episode 5, line 993): Creon, line 993. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the foreshadowing in “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)” shape what we understand about the prophet Teiresias? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise” (Episode 5, lines 962–965): Teiresias, lines 962–965. On foreshadowing:

The threat that Creon will pay with a child of his own points straight at Haemon before the Messenger confirms it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Princes of Thebes, two wayfarers as one, Having betwixt us eyes for one, we are here.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “And kings are all a lucre-loving race” (Episode 5, line 994): Teiresias, line 994. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Teiresias's omens; his prophecy that Creon will pay with a child of his own; the effect, Creon's decision to yield.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Teiresias's omens; his prophecy that Creon will pay with a child of his own; the effect, Creon's decision to yield. Evidence to accept: “To yield is grievous, but the obstinate soul / That fights with Fate, is smitten grievously” (Episode 5, lines 1035–1036): Creon, lines 1035–1036. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)” build on “Stasimon 4 (lines 884–923)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “Prophets are all a money-getting tribe” (Episode 5, line 993): Creon, line 993. Theme link: Creon’s “Prophets are all a money-getting tribe” (line 993) dismisses the seer’s warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the prophet Teiresias, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “And kings are all a lucre-loving race” (Episode 5, line 994): Teiresias, line 994. On characterization: Creon moves from scorn to the admission that “To yield is grievous,” the first crack in the stubbornness that has defined him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why is it so hard to admit we are wrong?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Almost I am persuaded it is best / To keep through life the law ordained of old” (Episode 5, lines 1052–1053): Creon, lines 1052–1053. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does characterization appear in “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)”, and how does it connect the prophet Teiresias to the larger concern with divine law and human law? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “To yield is grievous, but the obstinate soul / That fights with Fate, is smitten grievously” (Episode 5, lines 1035–1036): Creon, lines 1035–1036. On characterization: Creon moves from scorn to the admission that “To yield is grievous,” the first crack in the stubbornness that has defined him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Creon's change of heart real repentance or fear? Argue with lines 1035–1036 and 1052–1053. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.
    Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise” (Episode 5, lines 962–965): Teiresias, lines 962–965. Theme link: Creon’s “Prophets are all a money-getting tribe” (line 993) dismisses the seer’s warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)” acts most wisely in the matter of the prophet Teiresias, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “Prophets are all a money-getting tribe” (Episode 5, line 993): Creon, line 993. On characterization: Creon moves from scorn to the admission that “To yield is grievous,” the first crack in the stubbornness that has defined him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the prophet Teiresias. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “And kings are all a lucre-loving race”

(Episode 5, line 994): Teiresias, line 994. Theme link: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: "To yield is grievous, but the obstinate soul / That fights with Fate, is smitten grievously" (Episode 5, lines 1035–1036): Creon, lines 1035–1036. Theme link: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)", with its focus on the prophet Teiresias, to family and the State: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: "Almost I am persuaded it is best / To keep through life the law ordained of old" (Episode 5, lines 1052–1053): Creon, lines 1052–1053. Theme link: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" effective in presenting the prophet Teiresias, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: "O ponder this, my son. To err is common / To all men, but the man who having erred / Hugs not his errors, but repents and seeks / The cure, is not a wastrel nor unwise" (Episode 5, lines 962–965): Teiresias, lines 962–965. On conflict: Teiresias brings the gods' anger into the open: polluted altars against Creon's insults; prophecy against a king who calls all prophets a "money-getting tribe." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" treats the prophet Teiresias with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (Episode 5, line 993): Creon, line 993. Theme link: Creon's "Prophets are all a money-getting tribe" (line 993) dismisses the seer's warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his

edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “And kings are all a lucre-loving race” (Episode 5, line 994): Teiresias, line 994. On foreshadowing: The threat that Creon will pay with a child of his own points straight at Haemon before the Messenger confirms it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the prophet Teiresias? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon finally bends, but too late. The play's lesson, "To err is common," is offered and almost accepted. Useful evidence: “To yield is grievous, but the obstinate soul / That fights with Fate, is smitten grievously” (Episode 5, lines 1035–1036): Creon, lines 1035–1036. Theme link: Creon’s “Prophets are all a money-getting tribe” (line 993) dismisses the seer’s warning as greed, so he refuses the divine message that would have undone his edict. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who leads the blind Teiresias?
   A. A young boy
   B. His daughter
   C. A soldier
   D. A temple priest

   Key: A (A young boy)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Teiresias sit to read the birds?
   A. On the city wall
   B. On his seat of augury
   C. In the palace hall
   D. By the river

   Key: B (On his seat of augury)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's line: "The blind man cannot move without a _____."

   Key: guide

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did the birds do to each other?

   A. Sang together in sweet harmony at early dawn

   B. Flew away to the sea

   C. Tore at one another with bloody talons

   D. Built nests on the altar

   Key: C (Tore at one another with bloody talons)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happened when Teiresias tried the sacrifice by fire?

   A. The altar split in two

   B. A god spoke from the smoke

   C. Rain put out the torches

   D. The fire would not blaze

   Key: D (The fire would not blaze)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has fed on the unburied body, according to Teiresias?

   A. Dogs and crows

   B. Wolves and lions

   C. Fish of the river

   D. Worms in the soil

   Key: A (Dogs and crows)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon compare Teiresias and the elders to?

   A. Shepherds guarding their flock

   B. Archers shooting at a target

   C. Sailors in a storm

   D. Dogs fighting over meat

   Key: B (Archers shooting at a target)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon tell his men to bring?

   A. Spears

   B. Ropes

   C. Axes

   D. Torches

   Key: C (Axes)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What signs did Teiresias see that showed the gods were angry?

   Sample answer: Teiresias heard the birds screaming a strange jargon and knew they were tearing at each other with bloody talons. When he tried a sacrifice, the fire would not blaze; the thigh bones dripped and sputtered a foul ooze, the gall-bladders burst and the fat melted away. These signs showed that the gods rejected the offerings.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What does Teiresias say will happen to Creon?

    Sample answer: Teiresias says that before the sun has run its course many more times, Creon will lose a child of his own

body, a life for a life, because he has shut a living soul in a tomb and left a corpse unburied above ground. He adds that lamentation will fill Creon's halls and that neighbouring cities will rise in anger.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Teiresias mean by "two wayfarers as one, Having betwixt us eyes for one"?

    A. The boy sees for the two of them

    B. The boy is blind as well

    C. They have walked from far away

    D. Creon must lead them home

    Key: A (The boy sees for the two of them)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Teiresias' line: "No fool, the saw goes, like the _____ fool."

    Key: obstinate

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Teiresias address Creon in line 962?

    A. As a fool

    B. As his son

    C. As a tyrant

    D. As a stranger

    Key: B (As his son)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon say no human stain can do to the gods?

    A. Please them

    B. Praise them

    C. Pollute them

    D. Escape them

    Key: C (Pollute them)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Teiresias say Creon's "wilful temper" does?

    A. It protects the people

    B. It pleases the gods

    C. It will soon pass

    D. It harms the city

    Key: D (It harms the city)

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Creon mean by "Silver of Sardis change for gold of Ind"?

    A. Make whatever profit you like

    B. Trade the silver of Thebes in faraway lands

    C. Pay tribute to the East

    D. Go into exile in Asia

    Key: A (Make whatever profit you like)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say about the seer's past warnings to the State?

    A. They were mostly false

B. They have not failed

C. They were for sale

D. They were ignored

Key: B (They have not failed)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Chorus say Creon should act?

A. Slowly and with great care

B. Through his messengers

C. Quickly and in person

D. After a council

Key: C (Quickly and in person)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Teiresias try to persuade Creon gently at first?

Sample answer: Teiresias calls Creon my son and reminds him that all men err, but the man who repents and seeks the cure is not unwise. He urges Creon to let death disarm his vengeance and asks what glory there is in slaying the slain twice. He says he means Creon well, presenting his warning as friendly counsel.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Creon respond to Teiresias' warning?

Sample answer: Creon accuses the seer and the elders of shooting at him like archers and calls them pedlars who treat him as merchandise. He says he would not allow the burial even if the eagles of Zeus carried the body to Zeus' throne, and he charges Teiresias with dressing up treachery in fair words for gain.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of birds "Gorged with the carnival of human gore" suggest?

A. Nature itself is fouled by the unburied dead

B. The birds of Thebes are celebrating a holy feast day

C. The birds will soon die of hunger

D. Thebes is holding a carnival

Key: A (Nature itself is fouled by the unburied dead)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Teiresias' line: "Counsel's most welcome if it promise _____."

Key: gain

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Teiresias' question "What glory wilt thou win By slaying twice the slain?" imply?

A. Creon has killed two men

B. Punishing a dead man is pointless

C. Glory is won in war against real foes

D. The dead can die again

Key: B (Punishing a dead man is pointless)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the rapid exchange of single lines in lines 986–1002 affect the scene?

A. It slows the action down

B. It calms both men

C. It speeds up the quarrel

D. It settles the argument

Key: C (It speeds up the quarrel)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Teiresias mean by calling his words "shafts" loosed "like a bowman"?

A. He will shoot Creon with a real bow

B. He is a soldier

C. His words are weak

D. His warnings will strike home

Key: D (His warnings will strike home)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the Chorus's remark about the prophet's warnings in lines 1031–1033 add?

A. It confirms the seer's authority

B. It shows that the elders doubt him greatly

C. It mocks the prophet

D. It praises Creon

Key: A (It confirms the seer's authority)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's "To yield is grievous" reveal?

A. He enjoys changing his mind whenever he can

B. Giving in hurts his pride

C. He wants revenge

D. He is too ill to act

Key: B (Giving in hurts his pride)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Creon's last line about "the law ordained of old" suggest?

A. He plans to write new laws for the city of Thebes

B. He doubts the old gods

C. He now sees the worth of ancient divine law

D. He will leave Thebes

Key: C (He now sees the worth of ancient divine law)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how Teiresias' account of the failed sacrifice shows the gods' anger.

Sample answer: Teiresias says the God of Fire came not in flame, the thigh bones dripped a foul ooze into the ashes, the gall-bladders cracked and the fat melted away. The offerings are rejected, and he calls them the frustrate signs of oracles grown dumb. The vivid, disgusting details show that the gods have turned away from Thebes because of the unburied corpse.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Creon changes his mind from conviction or fear.

Sample answer: Creon yields only after Teiresias foretells the death of his own child and the elders say the seer's warnings never fail. He admits that to yield is grievous and that Fate is ill to fight, which suggests fear. Yet he ends by saying it is best to keep the law ordained of old. A strong answer weighs both and supports a view with lines.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Creon's metaphor of "Pedlars" and "merchandise" reveal his view of the seer?

    A. He reduces religion to trade

    B. He respects the seer's great skill

    C. He wants to buy the seer's help

    D. He fears the market

    Key: A (He reduces religion to trade)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Teiresias' line: "Thou art infected with that _____ thyself."

    Key: ill

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in Creon's claim that "No human soilure can assail the gods"?

    A. He has become a priest

    B. He uses piety to excuse polluting the city

    C. He is right about the gods

    D. He fears the gods more than anything in the world

    Key: B (He uses piety to excuse polluting the city)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Teiresias' warning of "life for life" connect to Creon's crimes?

    A. He will lose his throne to the boy

    B. Teiresias will die for Antigone

    C. His own child will pay for the death he caused

    D. The city will lose its army

    Key: C (His own child will pay for the death he caused)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the seer's charge "thou usurp'st a power not thine" mean?

    A. Creon stole the throne from the true heirs of Oedipus

    B. Creon took Teiresias' office

    C. Creon commands the army

    D. He claims power over the dead that is the gods'

    Key: D (He claims power over the dead that is the gods')

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] The episode's movement from fierce quarrel to sudden reversal most emphasizes

    A. The force needed to bend Creon's will

    B. Teiresias' love of argument for its own sake

    C. The Chorus's indifference

    D. The boy's importance

    Key: A (The force needed to bend Creon's will)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Teiresias' speech moves from evidence to counsel to warning.

Sample answer: Teiresias first reports evidence: sitting at his "throne of augury," he hears birds in "twitterings, hoots, and screams" tearing one another, then finds the sacrifice by fire fail, a "foul ooze" from the thigh bones and altars that will not kindle (lines 938–953). He interprets the signs as Creon's "wilful temper" profaning the shrines with the unburied son, and he offers counsel: "To err is common," but the man who "repents and seeks / The cure" is not unwise; "Let death disarm thy vengeance" (lines 954–970). Only after Creon insults him as a profit-seeker does he warn that Creon shall pay "life for life," a living soul entombed and a corpse left "unlaved, unwept, unsepulchred" (lines 1003–1010). The structure shows a seer who tries reason before revelation.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Creon's treatment of Teiresias with his treatment of Haemon.
    Sample answer: With both men Creon rejects wise advice and turns to insult: he called Haemon a woman's slave and calls Teiresias a money-getting prophet who sells his art. In each case he suspects motives rather than weighing arguments. The difference is that Teiresias' warning frightens him into yielding, while Haemon's reasoning did not.
39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate the role of the Chorus in Creon's reversal.
    Sample answer: After Teiresias leaves, the elders remind Creon that the seer's warnings have not failed the State and tell him to free the maiden and build a tomb at once. Creon asks them for advice and promises to heed it. A strong answer weighs whether the elders' counsel or the seer's warning moves him, and notes how late the Chorus speaks out.
40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the episode develop the theme of seeing and blindness?
    Sample answer: Teiresias is blind and needs a boy to guide him, yet he reads the signs of the gods and sees what Creon cannot. Creon, who can see, is blind to his own error and calls the seer a fraud. The contrast shows that true sight is insight, and that the powerful king is the one truly in the dark.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 5 (lines 924–1053) develops the idea of the prophet Teiresias. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" could deliver about the prophet Teiresias. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the prophet Teiresias in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 5 (lines 924–1053) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the prophet Teiresias. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" could deliver about the prophet Teiresias. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the prophet Teiresias in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 5 (lines 924–1053) suggests about the prophet Teiresias. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" could deliver about the prophet Teiresias. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the prophet Teiresias in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Episode 5 (lines 924–1053) to complicate the reader's understanding of the prophet Teiresias. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)" could deliver about the prophet Teiresias. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the prophet Teiresias in "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Princes of Thebes, two wayfarers as one, Having betwixt us eyes for one, we are here. The blind man cannot move without a guide. Why tidings, old Teiresias? I will tell thee; And when thou hearest thou must heed the seer. Thus far I ne'er have disobeyed thy rede. So hast thou steered the ship of State aright. I know it, and I gladly own my debt. Bethink thee that thou treadest once again The razor edge of peril. What is this? Thy words inspire a dread presentiment.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)"?

   A. The elders' song tracing the quarrel to desire

   B. The prophet Teiresias

   C. Haemon and his father

   D. The city's victory song

SAT key: 1. B (The prophet Teiresias)

Lesson 13: Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)

Focus: hymn to Dionysus

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093) (hymn to Dionysus) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus calls on Dionysus, Thebes' own god, to come and heal the city.

Background: Dionysus was the god of theatre: tragedies were performed at his festival in Athens. The hymn is part of the play.

Significance: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer place a hopeful song just before disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to divine law and human law because....
Prompt: Why might a writer place a hopeful song just before disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to divine law and human law because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Today's words: revellers — people taking part in a noisy celebration; bastion — a strong defensive position; clustered — gathered in close groups; sicken — to become ill; orbs — spheres, especially of light; rout — a disorderly crowd. Dionysus was the god of theatre: tragedies were performed at his festival in Athens. The hymn is part of the play. Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Allusion: The hymn calls Dionysus by many cult names and Theban places (Ismenus, the Dragon's teeth), rooting the prayer in the city's own founding myth. Tone / mood: Urgent and hopeful, the elders ask their own god to come and heal just as catastrophe is already under way offstage. Structure: A brief choral prayer stands between Creon's change of mind and the Messenger's report, the calm before the ruin. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The hymn never names the corpse; its hope for healing sits beside the still-unburied Polyneices and the still-entombed Antigone.
Words: revellers: people taking part in a noisy celebration · bastion: a strong defensive position · clustered: gathered in close groups · sicken: to become ill · orbs: spheres, especially of light · rout: a disorderly crowd

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how allusion shapes hymn to Dionysus. Key takeaway: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allusion:** The hymn calls Dionysus by many cult names and Theban places (Ismenus, the Dragon's teeth), rooting the prayer in the city's own founding myth.
- **Tone / mood:** Urgent and hopeful, the elders ask their own god to come and heal just as catastrophe is already under way offstage.
- **Structure:** A brief choral prayer stands between Creon's change of mind and the Messenger's report, the calm before the ruin.

Themes and how they develop

- **divine law and human law:** The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The hymn never names the corpse; its hope for healing sits beside the still-unburied Polyneices and the still-entombed Antigone.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen / Haunt of revellers, men and maids, / Dionysus, thou art seen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061) Chorus, lines 1054–1061.
- "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067) Chorus, lines 1062–1067.
- "Thee on the two-crested rock / Lurid-flaming torches see" (Stasimon 5, lines 1068–1069) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex.
Evidence: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen / Haunt of revellers, men and maids, / Dionysus, thou art seen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061)
Reasoning: The Chorus calls on Dionysus, Thebes' own god, to come and heal the city.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1054–1060

1054 **Chorus:** Thou by many names adored,
1055 **Chorus:** Child of Zeus the God of thunder,
1056 **Chorus:** Of a Theban bride the wonder,
1057 **Chorus:** Fair Italia's guardian lord;
1058 **Chorus:** In the deep-embosomed glades
1059 **Chorus:** Of the Eleusinian Queen
1060 **Chorus:** Haunt of revellers, men and maids,

Lines 1054–1061

1054 **Chorus:** Thou by many names adored,
1055 **Chorus:** Child of Zeus the God of thunder,
1056 **Chorus:** Of a Theban bride the wonder,
1057 **Chorus:** Fair Italia's guardian lord;
1058 **Chorus:** In the deep-embosomed glades
1059 **Chorus:** Of the Eleusinian Queen
1060 **Chorus:** Haunt of revellers, men and maids,
1061 **Chorus:** Dionysus, thou art seen.

Lines 1054–1067

1054 **Chorus:** Thou by many names adored,
1055 **Chorus:** Child of Zeus the God of thunder,
1056 **Chorus:** Of a Theban bride the wonder,
1057 **Chorus:** Fair Italia's guardian lord;
1058 **Chorus:** In the deep-embosomed glades
1059 **Chorus:** Of the Eleusinian Queen
1060 **Chorus:** Haunt of revellers, men and maids,
1061 **Chorus:** Dionysus, thou art seen.
1062 **Chorus:** Where Ismenus rolls his waters,
1063 **Chorus:** Where the Dragon's teeth were sown,
1064 **Chorus:** Where the Bacchanals thy daughters
1065 **Chorus:** Round thee roam,
1066 **Chorus:** There thy home;
1067 **Chorus:** Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own.

Line 1062

1062 **Chorus:** Where Ismenus rolls his waters,

Lines 1062–1067

1062 **Chorus:** Where Ismenus rolls his waters,
1063 **Chorus:** Where the Dragon's teeth were sown,
1064 **Chorus:** Where the Bacchanals thy daughters
1065 **Chorus:** Round thee roam,

1066 **Chorus:** There thy home;
1067 **Chorus:** Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own.

Line 1067
1067 **Chorus:** Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own.

Lines 1068–1069
1068 **Chorus:** Thee on the two-crested rock
1069 **Chorus:** Lurid-flaming torches see;

Line 1083
1083 **Chorus:** Whether adown Parnassian heights descending,

Line 1084
1084 **Chorus:** Or o'er the roaring straits thy swift was wending,

Line 1085
1085 **Chorus:** Save us, O save!

Line 1086
1086 **Chorus:** Brightest of all the orbs that breathe forth light,

Line 1088
1088 **Chorus:** Leader of all the voices of the night,

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
revellers (noun)	people taking part in a noisy celebration	*Haunt of revellers, men and maids, / Dionysus, thou art seen.*
bastion (noun)	a strong defensive position	*By Nysa's bastion ivy-clad, / By shores with clustered vineyards glad,*
clustered (adjective)	gathered in close groups	*By shores with clustered vineyards glad, / There to thee the hymn rings out,*
sicken (verb)	to become ill	*Thou see'st with what a plague our townsfolk sicken.*
orbs (noun)	spheres, especially of light	*Brightest of all the orbs that breathe forth light,*
rout (noun)	a disorderly crowd	*Thy maddened rout / Who dance before thee all night long, and shout,*

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer place a hopeful song just before disaster?
2. Where does allusion appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with family and the State?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Who haunts Dionysus' glades, according to the hymn? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Revellers, men and maids.
   Answer guidance: Revellers, men and maids.
2. Where do the elders say the vineyards stand (lines 1072–1073)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** On shores glad with clustered vineyards, near Nysa's ivy-clad bastion.
   Answer guidance: On shores glad with clustered vineyards, near Nysa's ivy-clad bastion.
3. To whom does the Chorus pray? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Dionysus
   Answer guidance: Dionysus.
4. Whose child is Dionysus called? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Zeus'
   Answer guidance: Zeus'.
5. What is the tone of the hymn? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Joyful and hopeful
   Answer guidance: Joyful and hopeful.
6. Why is the hymn ironic? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Disaster comes right after it
   Answer guidance: Disaster comes right after it.
7. What is Dionysus' link to the theatre? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The plays were performed at his festival
   Answer guidance: The plays were performed at his festival.
8. Retell the most important events of "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus calls on Dionysus, Thebes' own god, to come and heal the city.
   Answer guidance: The Chorus calls on Dionysus, Thebes' own god, to come and heal the city.
9. Who is on stage in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when is "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A

setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why ask Dionysus in particular to heal Thebes? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Dionysus is Thebes's own god; cite the local place-names in the hymn.

   Answer guidance: The elders ask Dionysus because Thebes is "thine own": they name Ismenus and the place "Where the Dragon's teeth were sown," and they call the Bacchanals "thy daughters" (lines 1062–1067). He is the city's own god, child of a Theban line, so they ask him in particular to come home and heal the land.
2. What does "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" suggest about hymn to Dionysus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex.

   Answer guidance: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Evidence to accept: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of allusion in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)". What does it reveal about hymn to Dionysus that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** references to other books, myths, history or religion.

   Answer guidance: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion. Evidence to accept: "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067): Chorus, lines 1062–1067. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the tone / mood in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" shape what we understand about hymn to Dionysus? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. On tone / mood: Urgent and hopeful, the elders ask their own god to come and heal just as catastrophe is already under way offstage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Thou by many names adored, Child of Zeus the God of thunder, Of a Theban bride the wonder, Fair Italia's guardian lord; In the deep-embosomed glades Of the Eleusinian Queen Haunt…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Thee on the

two-crested rock / Lurid-flaming torches see" (Stasimon 5, lines 1068–1069): Chorus, in this part of the section. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Dionysus called by many names; the plea to come and heal the city; the effect, a hopeful prayer just before the news arrives.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Dionysus called by many names; the plea to come and heal the city; the effect, a hopeful prayer just before the news arrives. Evidence to accept: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" build on "Episode 5 (lines 924–1053)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067): Chorus, lines 1062–1067. On structure: A brief choral prayer stands between Creon's change of mind and the Messenger's report, the calm before the ruin. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about hymn to Dionysus, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thee on the two-crested rock / Lurid-flaming torches see" (Stasimon 5, lines 1068–1069): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why might a writer place a hopeful song just before disaster?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067): Chorus, lines 1062–1067. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does structure appear in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)", and how does it connect hymn to Dionysus to the larger concern with family and the State? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. On structure: A brief choral prayer stands between Creon's change of mind and the Messenger's report, the calm before the ruin. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the hymn make the ending more painful? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defended position.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thee on the two-crested rock / Lurid-flaming torches see" (Stasimon 5, lines 1068–1069): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" acts most wisely in the matter of hymn to Dionysus, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of hymn to Dionysus. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067): Chorus, lines 1062–1067. On structure: A brief choral prayer stands between Creon's change of mind and the Messenger's report, the calm before the ruin.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thee on the two-crested rock / Lurid-flaming torches see" (Stasimon 5, lines 1068–1069): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)", with its focus on hymn to Dionysus, to pride and stubbornness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the allusion in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" effective in presenting hymn to Dionysus, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067): Chorus, lines 1062–1067. On allusion: The hymn calls Dionysus by many cult names and Theban places (Ismenus, the Dragon's teeth), rooting the prayer in the city's own founding myth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" treats hymn to Dionysus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thee on the two-crested rock / Lurid-flaming torches see" (Stasimon 5, lines 1068–1069): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its

harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Thou by many names adored, / Child of Zeus the God of thunder, / Of a Theban bride the wonder, / Fair Italia's guardian lord; / In the deep-embosomed glades / Of the Eleusinian Queen" (Stasimon 5, lines 1054–1061): Chorus, lines 1054–1061. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about hymn to Dionysus? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hope rises just before the catastrophe, a tragic pattern that also appears in Oedipus Rex. Useful evidence: "Where Ismenus rolls his waters, / Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, / Where the Bacchanals thy daughters / Round thee roam, / There thy home; / Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own" (Stasimon 5, lines 1062–1067): Chorus, lines 1062–1067. Theme link: The city that enforced Creon's edict now begs a god to heal it, so divine help is asked only after human law has already done its harm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus call Thebes in line 1067?
   A. The god's own home
   B. A city of sorrow and tears
   C. Creon's prison
   D. A harbour town

   Key: A (The god's own home)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which river is named in line 1062?
   A. Acheron
   B. Ismenus
   C. The Nile
   D. Alpheus

Key: B (Ismenus)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Where the Dragon's _____ were sown"

   Key: teeth

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What cry do the Thebans shout through the streets?

   A. Victory
   B. Peace
   C. Evoë
   D. Farewell

   Key: C (Evoë)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which city do the elders say the god loves best?

   A. The sea and its many fast ships
   B. Mount Olympus
   C. The city of Argos
   D. Thebes above other cities

   Key: D (Thebes above other cities)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders ask the god to do in line 1085?

   A. Save them
   B. Punish Creon
   C. Leave Thebes
   D. Bring rain

   Key: A (Save them)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From which heights might the god descend, according to line 1083?

   A. Olympian peaks
   B. Parnassian heights
   C. Theban hills
   D. The mountains of Argos

   Key: B (Parnassian heights)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who dance before the god all night long?

   A. The elders of Thebes
   B. The guards of Creon
   C. His train of Thyiads
   D. The Muses

   Key: C (His train of Thyiads)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders ask the god to do for Thebes?

   Sample answer: The elders remind the god that he loves Thebes best of all cities and see that the townsfolk are sick with a plague. They crave his ready help and beg him to come, whether down from Parnassus or across the roaring straits, crying Save us, O save! They want him to heal and protect the city.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] Why do the elders call Thebes the god's own city?

    Sample answer: The god is the child of Zeus and of a Theban bride, so Thebes is his birthplace. The elders describe his home by the waters of Ismenus, where the Dragon's teeth were sown and his Bacchanals roam around him. They end the stanza by saying, Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “Thou by many names adored” tell us about the god?

    A. He is worshipped under different names

    B. He has forgotten his own name and his home

    C. He is unknown in Thebes

    D. He has no worshippers

    Key: A (He is worshipped under different names)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “Thou see’st with what a _____ our townsfolk sicken.”

    Key: plague

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “levin-stricken” say about the god's mother?

    A. She was struck down by a long illness

    B. She was struck by lightning

    C. She was a queen

    D. She was blind

    Key: B (She was struck by lightning)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why do the elders list places where the god is worshipped?

    A. To boast of the empire that Thebes rules over

    B. To plan a journey

    C. To show how widely his power reaches

    D. To warn travellers

    Key: C (To show how widely his power reaches)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Brightest of all the orbs that breathe forth light” compare the god to?

    A. A burning city

    B. A golden crown

    C. A lamp in a tomb

    D. A shining star

    Key: D (A shining star)

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the hymn's mood differ from the scene just before it?

    A. It turns from dread to celebration

    B. It turns from calm to anger

    C. It turns from joy to grief

    D. It turns from noise to silence

    Key: A (It turns from dread to celebration)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the cry “Evoë” express?

    A. A warning of danger ahead

    B. Ecstatic worship of the god

    C. A call for silence

    D. Grief for the dead

    Key: B (Ecstatic worship of the god)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What image of the god's arrival does line 1084 give?

    A. Riding a great chariot of fire through the sky

    B. Sailing on a golden ship

    C. Crossing the roaring straits swiftly

    D. Walking slowly from the east

    Key: C (Crossing the roaring straits swiftly)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the hymn connect Dionysus to Thebes?

    Sample answer: The hymn calls him the child of Zeus and of a Theban bride, places his home where Ismenus rolls and the Dragon's teeth were sown, and declares Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own. Because he loves this city best of all, the elders believe he is the right god to call on in their need.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the hymn reveal about the elders' hopes after Creon leaves?

    Sample answer: The elders have just urged Creon to free the maiden and bury the dead, and he has gone to do it. Their hymn is full of eager praise and a plea for healing, which suggests they hope his change of heart will cleanse the city of its sickness. They turn to the city's own god, trusting that help is near.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What effect do the many place names in the hymn have?

    A. They make the god's power feel vast

    B. They confuse the elders

    C. They describe the lands that Creon rules

    D. They list old battles

    Key: A (They make the god's power feel vast)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: “Leader of all the voices of the _____”

    Key: night

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why might the elders call on the god of revels at this moment?

    A. They want to hold a great feast in Creon's honour

    B. They hope joy will replace the city's sickness

    C. They fear Bacchus

    D. They mourn Antigone

    Key: B (They hope joy will replace the city's sickness)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of the cry “Save us, O save!”?

    A. It shows that they are calm

    B. It mocks the god

C. It shows the urgency of their plea

D. It ends the hymn in triumph

Key: C (It shows the urgency of their plea)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “Thy handmaids we” suggest about the elders?

A. They are still the loyal servants of King Creon

B. They are women of the city

C. They are slaves of Argos

D. They see themselves as the god's servants

Key: D (They see themselves as the god's servants)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the hymn's structure move?

A. From praise of the god to a plea for help

B. From a long plea for help to a bitter curse

C. From grief to anger

D. From a story to a law

Key: A (From praise of the god to a plea for help)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the phrase “Fair Italia’s guardian lord” show?

A. The god was born and raised in the land of Italy

B. The god's worship reaches far beyond Greece

C. Thebes rules Italy

D. The god hates Thebes

Key: B (The god's worship reaches far beyond Greece)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the hymn's pairing of plague and festival suggest?

A. The city enjoys its sickness

B. The festival caused the plague

C. The city longs for healing through joy

D. The plague has ended at long last

Key: C (The city longs for healing through joy)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the hymn uses light and fire imagery.

Sample answer: The hymn describes lurid-flaming torches on the two-crested rock, calls the god the brightest of all the orbs that breathe forth light, and recalls his mother, struck by the levin, or lightning. The images of fire and light link the god to divine power and festival joy, and they promise brightness to a city darkened by sickness.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Evaluate whether the hymn's joyful tone fits its place in the play.

Sample answer: The hymn follows Teiresias' warning and Creon's hurried change of heart, so its joy can seem out of place. Yet it expresses the elders' real hope that the city can be healed. A strong answer weighs whether the joy is natural relief or dangerous optimism, and explains how it affects the audience's expectations.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the hymn recall the Parodos?

A. Each calls on Bacchus to lead the city

B. Each mourns Polyneices by name

C. Each praises Creon's decree

D. Each describes the plague in close detail

Key: A (Each calls on Bacchus to lead the city)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line: "Where Corisian maidens _____"

Key: flock

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why is the elders' appeal to a god of ecstasy and revelry complex?

A. He has no power over sickness or health at any time

B. That god also humbles those who resist him

C. He is Creon's ally

D. He is a minor god

Key: B (That god also humbles those who resist him)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the hymn suggest about the elders' view of Creon's reversal?

A. They think it is a grave mistake

B. They plan to oppose it

C. They hope it will heal the city

D. They have not heard of it

Key: C (They hope it will heal the city)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The hymn's mention of "the springs of Castaly" and "Nysa's bastion" mainly serves to

A. Describe the route of Creon's journey to the tomb

B. Locate Antigone's tomb

C. List Theban colonies

D. Widen the god's presence across the Greek world

Key: D (Widen the god's presence across the Greek world)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What role does the hymn play in the rhythm of the play?

A. It creates a pause of hope before the outcome is known

B. It ends the play with a final prayer to the gods of Thebes

C. It introduces Teiresias

D. It retells the burial

Key: A (It creates a pause of hope before the outcome is known)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the hymn presents Thebes' relationship with Dionysus.

Sample answer: The hymn calls Dionysus the child of Zeus and a Theban bride, says Thebes is his own, and claims he loves the city best of all. The elders speak as his handmaids and recall the torches, springs and vineyards where he is worshipped. Thebes is presented as the god's home and favourite, which makes their plea for help feel like a claim on family.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Compare the hymn with the Parodos in tone and purpose.

Sample answer: The Parodos celebrated the victory over Argos and called on Bacchus to lead the dance through the night.

The hymn also calls on him with joy, but now as a healer for a city sick with plague. Both are festive, yet the first gives thanks for safety while the second pleads for rescue, showing how far Thebes has fallen since the play began.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Evaluate the dramatic irony of placing this hymn here.
Sample answer: Teiresias has just foretold that Creon will pay life for life, yet the elders sing joyfully as if help is near. The audience, remembering the warning, may doubt that the god will come in time. A strong answer weighs whether the hymn deepens suspense or offers genuine hope, and supports the view with lines from the hymn and the episode before it.

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the hymn's imagery of madness and revelry relate to themes in the play?
Sample answer: The hymn praises the god's maddened rout of Thyiads and his revellers, who dance all night. Earlier the play showed madness as a danger: Love's poisoned dart and the Edonian king's frenzy. Here ecstasy is holy. The contrast asks whether giving up control can be divine, while Creon's refusal to yield has brought the city to sickness.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 7, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093) develops the idea of hymn to Dionysus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)” could deliver about hymn to Dionysus. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for hymn to Dionysus in “Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of hymn to Dionysus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)” could deliver about hymn to Dionysus. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for hymn to Dionysus in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093) suggests about hymn to Dionysus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's allusion and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" could deliver about hymn to Dionysus. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for hymn to Dionysus in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses allusion in Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093) to complicate the reader's understanding of hymn to Dionysus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)" could deliver about hymn to Dionysus. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for hymn to Dionysus in "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Thou by many names adored, Child of Zeus the God of thunder, Of a Theban bride the wonder, Fair Italia's guardian lord; In the deep-embosomed glades Of the Eleusinian Queen Haunt of revellers, men and maids, Dionysus, thou art seen. Where Ismenus rolls his waters, Where the Dragon's teeth were sown, Where the Bacchanals thy daughters Round thee roam, There thy home; Thebes, O Bacchus, is thine own.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)"?

   A. Hymn to Dionysus

   B. Two sisters, one choice

   C. Creon's public lecture on loyalty to the State

   D. Others who were shut away

SAT key: 1. A (Hymn to Dionysus)

Lesson 14: Exodos (lines 1094–1279)

Focus: the ruin of Creon's house

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported or spoken of)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Cite method lines by number only.
Suggested language: "How do the others respond to this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A Messenger reports that Creon buried Polyneices and then went to the tomb, where Antigone and Haemon had died; Haemon had first turned on his father. Queen Eurydice hears and goes silently inside; she too dies. Creon returns, admitting the fault is his alone. The Chorus closes: wisdom is the chief part of happiness, and the proud learn it too late.

Background: The deaths happen offstage and are reported. Method lines (53; 1161–1162; 1175–1179; 1235–1236; 1241; 1246–1248) are cited by line number only and are never quoted or asked about.

Significance: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to learning too late because....
Prompt: What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to learning too late because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Six key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: deprecate — to pray that something bad, such as anger, will be turned away; contrite — feeling sorry for having done wrong; enviable — so fortunate that others wish they were in the same place; discreet — careful and sensible in what one says and does; ominous — suggesting that something bad is going to happen; horoscope — a forecast of a person's fate from the stars. "enviable": c. 1600, from envy + -able, or from French enviable.
Words: deprecate: to pray that something bad, such as anger, will be turned away · contrite: feeling sorry for having done wrong · enviable: so fortunate that others wish they were in the same place · discreet: careful and sensible in what one says and does · ominous: suggesting that something bad is going to happen · horoscope: a forecast of a person's fate from the stars

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The deaths happen offstage and are reported. Method lines (53; 1161–1162; 1175–1179; 1235–1236; 1241; 1246–1248) are cited by line number only and are never quoted or asked about. Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Plot: The Messenger reports the triple ruin—Polyneices buried too late, Antigone and Haemon dead, Eurydice silent then dead—while Creon returns to claim the fault as his alone. Characterization: Creon's "The fault was mine, mine only" is the recognition the play has been driving toward; the proud king learns in sorrow what he would not learn in counsel. Theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Watch for burial and the unburied body: The play ends with Polyneices buried at last and Antigone dead in her tomb, so the pattern of denied and enforced burial closes on Creon's empty house.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life's joys I count a living death" slowly and put it in my own words: the Messenger says that everything is gone and wasted, and that a life without life's joys is only a living death. Next, craft. "All is gone and wasted" empties the house in five words, and "a living death" judges a life that has lost its joys without naming the events just reported. The strongest word is "wasted": it empties the king's fortune in a single past participle. Then, effect. What do lines 1105–1106 reveal about the ruin of Creon's house? My answer: The report has already turned the ruin of Creon's house into a lesson. Creon's later admission, "The fault was mine, mine only" (line 1210), is the recognition these lines begin to prepare.

> *Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life's joys I count a living death (Exodos, lines 1105–1106)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life's joys I count a living death" slowly and put it in my own words: the Messenger says that everything is gone and wasted, and that a life without life's joys is only a living death. Next, craft. "All is gone and wasted" empties the house in five words, and "a living death" judges a life that has lost its joys without naming the events just reported. The strongest word is "wasted": it empties the king's fortune in a single past participle. Then, effect. What do lines 1105–1106 reveal about the ruin of Creon's house? My answer: The report has already turned the ruin of Creon's house into a lesson. Creon's later admission, "The fault was mine, mine only" (line 1210), is the recognition these lines begin to prepare.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Witness", "unwisdom" and "worst of all" stand out. The Messenger turns the whole disaster into a lesson, so the report ends by naming lack of wisdom as the deepest cause. Ask: How does this line connect to learning too late? Expected student answer: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him. (Messenger, lines 1182–1183.)

> *A witness that of ills whate'er befall / Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all (Exodos, lines 1182–1183)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Witness", "unwisdom" and "worst of all" stand out in lines 1182–1183. The Messenger turns the whole disaster into a lesson, so the report ends by naming lack of wisdom as the deepest cause. "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" makes the cause general, then lets it rest on the king just described.
Ask: How does this line connect to learning too late?
Expected student answer: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him. (Messenger, lines 1182–1183.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the ruin of Creon's house? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1094–1279) develops the idea of the ruin of Creon's house. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. When the text says "Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might / Mightily the gods do smite. / Chastisement for errors past / Wisdom brings to age at last" (Exodos, lines 1272–1279), it shows this directly. A Messenger reports that Creon buried Polyneices and then went to the tomb, where Antigone and Haemon had died; Haemon had first turned on his father. Queen Eurydice hears and goes silently inside; she too dies. Creon returns, admitting the fault is his alone. The Chorus closes: wisdom is the chief part of happiness, and the proud learn it too late.

Task: Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the ruin of Creon's house? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1094–1279) develops the idea of the ruin of Creon's house. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. When the text says "Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might / Mightily the gods do smite. / Chastisement for errors past / Wisdom brings to age at last" (Exodos, lines 1272–1279), it shows this directly. A Messenger reports that Creon buried Polyneices and then went to the tomb, where Antigone and Haemon had died; Haemon had first turned on his father. Queen Eurydice hears and goes silently inside; she too dies. Creon returns, admitting the fault is his alone. The Chorus closes: wisdom is the chief part of happiness, and the proud learn it too late.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late? Ask: What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late?

Anchor question: What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late?

Facilitation: Ask: What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the ruin of Creon's house? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. ("Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might", Exodos, lines 1272–1279). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the ruin of Creon's house? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. ("Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might", Exodos, lines 1272–1279). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the ruin of Creon's house. Key takeaway: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The Messenger reports the triple ruin—Polyneices buried too late, Antigone and Haemon dead, Eurydice silent then dead—while Creon returns to claim the fault as his alone.
- **Characterization:** Creon's "The fault was mine, mine only" is the recognition the play has been driving toward; the proud king learns in sorrow what he would not learn in counsel.
- **Theme:** The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted.

Themes and how they develop

- **learning too late:** The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him.

Symbols and motifs

- **burial and the unburied body:** The play ends with Polyneices buried at last and Antigone dead in her tomb, so the pattern of denied and enforced burial closes on Creon's empty house.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life's joys I count a living death" (Exodos, lines 1105–1106) Messenger, lines 1105–1106.
- "A witness that of ills whate'er befall / Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (Exodos, lines 1182–1183) Messenger, lines 1182–1183.
- "The fault was mine, mine only, O my son" (Exodos, line 1210) Creon, line 1210.
- "By sorrow schooled. Heavy the hand of God, / Thorny and rough the paths my feet have trod, / Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain; / Poor mortals, how we labour all in vain" (Exodos, lines 1212–1215) Creon, lines 1212–1215.
- "Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might / Mightily the gods do smite. / Chastisement for errors past / Wisdom brings to age at last" (Exodos, lines 1272–1279) Chorus, lines 1272–1279.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition.
Evidence: "Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might / Mightily the gods do smite. / Chastisement for errors past / Wisdom brings to age at last" (Exodos, lines 1272–1279)
Reasoning: A Messenger reports that Creon buried Polyneices and then went to the tomb, where Antigone and Haemon had died; Haemon had first turned on his father. Queen Eurydice hears and goes silently inside; she too dies. Creon returns, admitting the fault is his alone. The Chorus closes: wisdom is the chief part of happiness, and the proud learn it too late.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 175–182
175 **Creon:** Before his country. For myself, I call
176 **Creon:** To witness Zeus, whose eyes are everywhere,
177 **Creon:** If I perceive some mischievous design
178 **Creon:** To sap the State, I will not hold my tongue;
179 **Creon:** Nor would I reckon as my private friend
180 **Creon:** A public foe, well knowing that the State
181 **Creon:** Is the good ship that holds our fortunes all:
182 **Creon:** Farewell to friendship, if she suffers wreck.

Line 1097
1097 **Messenger:** For Fortune with a constant ebb and rise

Line 1099
1099 **Messenger:** And none can read a mortal's horoscope.

Lines 1105–1106
1105 **Messenger:** Now all is gone and wasted, for a life
1106 **Messenger:** Without life's joys I count a living death.

Line 1113

1113 **Messenger:** Both dead, and they who live deserve to die.

Lines 1113–1130

1113 **Messenger:** Both dead, and they who live deserve to die.
1114 **Chorus:** Who is the slayer, who the victim? speak.
1115 **Messenger:** Haemon; his blood shed by no stranger hand.
1116 **Chorus:** What mean ye? by his father's or his own?
1117 **Messenger:** His own; in anger for his father's crime.
1118 **Chorus:** O prophet, what thou spakest comes to pass.
1119 **Messenger:** So stands the case; now 'tis for you to act.
1120 **Chorus:** Lo! from the palace gates I see approaching
1121 **Chorus:** Creon's unhappy wife, Eurydice.
1122 **Chorus:** Comes she by chance or learning her son's fate?
1123 **Eurydice:** Ye men of Thebes, I overheard your talk.
1124 **Eurydice:** As I passed out to offer up my prayer
1125 **Eurydice:** To Pallas, and was drawing back the bar
1126 **Eurydice:** To open wide the door, upon my ears
1127 **Eurydice:** There broke a wail that told of household woe.
1128 **Eurydice:** Stricken with terror in my handmaids' arms
1129 **Eurydice:** I fell and fainted. But repeat your tale
1130 **Eurydice:** To one not unacquaint with misery.

Lines 1138–1140

1138 **Messenger:** Was lying yet. We offered first a prayer
1139 **Messenger:** To Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways,
1140 **Messenger:** With contrite hearts, to deprecate their ire.

Line 1152

1152 **Messenger:** "Am I a prophet? miserable me!

Lines 1161–1162

[lines 1161–1162: cited by line number only]

Lines 1175–1179

[lines 1175–1179: cited by line number only]

Lines 1180–1181

1180 **Messenger:** Two corpses, one in death. His marriage rites
1181 **Messenger:** Are consummated in the halls of Death:

Lines 1182–1183

1182 **Messenger:** A witness that of ills whate'er befall
1183 **Messenger:** Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all. Exit Eurydice.

Line 1183

1183 **Messenger:** Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all. Exit Eurydice.

Lines 1207–1209

1207 **Creon:** Alas, my son,
1208 **Creon:** Life scarce begun,
1209 **Creon:** Thou wast undone.

Line 1210

1210 **Creon:** The fault was mine, mine only, O my son!

Line 1211

1211 **Chorus:** Too late thou seemest to perceive the truth.

Lines 1212–1215

1212 **Creon:** By sorrow schooled. Heavy the hand of God,
1213 **Creon:** Thorny and rough the paths my feet have trod,
1214 **Creon:** Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain;
1215 **Creon:** Poor mortals, how we labour all in vain!

Line 1214

1214 **Creon:** Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain;

Lines 1235–1236

[lines 1235–1236: cited by line number only]

Line 1254

1254 **Chorus:** His past endure demand the speediest cure.

Lines 1272–1279

1272 **Chorus:** Of happiness the chiefest part
1273 **Chorus:** Is a wise heart:
1274 **Chorus:** And to defraud the gods in aught
1275 **Chorus:** With peril's fraught.
1276 **Chorus:** Swelling words of high-flown might
1277 **Chorus:** Mightily the gods do smite.
1278 **Chorus:** Chastisement for errors past
1279 **Chorus:** Wisdom brings to age at last.

Lines 1276–1277

1276 **Chorus:** Swelling words of high-flown might
1277 **Chorus:** Mightily the gods do smite.

Line 1279

1279 **Chorus:** Wisdom brings to age at last.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
deprecate (verb)	to pray that something bad, such as anger, will be turned away	*We offered first a prayer To Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways, With contrite hearts, to deprecate their ire.*	
contrite (adjective)	feeling sorry for having done wrong	*We offered first a prayer To Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways, With contrite hearts, to deprecate their ire.*	
enviable (adjective)	so fortunate that others wish they were in the same place	*Take Creon; he, methought, if any man, Was enviable.*	"enviable": c. 1600, from envy + -able, or from French enviable. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://www.etymonline.com/word/enviable)
discreet (adjective)	careful and sensible in what one says and does	*Trust me, she is discreet and will not err.*	
ominous (adjective)	suggesting that something bad is going to happen	*I know not, but strained silence, so I deem, Is no less ominous than excessive grief.*	
horoscope (noun)	a forecast of a person's fate from the stars	*And none can read a mortal's horoscope.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and stubbornness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Creon say in line 1210? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** "The fault was mine, mine only, O my son!"
   Answer guidance: "The fault was mine, mine only, O my son!".

2. What does the Messenger say Fortune does to high and low (lines 1097–1098)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** With a constant ebb and rise it casts them down and raises them alike.
   Answer guidance: With a constant ebb and rise it casts them down and raises them alike.
3. How does the audience learn what happened at the tomb? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A Messenger reports it
   Answer guidance: A Messenger reports it.
4. What rites did Creon and his men perform on the plain? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Buried Polyneices
   Answer guidance: Buried Polyneices.
5. Whom does Creon blame at the end? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Himself
   Answer guidance: Himself.
6. According to the Messenger, what is the worst of ills? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Mortals' unwisdom
   Answer guidance: Mortals' unwisdom.
7. What is the Chorus's final lesson? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Wisdom is the chief part of happiness
   Answer guidance: Wisdom is the chief part of happiness.
8. Retell the most important events of "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A Messenger reports that Creon buried Polyneices and then went to the tomb, where Antigone and Haemon had died; Haemon had first turned on his father. Queen Eurydice hears and goes silently inside; she too dies. Creon returns, admitting the fault is his alone. The Chorus closes: wisdom is the chief part of happiness, and the proud learn it too late.
   Answer guidance: A Messenger reports that Creon buried Polyneices and then went to the tomb, where Antigone and Haemon had died; Haemon had first turned on his father. Queen Eurydice hears and goes silently inside; she too dies. Creon returns, admitting the fault is his alone. The Chorus closes: wisdom is the chief part of happiness, and the proud learn it too late.
9. Who is on stage in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when is "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
    Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

Inferential / analytical

1. What has Creon learned by the end (lines 1212–1215)? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** That his pride brought ruin; he is "by sorrow

schooled."

Answer guidance: That his pride brought ruin; he is "by sorrow schooled."

2. What does “Exodos (lines 1094–1279)” suggest about the ruin of Creon's house? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition.

   Answer guidance: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Evidence to accept: “Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life’s joys I count a living death” (Exodos, lines 1105–1106): Messenger, lines 1105–1106. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of plot in “Exodos (lines 1094–1279)”. What does it reveal about the ruin of Creon's house that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** key events and the causes linking them.

   Answer guidance: Look for key events and the causes linking them. Evidence to accept: “A witness that of ills whate’er befall / Mortals’ unwisdom is the worst of all” (Exodos, lines 1182–1183): Messenger, lines 1182–1183. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the characterization in “Exodos (lines 1094–1279)” shape what we understand about the ruin of Creon's house? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: “Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life’s joys I count a living death” (Exodos, lines 1105–1106): Messenger, lines 1105–1106. On characterization: Creon’s “The fault was mine, mine only” is the recognition the play has been driving toward; the proud king learns in sorrow what he would not learn in counsel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Both dead, and they who live deserve to die.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “The fault was mine, mine only, O my son” (Exodos, line 1210): Creon, line 1210. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Exodos (lines 1094–1279)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the Messenger's report of what happened at the tomb; Eurydice's silent exit; the effect, Creon admitting that the fault is his alone.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the Messenger's report of what happened at the tomb; Eurydice's silent exit; the effect, Creon admitting that the fault is his alone. Evidence to accept: “By sorrow schooled. Heavy the hand of God, / Thorny and rough the paths my feet have trod, / Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain; / Poor mortals, how we labour all in vain” (Exodos, lines 1212–1215): Creon, lines 1212–1215. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Exodos (lines 1094–1279)” build on “Stasimon 5 (lines 1054–1093)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s ·

RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "A witness that of ills whate'er befall / Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (Exodos, lines 1182–1183): Messenger, lines 1182–1183. Theme link: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the ruin of Creon's house, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "The fault was mine, mine only, O my son" (Exodos, line 1210): Creon, line 1210. On characterization: Creon's "The fault was mine, mine only" is the recognition the play has been driving toward; the proud king learns in sorrow what he would not learn in counsel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What does it take to learn from a mistake before it is too late?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might / Mightily the gods do smite." (Exodos, lines 1272–1279): Chorus, lines 1272–1279. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does theme appear in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)", and how does it connect the ruin of Creon's house to the larger concern with pride and stubbornness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "By sorrow schooled. Heavy the hand of God, / Thorny and rough the paths my feet have trod, / Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain; / Poor mortals, how we labour all in vain" (Exodos, lines 1212–1215): Creon, lines 1212–1215. On theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who is the tragic hero, Antigone or Creon? Argue with evidence from the Exodos and one earlier scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position naming Antigone or Creon, with evidence from the Exodos and one earlier scene. No item asks how anyone died.

   Answer guidance: A strong answer for Creon can use the Exodos: he admits "The fault was mine, mine

only" (line 1210) and that he has been "By sorrow schooled," his pride humbled (lines 1212–1214). Earlier, his refusal to bury Polyneices and his sentence of Antigone set that fall in motion (for example lines 175–182 or 439–450). A strong answer for Antigone can use her stand on the "immutable unwritten laws of Heaven" (lines 417–424) and her farewell (lines 793–796), and can treat Creon as the man who learns too late. Either claim must cite the Exodos and one earlier scene. No item asks how anyone died.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life's joys I count a living death" (Exodos, lines 1105–1106): Messenger, lines 1105–1106. On theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" acts most wisely in the matter of the ruin of Creon's house, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "A witness that of ills whate'er befall / Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (Exodos, lines 1182–1183): Messenger, lines 1182–1183. On characterization: Creon's "The fault was mine, mine only" is the recognition the play has been driving toward; the proud king learns in sorrow what he would not learn in counsel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the ruin of Creon's house. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "The fault was mine, mine only, O my son" (Exodos, line 1210): Creon, line 1210. Theme link: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and prophecy had already told him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "By sorrow schooled. Heavy the hand of God, / Thorny and rough the paths my feet have trod, / Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain; /

Poor mortals, how we labour all in vain" (Exodos, lines 1212–1215): Creon, lines 1212–1215. On theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)", with its focus on the ruin of Creon's house, to gender and power: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "Of happiness the chiefest part / Is a wise heart: / And to defraud the gods in aught / With peril's fraught. / Swelling words of high-flown might / Mightily the gods do smite." (Exodos, lines 1272–1279): Chorus, lines 1272–1279. On theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" effective in presenting the ruin of Creon's house, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "Now all is gone and wasted, for a life / Without life's joys I count a living death" (Exodos, lines 1105–1106): Messenger, lines 1105–1106. On plot: The Messenger reports the triple ruin—Polyneices buried too late, Antigone and Haemon dead, Eurydice silent then dead—while Creon returns to claim the fault as his alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" treats the ruin of Creon's house with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Antigone see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "A witness that of ills whate'er befall / Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (Exodos, lines 1182–1183): Messenger, lines 1182–1183. On theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve pride and stubbornness? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "The fault was mine, mine only, O my son" (Exodos, line 1210): Creon, line 1210. Theme link: The Messenger's "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" (lines 1182–1183) names the cause of the ruin just reported: Creon learned too late what counsel and

prophecy had already told him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the ruin of Creon's house? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Creon receives the sentence Teiresias foretold. His full admission (line 1210) is the tragic recognition. Useful evidence: "By sorrow schooled. Heavy the hand of God, / Thorny and rough the paths my feet have trod, / Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to pain; / Poor mortals, how we labour all in vain" (Exodos, lines 1212–1215): Creon, lines 1212–1215. On theme: The closing lines make wisdom the "chiefest part" of happiness and warn that swelling words are smitten by the gods, stating the moral Creon has enacted. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does the Messenger first address?
    A. All who dwell beside the halls of Cadmus
    B. The king's guards at the gate of the tomb
    C. The gods of Olympus
    D. Teiresias and the boy

    Key: A (All who dwell beside the halls of Cadmus)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the Messenger, what casts down and raises high and low alike?
    A. Love
    B. Fortune
    C. The king
    D. The sea

    Key: B (Fortune)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's cry as the Messenger reports it: "Is this the saddest _____ I ever trod?"
    Key: path

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To which goddess was Eurydice going to pray?
    A. Persephassa
    B. Aphrodite
    C. Pallas
    D. Hera

Key: C (Pallas)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Eurydice say happened when she heard the wail?

   A. She ran at once to the tomb outside the city

   B. She called for Creon

   C. She laughed at the Messenger's tale

   D. She fainted in her handmaids' arms

   Key: D (She fainted in her handmaids' arms)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Creon's men pile up for Polyneices?

   A. A mound of earth

   B. A wall of rough stone

   C. A heap of gold

   D. A tower of wood

   Key: A (A mound of earth)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Eurydice leave after the Messenger's tale?

   A. Weeping loudly in the street

   B. Without a word

   C. Cursing the elders

   D. Singing a hymn

   Key: B (Without a word)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Creon call himself near the end?

   A. A great and glorious king of Thebes

   B. A wise and gentle judge

   C. A cipher, less than nothing

   D. A friend of the gods

   Key: C (A cipher, less than nothing)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Creon do for Polyneices before going to the tomb?

   Sample answer: Creon and his men crossed the plain to where the body lay. They prayed to Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways to calm their anger, washed the body with holy water, laid it on fresh branches, burned it on a pyre and raised a high mound of earth over the remains.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Messenger say Creon's life is no longer enviable?

    Sample answer: The Messenger says Creon once saved Thebes, ruled with supreme power and was blessed with noble children. Now all his joy is gone. Wealth and royal pomp without pleasure are only the shadow of a shade, so he would not trade a dram of joy for all of Creon's power.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Messenger mean by “none can read a mortal’s horoscope”?

    A. No one can know a person's future

    B. The stars are hidden by clouds over Thebes

    C. Prophets cannot read

    D. Mortals have no fate

Key: A (No one can know a person's future)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Messenger's line: "Truth is ever _____."

Key: best

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What do the Messenger and the elders fear about Eurydice's silence?

A. It shows she did not hear the news

B. It may hide some fell design

C. It means she is happy

D. It shows she blames the guard

Key: B (It may hide some fell design)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Creon mean by "By sorrow schooled"?

A. He was trained in a school

B. He teaches others

C. Suffering has taught him

D. He refuses to learn

Key: C (Suffering has taught him)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Messenger insist on telling the whole truth?

A. He wants a large reward from the queen herself

B. Creon ordered him to lie

C. He is afraid of Eurydice

D. Flattery would be proved false later

Key: D (Flattery would be proved false later)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the tone of Creon's lines "Alas, my son, Life scarce begun, Thou wast undone"?

A. Anguished

B. Proud

C. Calm

D. Mocking

Key: A (Anguished)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Chorus say Creon bears with him as he enters?

A. Gifts for the gods of Thebes

B. Proof of his own guilt

C. A new decree for the city

D. News of victory

Key: B (Proof of his own guilt)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Creon mean by "every way Leads but astray"?

A. He has lost his way home in the dark

B. He wants to travel

C. He has nowhere left to turn

D. He plans a new road

Key: C (He has nowhere left to turn)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Messenger's opening speech prepare the audience for the news?

Sample answer: Before giving any facts, the Messenger says Fortune casts down high and low alike and that no one can read a mortal's future. He describes Creon's former greatness and then says all is gone, so that Creon lives a living death. The audience knows disaster has struck before learning what it is.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why is Eurydice's silent exit alarming?

Sample answer: Eurydice hears the Messenger's report about her son and leaves without a word. The Messenger hopes she will mourn in private, but the elders say strained silence is as ominous as excessive grief. Her silence suggests some fell design hidden in her heart and prepares the audience for more sorrow.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Messenger's phrase "The shadow of a shade" suggest about wealth without joy?

A. It is empty and worthless

B. It is safe from harm

C. It is hidden from thieves

D. It grows larger at night

Key: A (It is empty and worthless)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: "Humbled my pride, my pleasure turned to _____"

Key: pain

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Creon's cry in line 1152?

A. He has become a priest of Apollo

B. He now fears the very warning he had mocked

C. He is glad to hear his son's voice

D. He has forgotten what the seer said to him long ago

Key: B (He now fears the very warning he had mocked)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does the play report the scenes at the tomb through a Messenger?

A. The Messenger is the true hero of the whole play

B. Creon is not allowed at the tomb

C. It keeps the focus on Creon's reaction and loss

D. The tomb is in another city

Key: C (It keeps the focus on Creon's reaction and loss)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus's "Too late thou seemest to perceive the truth" emphasize?

A. Creon has learned nothing at all

B. The truth is still hidden

C. Creon is still in time

D. Recognition has come after the damage

Key: D (Recognition has come after the damage)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Messenger mean by the halls of Death in lines 1180–1181?

A. Their marriage takes place only in death

B. Haemon has married another bride

C. Creon has built a new palace

D. The wedding feast was held in the palace

Key: A (Their marriage takes place only in death)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How has Creon changed by the end of the play?

A. He blames Antigone and the elders for his many losses

B. He accepts guilt instead of defending his will

C. He grows prouder than before

D. He leaves Thebes in triumph

Key: B (He accepts guilt instead of defending his will)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus's "Swelling words of high-flown might Mightily the gods do smite" warn against?

A. Singing too loudly

B. Praying to many gods

C. Proud and boastful speech

D. Speaking with strangers

Key: C (Proud and boastful speech)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the Exodos presents Creon's recognition of his guilt.

Sample answer: Creon enters bearing evidence against himself and cries that the fault was his alone. He calls himself his son's murderer, a cipher less than nothing, and says he is by sorrow schooled, his pride humbled. The Chorus answers that he sees the truth too late. His recognition is complete but cannot undo the losses it explains.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the ending is more Creon's tragedy than Antigone's.

Sample answer: Antigone dies offstage and is reported, while Creon is on stage for the whole ending, losing his son and wife and recognizing his guilt. Yet Antigone's choice drives the play and her death is its turning point. A strong answer weighs these points, defines tragic hero, and supports a view with evidence from the Exodos and an earlier scene.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Messenger's opening on "Fortune with a constant ebb and rise" frame the news?

A. As proof that no one's luck is secure

B. As a punishment sent by Antigone's ghost

C. As a story of good luck

D. As a warning about the sea

Key: A (As proof that no one's luck is secure)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: "Heavy the hand of _____"

    Key: God

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about the Chorus's earlier praise of man's skill in light of the ending?

    A. Man truly masters every danger

    B. Man's cleverness could not save Creon from folly

    C. Creon's skill saved his family

    D. The Chorus has long distrusted man's skill and daring

    Key: B (Man's cleverness could not save Creon from folly)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Messenger's moral "Mortals' unwisdom is the worst of all" add to the account?

    A. It praises the dead for their wisdom

    B. It blames the gods and Fortune for the deaths in the palace

    C. It turns the report into a lesson about folly

    D. It excuses Creon fully

    Key: C (It turns the report into a lesson about folly)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Creon's final speech echo Antigone's earlier laments?

    A. He praises the power of the State and its laws, as Antigone once did

    B. He defends his edict as Antigone defended hers

    C. He leaves Thebes as she left the city

    D. He too laments that he is undone and asks to be led away

    Key: D (He too laments that he is undone and asks to be led away)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The final lines, ending "Wisdom brings to age at last", suggest that wisdom

    A. Comes through suffering, often too late

    B. Is given freely to the young

    C. Can be bought with wealth

    D. Is useless to old men

    Key: A (Comes through suffering, often too late)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the closing choral lines sum up the play's themes.

    Sample answer: The Chorus says the chief part of happiness is a wise heart, that defrauding the gods is perilous, and that the gods strike down swelling words of pride. Wisdom comes to the old through chastisement. These lines gather the play's concerns with pride, divine law and late learning, pointing to Creon as their clearest example.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Creon's state at the end with his confidence in his first speech.

    Sample answer: In his first speech Creon confidently compared the State to a ship he would steer and promised never to put a friend above the country. At the end he is a cipher, led away, saying every way leads astray and that he is crushed by Fate. The contrast shows the complete reversal of fortune that defines tragedy.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the role of Fortune and Fate in the Exodos against human responsibility.

    Sample answer: The Messenger speaks of Fortune's ebb and rise and Creon feels the weight of crushing Fate, yet Creon also says the fault was his alone and the Chorus blames pride. A strong answer weighs whether the ending presents the disaster as fated or as the result of choices, and supports the view with lines.

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Exodos use reported action and on-stage grief together?

    Sample answer: The events at the tomb are told by a Messenger, so the audience hears them through a witness, while Creon's grief is shown directly on stage. The report gives the facts; the lament gives their meaning. Together they keep attention on the cost of Creon's choices rather than on spectacle.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 8, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 7, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Exodos (lines 1094–1279) develops the idea of the ruin of Creon's house. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" could deliver about the ruin of Creon's house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the ruin of Creon's house in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Exodos (lines 1094–1279) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the ruin of Creon's house. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" could deliver about the ruin of Creon's house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the ruin of Creon's house in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Exodos (lines 1094–1279) suggests about the ruin of Creon's house. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" could deliver about the ruin of Creon's house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the ruin of Creon's house in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Exodos (lines 1094–1279) to complicate the reader's understanding of the ruin of Creon's house. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)" could deliver about the ruin of Creon's house. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the ruin of Creon's house in "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to divine law and human law and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *We offered first a prayer To Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways, With contrite hearts, to deprecate their ire.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "deprecate" most nearly mean?

   A. to pray that something bad, such as anger, will be turned away
   B. suggesting that something bad is going to happen
   C. careful and sensible in what one says and does
   D. so fortunate that others wish they were in the same place

2. *Both dead, and they who live deserve to die. Who is the slayer, who the victim? speak. Haemon; his blood shed by no stranger hand. What mean ye? by his father's or his own? His own; in anger for his father's crime. O prophet, what thou spakest comes to pass. So stands the case; now 'tis for you to act. Lo! from the palace gates I see approaching Creon's unhappy wife, Eurydice. Comes she by chance or learning her son's fate? Ye men of Thebes, I overheard your talk. As I passed out to offer up my prayer To Pallas, and was drawing back the bar To open wide the door, upon my ears There broke a wail that told of household woe. Stricken with terror in my handmaids' arms I fell and fainted. But repeat your tale To one not unacquaint with misery.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1094–1279)"?

   A. The ruin of Creon's house
   B. The curse on the house
   C. Antigone before Creon
   D. Creon's first speech and the Guard

SAT key: 1. A (to pray that something bad, such as anger, will be turned away); 2. A (The ruin of Creon's house)

Unit test

Antigone: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Prologue, what does Antigone ask Ismene to help her do?
   A. Give their brother the rites of burial
   B. Escape from Thebes before the watchmen wake at dawn
   C. Plead with Creon for mercy
   D. Find the body of Eteocles

   Key: A (Give their brother the rites of burial)
2. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Prologue take place outside the palace gates?
   A. The sisters have been banished from the palace
   B. Antigone wants to speak where no one can overhear
   C. Creon has called the people to the gates
   D. The elders are meeting inside the palace

   Key: B (Antigone wants to speak where no one can overhear)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Ismene's words in the Prologue: “My poor, fond sister, how I _____ for thee!”

   Key: fear
4. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What choice does Antigone face in the Prologue, and what does she decide?

   Sample answer: Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices on pain of death. Antigone must choose between obeying the edict and giving her brother the rites she believes the gods demand. She decides to bury him, alone if necessary, even though she knows she may die for it.
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Parodos, what are the elders celebrating?
   A. The marriage of a prince
   B. The end of a plague
   C. The defeat of the Argive army
   D. The return of their old king from a long exile

   Key: C (The defeat of the Argive army)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which god does the Chorus of the Parodos ask to lead the dancing?

   A. Phoebus Apollo

   B. Pallas Athena

   C. Ares the war god

   D. Bacchus

   Key: D (Bacchus)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line from the Parodos: “Let us to the temples _____”

   Key: throng

8. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How does the Parodos change the mood of the play after the Prologue?

   Sample answer: The Prologue is tense and private, with two sisters quarrelling in secret before dawn. The Parodos is public and joyful, as the elders greet the sunrise and celebrate the city's victory. The change shows how differently the city and the royal family feel about the end of the war.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 1, what does Creon order for the body of Polyneices?

   A. It must lie unburied for dogs and crows

   B. It must be buried with full honours beside his brother

   C. It must be sent back to Argos

   D. It must be burned on a pyre

   Key: A (It must lie unburied for dogs and crows)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] In Episode 1, what does Creon think caused the burial?

    A. The will of the gods

    B. Bribery of the guards

    C. A storm that swept dust over it in the night

    D. A raid by Argive soldiers

    Key: B (Bribery of the guards)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's words to the Guard in Episode 1: “Thou art good at _____, and canst fence about”

    Key: parry

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Creon's first speech show about his idea of a good citizen?

    Sample answer: Creon says a good citizen puts the State before any friend, since the State is the ship that carries everyone's fortunes. Patriots, living or dead, will be honoured by him, while traitors will not. His idea of goodness is loyalty to the city.

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Ode on Man, which creatures does man catch with his woven snare?

    A. Lions and wolves

    B. Only wild horses

    C. Birds, beasts and fish

    D. Snakes and scorpions

Key: C (Birds, beasts and fish)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] In the Ode on Man, how do the elders react on seeing Antigone?

    A. With anger and a kind of grim joy

    B. With loud laughter

    C. With no interest

    D. With shock and pity

    Key: D (With shock and pity)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line in the Ode on Man: “Proudly his _____ shall stand”

    Key: city

16. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Ode on Man, what does the Chorus admire about human beings?

    Sample answer: The Chorus admires man's daring and skill. He sails the stormy sea, ploughs the Earth, traps birds, beasts and fish, and tames wild animals. He has also taught himself speech, thought and the ways of living together in a city.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 2, who brings Antigone before Creon?

    A. The Guard

    B. The Chorus

    C. A herald

    D. A priest

    Key: A (The Guard)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 2, what does Antigone say when Creon asks if she knew of the edict?

    A. She had not heard of it

    B. She knew, as everyone did

    C. A stranger told her of it

    D. She thought it was a joke

    Key: B (She knew, as everyone did)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's question in Episode 2: “Hast thou no _____ to differ from all these?”

    Key: shame

20. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 2, what does Antigone say about her brothers when Creon calls one a traitor?

    Sample answer: Antigone says the slain man was no villain but a brother, and that both had one mother and one father. She believes the dead deserve the same rites whatever they did in life, and that the gods below ask for equal burial. Her love, she says, is for sharing, not for hate.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 2, what natural force does the family curse resemble?

    A. A forest fire in high summer

    B. An earthquake under the palace

    C. Storm waves on the shore

D. A plague of locusts stripping the fields

Key: C (Storm waves on the shore)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 2, on what does Hope flit about?

A. A golden chariot drawn by doves

B. The backs of birds

C. A cloud of smoke

D. Never-wearying wings

Key: D (Never-wearying wings)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line from Stasimon 2: "Scourges each age with sorrows never _____."

Key: ending

24. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 2, why does the Chorus call those who never suffered blest?

Sample answer: The Chorus says that once the gods curse a family, the suffering spreads from age to age, like storm waves that keep crashing on the shore. Those who have never tasted pain are lucky because they have escaped that endless cycle of sorrow, which now reaches Antigone.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 3, what does Creon call Antigone among all his subjects?

A. The one malcontent

B. The most loyal of all his people

C. The wisest of the women

D. The youngest of his kin

Key: A (The one malcontent)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 3, to which god does Creon say Antigone may appeal?

A. Ares the god of war

B. Zeus the God of Kindred

C. Apollo, lord of the Delphic oracle

D. Bacchus of Thebes

Key: B (Zeus the God of Kindred)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Haemon's line in Episode 3: "I plead for _____, father, nothing more."

Key: justice

28. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 3, why does Creon say he cannot spare Antigone?

Sample answer: Creon says that if he allows rebellion in his own family, he will encourage disobedience in the city. He caught her openly defying him, and sparing her would make him a traitor to the State. A ruler who cannot govern his own house, he argues, cannot govern Thebes.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 3, what can no one withstand, according to line 737?

A. The anger of Zeus

B. The stern voice of the king of Thebes

C. A glance of Love's eye

D. The spears of Argos

Key: C (A glance of Love's eye)

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 3, whom do the elders say Love has made mad?

A. Only Creon and his son

B. Only the gods

C. Only the old

D. All its subjects

Key: D (All its subjects)

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line in Stasimon 3: "Love resistless in _____"

Key: fight

32. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 3, how do the elders feel when they see Antigone?

Sample answer: The elders are moved to tears. They say they are borne aside from Justice as they see Antigone, so young and fair, led toward her death, and their pity overcomes their loyalty to the king's decree. They can no longer hold back the flood of their grief for her.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 4, what does Antigone say no maids have done for her?

A. Decorated her wedding bed

B. Taught her to weave cloth

C. Sung at her brother's grave

D. Carried her letters to Haemon in secret

Key: A (Decorated her wedding bed)

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 4, where does Creon say Antigone will dwell?

A. In her sister's room in the palace

B. In a cave closed off in the rock

C. In a temple outside Thebes

D. In a farmhouse far from Thebes

Key: B (In a cave closed off in the rock)

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Antigone's line in Episode 4: "O fount of _____, wood-embowered plain"

Key: Dirce

36. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 4, what does Antigone ask the gods of Thebes to look upon at the end?

Sample answer: She asks the gods and lords of Thebes to look on her, the last of their royal house, suffering at the hands of sinful men. She says this is the reward her piety has won. Her final words claim that she is punished for doing what the gods require, not for any crime.

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 4, what did Danaë give up for her cell?

A. Her golden crown

B. Her father's love

C. The light of the sun

D. Her place at the feast

Key: C (The light of the sun)

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 4, what did the Edonian king come to see once his frenzy passed?

A. Kings should rule alone

B. Wine is a danger to all men

C. Prisons cannot hold the brave

D. Scorning the gods is folly

Key: D (Scorning the gods is folly)

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line in Stasimon 4: “By the Iron Rocks that guard the double _____”

Key: main

40. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 4, why does the Chorus compare Antigone to Danaë?

Sample answer: Both are royal maidens shut away from the sunlight. Danaë exchanged the glad sunlight for a cell in a brass-bound tower, and Antigone is going to a rock tomb. The comparison shows that even the royal cannot escape Fate, since neither wealth nor towers nor ships can flee from it.

41. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 5, how does Teiresias describe the sounds of the birds?

A. A strange jargon of screams

B. A sweet and gentle hymn

C. A deep and total silence

D. A roll of distant thunder over the hills

Key: A (A strange jargon of screams)

42. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 5, what does Teiresias tell the boy to do as he leaves?

A. Fetch the guards

B. Lead him home

C. Wait for Creon

D. Run to the tomb

Key: B (Lead him home)

43. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Teiresias' line in Episode 5: “Let death disarm thy _____.”

Key: vengeance

44. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 5, what does the Chorus advise Creon to do?

Sample answer: The elders tell Creon to go at once and free Antigone from her rocky cell, and to build a tomb for the unburied Polyneices. They warn that the vengeance of the gods is swift to overtake those who will not repent. Creon, shaken by the seer's words, agrees to go himself.

45. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 5, what kind of song rings out to the god?

A. A funeral song for the fallen

B. A song of war

C. A hymn of praise

D. A soft lullaby

Key: C (A hymn of praise)

46. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 5, why do the elders call on the god for help?
Sample answer: The townsfolk are sick with a plague, and the god loves Thebes best of all cities because it is his own home, the city of his mother. The elders crave his ready help and beg him to come down from the heights of Parnassus or across the roaring straits to save them.

47. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Exodos, to whom did Creon's men pray before tending the body?

A. Zeus and Apollo

B. Ares and Athena, gods of the battlefield

C. The Muses of the sacred mount

D. Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways

Key: D (Pluto and the goddess of cross-ways)

48. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Exodos, who tells Eurydice the news?

A. A Messenger who was there

B. Creon himself, returning from the tomb

C. Teiresias the prophet

D. Ismene, Antigone's sister

Key: A (A Messenger who was there)

49. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's line in the Exodos: “Of happiness the chiefest part Is a wise _____”
Key: heart

50. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Exodos, what does Creon admit when he returns?
Sample answer: Creon admits that the fault was his and his alone. He calls himself the guilty cause of his family's losses and asks to be led away, saying he is less than nothing. The proud king who once would hear no advice now accepts that his own stubborn will brought ruin on his house.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What reason does Ismene give in the Prologue for obeying the edict?

A. The stronger rules, and they must obey

B. The edict was approved by the priests of the gods

C. Their brother was a traitor to Thebes

D. Creon has promised to change it soon

Key: A (The stronger rules, and they must obey)

52. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In the Prologue, what does Antigone mean by “A specious pretext”?

A. Creon's edict is a cover for his fear

B. Ismene's reason only looks good on the surface

C. The elders' advice is meant to trick her

D. The gods' laws are only an excuse

Key: B (Ismene's reason only looks good on the surface)

53. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Prologue introduce the conflict between divine law and human law?

    Sample answer: Antigone calls burial one of the eternal laws of Heaven and says the dead will commend her. Ismene replies that she does not scorn those laws but cannot defy the State. The scene sets the gods' law and the ruler's edict against each other before Creon has even appeared.

54. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What role does Ismene play in the Prologue's structure?

    A. She is the messenger who reports the edict to Creon

    B. She is a spy sent by the king

    C. She is a foil whose caution sets off Antigone's resolve

    D. She is a judge who decides the dispute

    Key: C (She is a foil whose caution sets off Antigone's resolve)

55. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Parodos, what happened to the fire-brand the attacker carried?

    A. It set the city's towers alight

    B. It was thrown into the river

    C. It was kept as a trophy in the temple

    D. It was dashed from his hand

    Key: D (It was dashed from his hand)

56. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Parodos suggest about how the elders see Creon at first?

    A. As a new ruler whose purpose they do not yet know

    B. As a tyrant they already fear

    C. As a hero who won the war alone

    D. As a stranger from another city

    Key: A (As a new ruler whose purpose they do not yet know)

57. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Parodos add to the audience's knowledge of the brothers?

    Sample answer: It tells how the two brothers, sons of one mother and father, rode against each other at the gates and both died. The Prologue mentioned their deaths, but the Parodos places them in the war, with Polyneices's side as the invader. This helps explain why Creon will treat them so differently.

58. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which image in the Parodos best captures the city's sense of rescue?

    A. The snow falling softly on the mountains of Thrace

    B. The sunbeam shining on Dircè's fountain

    C. The ship sinking in a storm

    D. The torch burning the towers

    Key: B (The sunbeam shining on Dircè's fountain)

59. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Episode 1, what does the Guard say his conscience did on the road?

    A. Told him to flee the city and hide in the hills

    B. Urged him to accuse the others

    C. Spurred him on and held him back by turns

    D. Kept silent the whole way

    Key: C (Spurred him on and held him back by turns)

60. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is Creon's claim that money is the worst evil important in Episode 1?

    A. It shows he is poor himself

    B. It explains why he became king

    C. It shows he wants to tax the city's richest merchants more

    D. It shows he suspects bribery rather than piety

    Key: D (It shows he suspects bribery rather than piety)

61. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Episode 1 build suspense about who buried the body?

    Sample answer: The Guard reports that someone sprinkled dust and performed the rites, but there was no trace of the doer. The guards quarrelled and swore oaths, and no one knew who had done it. Creon accuses bribed men, so the audience, who knows Antigone's plan, waits to see whether she will be discovered.

62. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's treatment of the Chorus in Episode 1 suggest?

    A. He will not accept advice he dislikes

    B. He values the elders' opinions above all

    C. He is afraid of the elders' power

    D. He plans to give the elders his throne

    Key: A (He will not accept advice he dislikes)

63. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In the Ode on Man, where can man's cunning lead him, according to the last stanza?

    A. Only to glory

    B. To good or to evil

    C. Only to ruin

    D. To the gods' favour

    Key: B (To good or to evil)

64. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Ode on Man, what weather does man shelter from?

    A. Lightning and hail

    B. Floods and drought

    C. Frost and rain

    D. Dust and heat

    Key: C (Frost and rain)

65. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Ode on Man comment on the burial of Polyneices without naming it?

    Sample answer: The ode warns against a bold man who departs from the path of right and from the laws of the land. The elders do not yet know who buried the body, but the warning fits the unknown lawbreaker. When Antigone is led in, the audience sees that the warning has landed on her.

66. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the main purpose of the Ode on Man in the play's structure?

    A. It retells the story of the Argive war

    B. It reveals who buried the body

    C. It prays for Creon to reign long and well

    D. It pauses to reflect on human daring

    Key: D (It pauses to reflect on human daring)

67. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 2, why does Creon send for Ismene?

    A. He suspects her of plotting too

    B. He wants her to plead for Antigone

    C. He wants her to take Antigone's place

    D. He wants her to bury the body

    Key: A (He suspects her of plotting too)

68. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 2, what does Antigone say keeps the townsmen silent?

    A. Love of the king

    B. Terror of the king

    C. Respect for the law

    D. Shame at her deed

    Key: B (Terror of the king)

69. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 2, how does Creon justify punishing his own niece?

    Sample answer: Creon says that even though Antigone is his sister's child, closer to him than any of his household, she and her sister will not escape the utmost penalty. He holds them equally guilty as conspirators. He puts the law of the State above family ties, believing that a ruler who spared his kin would lose his authority.

70. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which line from Episode 2 best shows Creon's fear of losing authority?

    A. “Bring forth the other”

    B. “Not I, thy life is mine, and that’s enough”

    C. “Unpunished, I am woman, she the man”

    D. “Both maids, methinks, are crazed”

    Key: C (“Unpunished, I am woman, she the man”)

71. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 2, who does the Chorus say laid the curse on the race?

    A. Creon, in his anger at the burial

B. The Argive army

C. Oedipus himself

D. Some god, in days of old

Key: D (Some god, in days of old)

72. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 2, whom does the Chorus credit with the saying about evil and good?

A. An inspired sage

B. A foolish king

C. A blind beggar

D. A priest of Thebes

Key: A (An inspired sage)

73. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 2 make Antigone's suffering part of a larger pattern?

Sample answer: The ode places her sentence inside a curse that has struck the house of Oedipus in every generation. It compares the curse to waves that keep pounding the shore and says the gods laid it on the family long ago. Her suffering becomes one more stage of an old family disaster.

74. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the main purpose of Stasimon 2 in the play?

A. To celebrate the victory over Argos

B. To place the sentence within the family curse

C. To reveal what Creon plans to do next with the two sisters

D. To praise Creon's wisdom as king

Key: B (To place the sentence within the family curse)

75. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line in Episode 3: “A brood of sons _____, keen to avenge”

Key: submissive

76. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 3, why does Creon reject Haemon's advice?

A. Haemon is lying about the people

B. The gods have warned him

C. Haemon is too young to teach him

D. The elders disagree with Haemon

Key: C (Haemon is too young to teach him)

77. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Episode 3 show the cost of Creon's decree to his own family?

Sample answer: Creon's sentence on Antigone turns his son against him. Haemon begins as a loyal son but ends by refusing ever to see his father again. Creon even orders that Antigone die in front of her bridegroom. The decree that was meant to protect the State is breaking apart Creon's own house.

78. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 3, which line best shows Haemon's respect for his father?

A. “’Tis thou, methinks, who speakest like a boy”

B. “As monarch of a desert thou wouldst shine”

C. “Because I see thee wrongfully perverse”

D. “O father, I am thine”

Key: D (“O father, I am thine”)

79. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 3, over which places does Love roam?

A. Hills and sea alike

B. Only the palace

C. Only the temples

D. Only the battlefield

Key: A (Hills and sea alike)

80. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Stasimon 3, what do the elders admit about their own judgment?

A. They have not once been wrong in their lives

B. Pity pulls them from Justice

C. They obey only the gods

D. They agree fully with Creon

Key: B (Pity pulls them from Justice)

81. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 3 explain the quarrel in Episode 3?

Sample answer: The Chorus says Love kindled the feud of kinsman with kin through the eyes of a winsome wife. The elders see Haemon's defiance of his father as the work of passion for Antigone, a power that bends gods and mortals alike to its will.

82. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 3, what does the Chorus claim about Love and the gods?

A. The gods have banished it from Olympus

B. It obeys Zeus alone

C. Even immortals are ruled by it

D. It cannot touch the gods

Key: C (Even immortals are ruled by it)

83. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 4, what is the taint of blood Antigone speaks of?

A. A wound from the battle of the brothers

B. A sickness in the city

C. A stain on Creon's sword

D. Her family's inherited disgrace

Key: D (Her family's inherited disgrace)

84. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Episode 4, what does Creon threaten the guards with?

A. Punishment for their delay

B. Exile from Thebes

C. Loss of their pay for the year

D. A place in the tomb beside her

Key: A (Punishment for their delay)

85. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Episode 4 present Antigone's isolation?

    Sample answer: Antigone goes unwept, unwed and unfriended, saying no friend is left to grieve for her. She feels mocked by the elders and calls herself an alien among the living and the dead. Creon orders her shut alone in a rock tomb, cut off from every human lodging on earth.

86. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Episode 4, whose guests does Antigone say her dead kinsfolk are?

    A. The king of Argos
    B. The queen of the dead
    C. The priests of Apollo
    D. The elders of Thebes

    Key: B (The queen of the dead)

87. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 4, what does the ode suggest about royal birth?

    A. It guarantees the favour of Zeus and the Muses
    B. It frees a person from all law
    C. It gives no protection from suffering
    D. It brings wealth but no power

    Key: C (It gives no protection from suffering)

88. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 4, whose sons were blinded?

    A. Danaë's, in her brass-bound tower
    B. The Edonian king's
    C. The Theban queen's
    D. The daughter of Boreas'

    Key: D (The daughter of Boreas')

89. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 4 use myth to comment on Antigone's fate?

    Sample answer: The Chorus tells of Danaë in her tower, the Edonian king in his dungeon and a child of gods vanquished by Destiny. Each figure is noble yet shut away or defeated, so the myths suggest that Antigone's royal birth cannot save her and that no one escapes Fate.

90. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 4, what does the Chorus say a jealous step-mother took?

    A. Vengeance on her step-sons
    B. The throne of Thrace from her husband
    C. A ship across the sea
    D. Her husband's sword

    Key: A (Vengeance on her step-sons)

91. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 5, what do the neighbouring States want to avenge?

    A. Cattle stolen from their fields
    B. Their warriors left to beasts and birds
    C. An insult to their king

D. A broken treaty of peace sworn between the cities

Key: B (Their warriors left to beasts and birds)

92. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 5, how long have the elders known the seer to be right?

A. Since last spring

B. For a few days

C. Since their hair was dark

D. Since the war with Argos began last year

Key: C (Since their hair was dark)

93. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Teiresias show that Creon's edict has harmed the whole city?

Sample answer: Teiresias says the city's shrines and altars are fouled by flesh carried from the corpse by dogs and crows. The gods reject Thebes' prayers and burnt offerings, and the birds no longer sing. One man's decree has polluted the whole city's worship.

94. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Episode 5, whom does Teiresias say Creon has wronged by leaving a corpse unwashed and unwept?

A. The Argive army

B. The elders

C. The guards

D. The gods below

Key: D (The gods below)

95. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 5, how do the elders describe the help they crave?

A. Ready and near

B. Slow and distant

C. Costly

D. Unwilling

Key: A (Ready and near)

96. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 5 show the elders' love for their city?

Sample answer: The elders call Thebes the god's own home and remind him that he loves it best of all cities. They describe its river, its founding and its festivals with pride, and they beg for help because their townsfolk are suffering.

97. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In the Exodos, what do the elders think of Eurydice's strained silence?

A. It shows calm acceptance of what has happened

B. It is as ominous as loud grief

C. It means she did not hear

D. It is a sign of joy

Key: B (It is as ominous as loud grief)

98. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Exodos, what has Creon's pride become, in his own words?

A. Stronger

B. Hidden

C. Humbled

D. Rewarded

Key: C (Humbled)

99. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Exodos show the reversal of Creon's fortune?

Sample answer: The Messenger recalls that Creon saved Thebes, ruled supreme and had noble children, but now all is gone. Creon returns grieving, learns of further loss, and asks to be led away as a cipher. The powerful king of the opening is reduced to helpless sorrow.

100. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Exodos, what does Eurydice say she is no stranger to?

A. Wealth

B. Battle

C. Exile

D. Misery

Key: D (Misery)

101. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In the Prologue, what does Antigone mean by the "eternal laws of Heaven"?

A. Laws of the gods that no ruler can cancel

B. Laws carved in stone at the temple of Zeus in Thebes

C. Laws passed by the elders long ago

D. Laws that Creon has promised to keep

Key: A (Laws of the gods that no ruler can cancel)

102. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which statement best describes Antigone's attitude toward death in the Prologue?

A. She fears it more than anything else

B. She accepts it as the price of a right act

C. She hopes Ismene will die in her place

D. She thinks the edict will not be enforced against her

Key: B (She accepts it as the price of a right act)

103. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Prologue set up the theme of family against the State?

Sample answer: Antigone puts her duty to her dead brother above the edict of the ruler, while Ismene says she cannot defy the State. Their quarrel shows two loyalties pulling in opposite directions. The rest of the play tests which should come first.

104. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Antigone's treatment of her sister in the Prologue. Is her harshness justified?

Sample answer: Antigone rejects Ismene's later offer, scorns her reasons as a pretext and says she will hate her. Her harshness can be seen as the firmness of someone who will not compromise on what is right, or as pride that pushes away the only family she has left. A strong answer judges with evidence from the scene.

105. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Parodos's portrayal of Zeus suggest about the play's values?

    A. The gods do not care about mortals

    B. The gods favour the strongest army

    C. The gods punish boastful pride

    D. The gods are at war with each other

    Key: C (The gods punish boastful pride)

106. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which choice best describes the structure of the Parodos?

    A. A lament, then a call for revenge

    B. A prayer, then a long story of the city's founding by Cadmus and his men

    C. An argument, then a vote among the elders

    D. Celebration of victory, then a turn to the new king's summons

    Key: D (Celebration of victory, then a turn to the new king's summons)

107. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Parodos present the city's attitude to the war dead?

    Sample answer: The elders praise the champions who defended each gate and celebrate the armour left as trophies. The two brothers who killed each other are mentioned briefly as an ill-starred pair. The city wants to blot out memories of war, which suggests it is not ready to face the question of the dead that Creon's edict will raise.

108. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Evaluate how the Parodos's joy affects the audience's response to the Prologue.

    Sample answer: After the sisters' anguish, the joyful song shows how far the city is from their grief. The contrast can make Antigone seem isolated, or it can make the city seem forgetful. A strong answer argues one view with evidence from both scenes.

109. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which statement best captures the principle Creon announces in Episode 1?

    A. The good of the State comes before any private bond

    B. The gods' law comes before the king's law

    C. Family bonds must be honoured above the commands of any king

    D. A king must obey the will of the people

    Key: A (The good of the State comes before any private bond)

110. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What role does the Guard play in Episode 1's structure?

    A. He argues with Creon about whether the edict is just and wise

    B. He brings the news that tests Creon's edict

    C. He reveals the name of the culprit

    D. He announces the end of the war

    Key: B (He brings the news that tests Creon's edict)

111. [short · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Episode 1 show a gap between Creon's ideals and his actions?

    Sample answer: Creon says a ruler must not be tongue-tied by fear and must listen for danger to the State. Yet when the

elders suggest the gods may be at work, he scorns them, and he threatens the guards with torture without evidence. His ideals of wise rule give way to suspicion and anger.

112. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the Chorus's caution in Episode 1. Is it wise or weak?

Sample answer: The elders accept Creon's edict, saying his word is law, but they ask that younger men enforce it and hint that the gods may be involved. Their caution can be seen as prudence before a powerful king or as weakness in failing to challenge him. A strong answer takes a position with evidence.

113. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In the Ode on Man, the phrase “Master of cunning” presents man as

A. Dishonest, sly and quick to cheat

B. Weak and fearful

C. Skilled and inventive

D. Proud and lazy

Key: C (Skilled and inventive)

114. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which pair of words best describes the double view of man in the Ode on Man?

A. Weak and wise

B. Holy, humble and close to the gods

C. Cruel and foolish

D. Wondrous and dangerous

Key: D (Wondrous and dangerous)

115. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the Ode on Man's final stanza as a judgment on both Antigone and Creon.

Sample answer: The stanza praises the man who honours the laws of the land and reveres the gods, and rejects one who leaves the path of right in pride. Antigone breaks the law of the land but honours the gods; Creon upholds the State's law but may offend the gods. The stanza can be turned against either, which is why it is so powerful.

116. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Ode on Man suggest about the limits of human achievement?

Sample answer: The ode says man has mastered the sea, the land, the beasts and even speech and thought, and has learned to endure plague. Yet he has found no cure for death, and his skill can lead him to evil. Human achievement is great but bounded by mortality and by the need to respect law and the gods.

117. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 2, what does the Guard's report of the whirlwind suggest?

A. The gods may be helping Antigone

B. Creon caused the storm

C. The guards were careless and fell asleep at their post

D. Antigone fled in the dust

Key: A (The gods may be helping Antigone)

118. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 2, which phrase shows that Antigone does not care for Creon's approval?

A. “I knew, all knew”

B. “To me no word of thine Is pleasant”

C. “One death sufficeth”

D. “Fear not; thou livest”

Key: B (“To me no word of thine Is pleasant”)

119. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Episode 2 develop the conflict between family loyalty and loyalty to the State?

Sample answer: Antigone defends the burial as reverence for kith and kin and for the gods' unwritten laws. Creon answers that a traitor cannot be honoured like a patriot and that even his niece must die for breaking the law. Each holds one loyalty as absolute, so the episode turns their disagreement into an open clash with a death sentence.

120. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Ismene's change between the Prologue and Episode 2.

Sample answer: In the Prologue Ismene refused to help, saying women must obey the stronger. In Episode 2 she claims a share in the guilt and asks to die with her sister. Her change shows that love for Antigone has overcome her fear, though Antigone refuses to let her share a deed she did not do.

121. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Stasimon 2, the words “omnipotent, sublime” describe

A. Hope on her wings

B. Fate with her sword

C. Zeus on Olympus

D. Oedipus as king

Key: C (Zeus on Olympus)

122. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 2, which phrase shows that the curse cannot be escaped?

A. “Profit to some”

B. “Throned in the dazzling light”

C. “Hither comes in angry mood”

D. “each the cup must drain”

Key: D (“each the cup must drain”)

123. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how Stasimon 2 uses images of nature to describe the power of fate.

Sample answer: The ode compares the family curse to storm winds that whip the sea and drive wave after wave onto the shore, and Fate to an axe that fells a blossoming tree. These natural images make fate seem relentless and impersonal, a force like weather or a woodsman that human beings cannot resist.

124. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 2 respond to the events of Episode 2?

Sample answer: After Creon sentences Antigone, the elders do not judge him directly. Instead they explain her fate as part of the family curse and warn that excess and false hope lead to ruin. The ode turns the scene's conflict into a reflection on fate, while hinting that more suffering is coming.

125. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 3, what is Haemon's main argument?

A. A wise ruler listens and yields

B. Antigone is innocent of the burial

C. The gods have ordered her release

D. Creon should give him the throne

Key: A (A wise ruler listens and yields)

126. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Episode 3, what does the Chorus's "Fell is the wrath of youth" suggest?

A. Haemon will soon calm down and come back to obey

B. Haemon's anger may lead to harm

C. Youth is wiser than old age

D. Creon should fear the army

Key: B (Haemon's anger may lead to harm)

127. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Episode 3 uses the conflict of father and son to explore power.

Sample answer: Creon expects obedience from his son as he does from citizens, and treats disagreement as rebellion. Haemon argues that a ruler should listen to others and that the State is not one man's property. The clash shows how Creon's idea of power, absolute and unbending, breaks the bonds of family that should support it.

128. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Creon's language in Episode 3 reveal his fears?

Sample answer: Creon talks constantly of rebellion, mutiny and Anarchy, and of a woman proving his match. He calls Haemon a beardless boy and a woman's slave. His words reveal a ruler afraid of losing control, of seeming weak, and of being beaten by a woman, fears that make him unable to listen.

129. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Stasimon 3, what does the ode suggest about the elders?

A. They are cold to Antigone and her suffering

B. They want to rule Thebes

C. Feeling can sway their loyalty

D. They fear only Haemon

Key: C (Feeling can sway their loyalty)

130. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 3, what does Love's being the consort of Justice imply?

A. Love is married to Creon

B. Justice must obey Love in every quarrel between kin

C. Love is a minor spirit

D. Love has a rightful place among divine laws

Key: D (Love has a rightful place among divine laws)

131. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Stasimon 3 moves from general truth to personal feeling.

Sample answer: The ode begins with general claims: all yield to Love, the gods are its captives, and the wisest fall to folly. Then the elders say Lo I myself am borne aside from Justice, turning to their own tears at the sight of Antigone. The shift makes their pity concrete and draws the audience toward her.

132. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Stasimon 3 use the image of marriage?

Sample answer: The ode speaks of a winsome wife and the yearning to win her heart, and the elders call Antigone this bride as she goes to Death's bower. The marriage images stress the wedding Antigone will never have, turning her punishment into a dark bridal and deepening the pathos of her fate.

133. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 4, what effect does Creon's interruption of Antigone's lament have?

A. It shows his coldness toward her grief

B. It shows that he has begun to pity her

C. It ends the scene in peace

D. It reveals a plan to free her later

Key: A (It shows his coldness toward her grief)

134. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Episode 4, why does Antigone call on the fount of Dirce and the Theban plain?

A. To ask them to hide her from Creon and his guards

B. To witness how her friends abandon her

C. To thank them for her happy childhood

D. To curse the city of Argos

Key: B (To witness how her friends abandon her)

135. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Episode 4 makes Antigone a more sympathetic figure.

Sample answer: The scene shows Antigone grieving for the marriage, children and life she will lose, and admitting fear and loneliness. Her laments, her comparison to Tantalus' daughter and her question about which law of heaven she broke draw pity. Against Creon's cold orders, her suffering makes the audience feel the human cost of the decree.

136. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 4, how is Antigone's doom tied to the history of her house?

Sample answer: The elders say she bears a father's guilt, and Antigone speaks of the hereditary stain on the race of Labdacus and the monstrous marriage-bed of her mother and father. She even says her brother's dead hand dealt her death-blow. The scene presents her death as part of an inherited curse as well as her own choice.

137. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Stasimon 4, what links the three stories?

A. Heroes who defeat the gods

B. Lovers who marry in secret against their fathers' will

C. Noble figures who cannot escape suffering

D. Kings who found new cities

Key: C (Noble figures who cannot escape suffering)

138. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's line in Stasimon 4: “For a cell, her bridal _____.”

Key: bower

139. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how Stasimon 4 balances pity and warning.

Sample answer: The Chorus pities Antigone, calling her my child and placing her among royal sufferers like Danaë. Yet the story of the Edonian king, punished for words of high disdain, warns that pride is punished. The ode both mourns her and reminds the audience that defiance of the gods brings ruin.

140. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 4 widen the play's view of suffering?

Sample answer: The ode moves beyond the house of Labdacus to Danaë, a Thracian king and a daughter of Boreas. By showing that royal and even divine figures were shut away or vanquished, it presents Antigone's fate as part of a universal pattern of human helplessness before Fate.

141. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 5, what does Creon's charge that the seer is bribed reveal?

    A. His trust in the seer's long record of truth

    B. His great wealth

    C. His love of birds

    D. His suspicion of those who oppose him

    Key: D (His suspicion of those who oppose him)

142. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 5, what makes Teiresias reveal the mystery hidden in his breast?

    A. Creon's insults provoke him

    B. The boy who leads him asks him to speak

    C. A sign from the birds

    D. The elders beg him

    Key: A (Creon's insults provoke him)

143. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Episode 5 presents Teiresias as a voice of the gods.

    Sample answer: Teiresias reads the birds and the sacrifice and reports what the gods reject. He speaks calmly at first, then with authority, foretelling Creon's loss as the avenging spirits of Heaven and Hell pursue him. The elders confirm his warnings have not failed the State, so his words carry the weight of the gods.

144. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Episode 5 mark the turning point of Creon's fate?

    Sample answer: Creon begins by insulting the seer and refusing burial even if Zeus' eagles carried the body to heaven. After the warning of a life for a life and the elders' urging, he yields, orders axes and says he will free the maiden himself. The proud ruler finally bends, but only under threat.

145. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 5, what contrast does the hymn draw?

    A. Peace in the city against a coming war with Argos

    B. Festive worship against a city's sickness

    C. Wealth against poverty

    D. Youth against old age

    Key: B (Festive worship against a city's sickness)

146. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how Stasimon 5 builds hope.

    Sample answer: The hymn praises the god as the child of Zeus and the lord of Thebes, lists the many places that worship him, and calls on him to come swiftly over mountains and straits. The festive cries and bright images build a mood of eager hope that the city's sickness will be healed.

147. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In the Exodos, why does the Messenger hope Eurydice left in silence?

    A. To fetch Creon from the plain

    B. To pray at the temple of Zeus

    C. To mourn in private with her maidens

    D. To rest after her long and weary journey home

    Key: C (To mourn in private with her maidens)

148. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In the Exodos, what effect does reporting events through a Messenger create?

A. It hides who the characters really are from the audience

B. It speeds the play to a happy end

C. It replaces the Chorus

D. It focuses attention on reactions and meaning

Key: D (It focuses attention on reactions and meaning)

149. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the Chorus's final lesson in the Exodos.

Sample answer: The Chorus says that a wise heart is the chief part of happiness, that it is perilous to cheat the gods, that the gods strike down proud words, and that chastisement brings wisdom to the old. The lesson applies to Creon, whose pride brought suffering and whose wisdom arrived too late.

150. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Exodos complete the pattern begun by Teiresias' warning?

Sample answer: Teiresias warned that Creon would pay life for life and that lamentation would fill his halls. In the Exodos, Creon cries out as if he were a prophet, his household is filled with mourning, and he recognizes his guilt. The ending fulfils the warning that he had mocked.

151. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which choice best explains why the Prologue opens with the sisters rather than with Creon?

A. The audience sees the edict's cost before hearing its reasons

B. Creon is away fighting the remnants of the Argive army beyond the walls

C. The sisters are the narrators of the play

D. Greek plays by custom begin with women speaking

Key: A (The audience sees the edict's cost before hearing its reasons)

152. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What tension is held in Antigone's phrase “banned awhile on earth, But by the dead commended”?

A. Love for her brother against love for Ismene

B. Human condemnation against divine approval

C. Hope of escape against fear of capture

D. Respect for Creon against fear of the elders

Key: B (Human condemnation against divine approval)

153. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the opening lines about the weird of Oedipus frame the action of the Prologue?

Sample answer: Antigone begins by asking whether Zeus will fulfil the weird of Oedipus, a world of woes, in their lives. The edict seems one more disaster added to an inherited curse. This frame makes her choice part of a family story of suffering, so the audience watches to see whether she can act freely or only complete her family's fate.

154. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether the Prologue presents Antigone's choice as heroic, reckless or both.

Sample answer: Her choice is heroic in that she acts on principle and accepts the cost, saying the worst is to die an honourable death. It is also reckless, as Ismene warns, because she rushes into a deed she cannot hope to win. A strong answer argues for one reading or for both, using lines from each sister.

155. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What dramatic function does the closing question of the Parodos serve?

A. It ends the play's first conflict

B. It reveals the outcome of the war against the Argive host

C. It builds suspense about Creon's purpose

D. It introduces a new speaker from the palace

Key: C (It builds suspense about Creon's purpose)

156. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Parodos's treatment of the attacker anticipate later concerns of the play?

A. It praises rebellion against kings

B. It argues that war against kin can be just

C. It shows that mortals can defy the gods

D. It shows the gods humbling the proud

Key: D (It shows the gods humbling the proud)

157. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the contrast between the Parodos and the Prologue in setting and speakers.

Sample answer: The Prologue is a secret meeting of two sisters before dawn beyond the gates; the Parodos is the public song of the city's elders at sunrise. One is private grief and conflict, the other public joy. The contrast sets the individual against the city, which is the play's central tension.

158. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the Chorus's description of Creon as crowned by this strange chance.

Sample answer: The phrase shows that Creon did not earn the throne by merit but gained it through the brothers' deaths. It hints at insecurity in his rule and at a city unsure of its new king. A strong answer judges what the phrase suggests about Creon's position, using the text.

159. [mc · analysis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which choice best describes the irony of Creon's oath by Zeus in Episode 1?

A. He swears by the god whose laws his edict may offend

B. He swears by a god he does not believe in

C. He swears falsely to deceive the guards and the watching elders

D. He swears by Zeus to honour Polyneices

Key: A (He swears by the god whose laws his edict may offend)

160. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus's line “Thy word is law” in Episode 1 suggest about Theban politics?

A. The elders rule jointly with the king in every matter

B. The new king holds near-absolute power

C. The people vote on every law

D. The gods choose each law directly

Key: B (The new king holds near-absolute power)

161. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Episode 1 presents Creon's understanding of the gods.

Sample answer: Creon calls on Zeus as witness and swears by him, yet he cannot believe the gods would honour a man who came to burn their temples. He assumes the gods agree with his judgment of the traitor. The episode shows a ruler who uses religion to support the State and will not consider that the gods might see things differently.

162. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Creon is presented as a tyrant in Episode 1.

Sample answer: Creon presents himself as a lawful ruler serving the common good, and his principle of loyalty to the State is reasonable. But he silences the elders, threatens torture and assumes bribery without evidence. A strong answer weighs these signs and decides whether he is a tyrant already or a ruler in danger of becoming one.

163. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In the Ode on Man, why is plague mentioned just before death?

A. Plague is raging in Thebes now

B. Plague is the gods' punishment for the war

C. It is a danger he can survive

D. Man has cured every plague on earth

Key: C (It is a danger he can survive)

164. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The Ode on Man's praise of “civic wit” most directly connects to which concern of Creon's?

A. The honour of the family

B. The worship of Bacchus in the city's temples

C. The fate of the Argives

D. The good order of the State

Key: D (The good order of the State)

165. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Ode on Man's warning against the “cityless outcast” shape the audience's response to Antigone's entrance?

Sample answer: The ode ends by rejecting the proud man who departs from the laws of the land, and at once Antigone is led in as the lawbreaker. The timing invites the audience to see her as the outcast the elders describe. Yet we know she acted for the gods, so the ode's judgment feels incomplete, and the audience is pulled between the elders' view and hers.

166. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the Ode on Man as a statement of the play's central ideas.

Sample answer: The ode states the play's central tension: human skill and law are wondrous, but they must stay within divine bounds and cannot overcome death. It does not settle whether Creon or Antigone embodies the good citizen. A strong answer weighs how far the ode speaks for the play and how far it reflects only the elders' cautious view.

167. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 2, Creon's line “Not that the base should fare as do the brave” expresses which principle?

A. Honour must match a man's deeds

B. All the dead deserve equal rites

C. The brave should rule the base

D. Death erases every crime

Key: A (Honour must match a man's deeds)

168. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 2, why is Creon's insistence on punishing his sister's child significant?

A. It shows he loves his niece most

B. It shows he puts the State above kin

C. It shows the elders control him from behind the throne

D. It shows he fears Ismene

Key: B (It shows he puts the State above kin)

169. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Episode 2 turns the burial from a private act into a public contest of wills.

Sample answer: The burial began as Antigone's secret act of family duty. Once she is caught, she openly claims the deed and defends it before the king and elders, and Creon answers with threats and talk of authority. Each now has a public reputation at stake, so neither can yield without seeming defeated, and the private act becomes a test of power.

170. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether Antigone or Creon argues better in Episode 2.

Sample answer: Antigone appeals to eternal divine law and the duty owed to kin, and she answers Creon's points directly. Creon appeals to the order of the State and the difference between patriot and traitor, but he falls back on threats and insults about women. A strong answer weighs the logic and the tone of each and reaches a defended judgment.

171. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 2, "All that exceeds the mean by Fate Is punished, Love or Hate" implies that

A. Only hatred is ever punished

B. Love wins every contest with fate in the end

C. Even excessive love is dangerous

D. Fate punishes only the gods

Key: C (Even excessive love is dangerous)

172. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Stasimon 2, the address to Zeus differs from the rest of the ode because it

A. Tells again the story of the Argive war at the seven gates

B. Mocks the gods for their cruelty

C. Praises Creon as a second Zeus

D. Turns from mortal ruin to divine permanence

Key: D (Turns from mortal ruin to divine permanence)

173. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Stasimon 2 balances fate and human responsibility.

Sample answer: The ode points to a curse laid by some god and passed down age after age, which suggests that the family cannot escape. Yet it also names Oedipus's reckless pride and warns that excess and misjudged hope bring punishment. Fate sets the pattern, but human choices trigger the blow, so the ode holds both ideas together.

174. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the claim that Stasimon 2 is the moral centre of the play's first half.

Sample answer: The ode gathers the first half's themes, the family curse, the danger of excess and the power of the gods, and points them toward the scenes to come. But it speaks through the cautious elders and avoids judging Creon. A strong answer decides whether its view is the play's own or only one voice in it.

175. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Episode 3, why is Haemon's line “Talk not of rights; thou spurn’st the due of Heaven” significant?

A. It links Antigone's cause to the gods

B. It shows Haemon has abandoned her cause to please his father

C. It praises Creon's piety

D. It ends the argument peacefully

Key: A (It links Antigone's cause to the gods)

176. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Episode 3, which earlier image does Haemon's capsized ship recall?

A. The eagle over Thebes

B. Creon's ship of State

C. The furlong and the league

D. The cup that each must drain

Key: B (Creon's ship of State)

177. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Creon's speech on Anarchy (lines 618–636) as political argument.

Sample answer: Creon argues that a man who rules his home well will rule the city well, that the State's appointed ruler must be obeyed in all things, and that Anarchy ruins cities, homes and armies while discipline preserves them. The argument is strong on order, but it demands obedience even to unjust commands and ends in fear of a woman's victory, which exposes its weakness.

178. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate the claim that Episode 3 is the turning point of Creon's tragedy.

Sample answer: In this episode Creon is offered wise advice by his own son and refuses it, losing Haemon's loyalty. He still yields on Ismene, so he is not wholly closed. A strong answer judges whether this refusal seals his fate or whether later scenes, such as further warnings, matter more, and supports the view with evidence.

179. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Stasimon 3, the phrase “feud of kinsman with kin” most directly recalls

A. The war of the brothers alone

B. The anger of Zeus at Thebes

C. The quarrel between Creon and his son

D. The guard's dispute with Creon about the dust on the body

Key: C (The quarrel between Creon and his son)

180. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Stasimon 3, how does the ode's closing tone differ from its opening?

A. Grief gives way to joy

B. Calm gives way to rage

C. Doubt gives way to certainty

D. Awe gives way to grief

Key: D (Awe gives way to grief)

181. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the role of the Chorus in Stasimon 3 as both commentator and participant.

Sample answer: As commentator, the Chorus explains the quarrel as the work of Love, a divine power that bends gods and mortals. As participant, the elders admit they are borne aside from Justice by pity for Antigone. The double role shows that even the king's counsellors are moved, preparing the audience to doubt Creon's decree.

182. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether Stasimon 3 supports or undercuts Creon's decree.

Sample answer: The ode seems to dismiss Haemon's argument as passion, which could support Creon. Yet it also says Love is enthroned with Justice and ends with the elders' tears for Antigone, which undercuts the decree. A strong answer weighs these signals and defends a view with lines from the ode.

183. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Episode 4, what does Antigone's comparison to Tantalus' child suggest about her view of herself?

A. She sees her suffering as mythic

B. She thinks she is a goddess

C. She expects to be turned to stone at once

D. She blames the gods of Olympus for everything

Key: A (She sees her suffering as mythic)

184. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Episode 4, the elders' responses to Antigone most show

A. Their joy at her punishment and at Creon's firm rule

B. Their divided loyalty to her and to Creon

C. Their plan to free her

D. Their ignorance of the law

Key: B (Their divided loyalty to her and to Creon)

185. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the tension between private grief and public justification in Episode 4.

Sample answer: Antigone grieves privately for her lost marriage, children and friends, yet in the same scene she publicly argues that she is justified in wisdom's eyes and was led by the law of conscience. The tension shows that her heroism costs her everything she values, and that conviction does not free her from fear and sorrow.

186. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Episode 4 weakens or strengthens Antigone as a tragic heroine.

Sample answer: Her grief and her strange argument about husband, child and brother may seem to weaken her heroic certainty. Yet her suffering makes her more human, and she never repents, calling on the gods to judge. A strong answer weighs these points and decides whether doubt and sorrow diminish or deepen her tragic stature.

187. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Stasimon 4, how does the Edonian king's story differ from Antigone's own case?

A. He was innocent of all wrong, while she knowingly broke the king's law

B. He was a woman of royal line

C. He scorned a god, while she claims to honour the gods

D. He escaped while she cannot

Key: C (He scorned a god, while she claims to honour the gods)

188. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Stasimon 4, what is ironic about the elders' comfort?

    A. They offer her a way to escape from the tomb

    B. They praise Creon's mercy

    C. They speak of a happy marriage

    D. Their examples all end in suffering

    Key: D (Their examples all end in suffering)

189. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the ambiguity of Stasimon 4's examples.

    Sample answer: Danaë suffered though innocent, the Edonian king suffered for his insolence, and the daughter of Boreas was simply vanquished by Destiny. The examples do not agree on why people suffer. This ambiguity leaves the audience to judge whether Antigone is an innocent victim, a proud rebel, or simply a mortal under Fate.

190. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether Stasimon 4 could be read as a warning to Creon.

    Sample answer: The ode tells of a king who mocked a god and was imprisoned until he learned his folly, and insists that neither wealth nor arms nor towers can withstand Fate. Though addressed to Antigone, these lines could apply to a ruler who defies the gods' laws. A strong answer weighs both readings with evidence.

191. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Episode 5, how does Teiresias' blindness relate to Creon's understanding?

    A. The blind seer sees the truth the king cannot

    B. Both men see the truth at once

    C. Creon sees more clearly than the seer, who is blinded by greed

    D. Blindness makes the seer unreliable

    Key: A (The blind seer sees the truth the king cannot)

192. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Episode 5, what is the dramatic effect of Teiresias' exit?

    A. It ends the conflict happily

    B. It leaves Creon alone with the warning

    C. It shows that Teiresias is afraid of the king's guards

    D. It brings Antigone on stage

    Key: B (It leaves Creon alone with the warning)

193. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the role of money and trade imagery in Episode 5.

    Sample answer: Creon calls the seer and elders pedlars who buy and sell him, speaks of silver of Sardis and gold of Ind, and calls prophets a money-getting tribe. Teiresias replies that kings are a lucre-loving race and invites Creon to consider whether he prophesies for gold. The imagery shows Creon reducing sacred matters to bargains.

194. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Creon's reversal in Episode 5 makes him a tragic figure.

    Sample answer: Creon finally recognizes that it is best to keep the law ordained of old and goes to undo his own act, which shows insight. Yet his change comes from fear after insults and stubbornness. A strong answer weighs whether recognition joined with suffering makes him tragic, and supports the view with lines from the episode.

195. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Stasimon 5, the elders' appeal to the god as healer is ironic because

    A. The god has not once set foot in Thebes since the city's founding

    B. Creon has banned all worship

C. Teiresias has foretold suffering that a hymn cannot undo

D. The elders do not believe in the god

Key: C (Teiresias has foretold suffering that a hymn cannot undo)

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Evaluate how Stasimon 5 shapes the audience's expectations.

Sample answer: The hymn's joy and hope suggest that Creon's change of heart may save the city. Yet the audience remembers Teiresias' warning of life for life. A strong answer weighs whether the hymn raises hope, deepens dread through contrast, or does both, and supports the view with lines.

197. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Messenger's line in the Exodos: “So at the bidding of our _____ lord”

Key: distraught

198. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In the Exodos, how does Creon's language change from his earlier speeches?

A. From grief to pride

B. From prayers to the gods to curses on the elders

C. From silence to boasting

D. From commands to confessions

Key: D (From commands to confessions)

199. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the Exodos resolves the play's conflict between divine and human law.

Sample answer: Creon finally buries Polyneices and tries to free Antigone, admitting the gods' claims, but too late. The losses that follow show the cost of putting a ruler's decree above the gods' laws. The Chorus's closing warning against cheating the gods confirms that divine law prevails over human pride.

200. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the ending offers any hope or consolation.

Sample answer: The ending is full of loss, and Creon says every way leads astray. Yet the Chorus says chastisement brings wisdom, and Creon does come to see the truth. A strong answer weighs whether hard-won wisdom offers consolation or only deepens the tragedy, using lines from the Exodos.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 44, inference 5, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Junior	51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100	recall 16, inference 25, analysis 9, synthesis 0
HS Senior	101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150	recall 1, inference 10, analysis 35, synthesis 4

AP	151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 23, synthesis 26

Final paper

Antigone: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Sophocles develops divine law and human law across Antigone. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Antigone and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to family and the State.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Antigone. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Antigone finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of pride and stubbornness. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the section and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The sisters embody two answers to an unjust law: open defiance and fearful obedience. Ismene's "weak women" (line 60) states her society's view of women, which Antigone's action challenges. The text makes this visible when it says “If in defiance of the law we cross / A monarch’s will?—weak women, think of that, / Not framed by nature to contend with men” (Prologue, lines 59–61). Before dawn after the war, Antigone tells her sister Ismene that King Creon has forbidden anyone to bury their brother Polyneices, who attacked Thebes; Eteocles, who defended it, will be buried with honour. Antigone will bury Polyneices and asks Ismene to help. Ismene, recalling the ruin of their family, refuses: they are women and cannot defy the State. Antigone goes alone. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Divine law and human law

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops divine law and human law across Antigone. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Antigone (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of divine law and human law. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of divine law and human law in Antigone. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Antigone (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of divine law and human law, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Family and the State

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops family and the State across Antigone. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Antigone (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of family and the State. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of family and the State in Antigone. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Antigone (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of family and the State, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Pride and stubbornness

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops pride and stubbornness across Antigone. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Antigone (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of pride and stubbornness. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of pride and stubbornness in Antigone. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Antigone (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of pride and stubbornness, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Gender and power

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops gender and power across Antigone. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Antigone (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of gender and power. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of gender and power in Antigone. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Antigone (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of gender and power, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Learning too late

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops learning too late across Antigone. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Antigone (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of learning too late. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of learning too late in Antigone. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Antigone (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of learning too late, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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